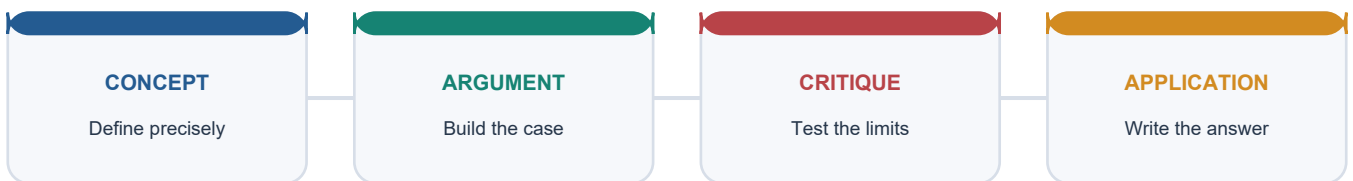


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Empiricism - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 13 teaching sessions, 32 diagnostics, 12 solved PYQs, 6 original Mains models and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Empiricism - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: *Empiricism (Locke, Berkeley, Hume) : Theory of Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 3. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute or a contested attribution. Locke is cited by **Book.Chapter.Section** of the *Essay Concerning Human Understanding*, Berkeley by **section number** of the *Principles of Human Knowledge* and by dialogue of the *Three Dialogues*, and Hume by **Book.Part.Section** of the *Treatise of Human Nature* and by **Section** of the *Enquiry concerning Human Understanding*, because those references are identical in every modern edition. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the original Latin term follows immediately - *to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)*, *blank slate (tabula rasa)*, *evil deceiver*-style vocabulary is not used here, and any Latin tag that is a later label rather than the author's own words is marked as such.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	13
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	12
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L)
ASCII master flow panels authored	25

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, LATIN IMMEDIATELY AFTER

THE ONE QUESTION ALL THREE MEN ANSWER
WHAT CAN AN EXPERIENCE-ONLY FOUNDATION ACTUALLY JUSTIFY?

SHARED RULE: every simple cognitive content must be traceable to experience - Locke's SENSATION and REFLECTION, Hume's IMPRESSIONS. The mind's OPERATIONS (compare, combine, abstract) are not denied.

THE FOUR TEST CASES THE SYLLABUS PRINTS BY NAME
knowledge | substance and qualities | self and God | scepticism

LOCKE	BERKELEY	HUME
applies the rule to CONTENT	applies it to MATTER	applies it to EVERYTHING
KNOWLEDGE = perceived agreement of ideas; intuitive > demonstrative > sensitive	all knowledge is of ideas immediately perceived; no veil of perception	perceptions divide into IMPRESSIONS (vivid) and IDEAS (faint copies); the FORK sorts them
QUALITIES: primary (in the object) vs secondary (powers); primary ideas RESEMBLE	the primary/secondary distinction COLLAPSES - relativity applies to both alike	no impression of substance at all - material or spiritual
SUBSTANCE = supposed substratum, "something I know not what"	NO material substance; to be is to be perceived (<i>esse est percipi</i>)	SUBSTANCE dissolved into stable bundles of co-occurring qualities
SELF = continuity of consciousness; a FORENSIC concept	SELF = active SPIRIT, known by NOTION, not by idea	SELF = a bundle or collection of different perceptions in flux
GOD = demonstrated from my own existence by causal reasoning	GOD = the infinite spirit who causes and sustains the ideas of sense	GOD = no proof survives; cosmological and design arguments both fail
NOT A SCEPTIC: epistemically humble but confident enough for practical life	ANTI-SCEPTIC: the materialist, not the idealist, invents the unknowable world	MITIGATED SCEPTIC: nature compels the beliefs reason cannot justify

THE PRICE EACH PAYS: Locke cannot compare an idea with the matter it is said to resemble; Berkeley must know spirits by a faculty his own theory of ideas cannot supply; Hume cannot say what binds the bundle, and says so himself.

Concept spine: read it downward. One shared rule about the origin of content, applied with increasing severity to four printed test cases - knowledge, substance and qualities, self and God, and scepticism.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the slide "R -> I -> S"**. Representative realism -> Immaterialism -> mitigated Scepticism.
MEMORY: **Mnemonic - what each man deletes, "M-S-N"**. Berkeley deletes **Matter**; Hume deletes the **Substantial** self and objective **Necessity**. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the three verdicts on scepticism, "H-A-M"**. Locke is **Humble**, Berkeley is **Anti-sceptical**, Hume is **Mitigated**.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Classification	Content
CORE MAINS	Locke's refutation of innate ideas and the sources of ideas; the degrees of knowledge; representative realism; abstract general ideas and nominal versus real essence; primary and secondary qualities; substance as "something I know not what"; personal identity and the circularity objection; Locke's demonstrative God. Berkeley's attack on abstraction; the five reconstructed arguments for immaterialism; <i>to be is to be perceived</i> (<i>esse est percipi</i>); spirits known by notion; God as cause and guarantor of continuity; the contrast with Hegel's absolute idealism; the Moore and Russell reactions. Hume's impressions and ideas and the copy principle; the fork; the dissolution of substance; the bundle self and Kant's reply; the analysis of causation and its two definitions; the problem of induction; the failure of the proofs of God; mitigated scepticism

Classification	Content
CORE SUPPORTING	The three principles of association; the missing shade of blue; constancy and coherence in the belief in body; the prince-and-cobbler case; Reid's brave officer; the <i>Treatise</i> Appendix retraction; the billiard balls and the bread; the argument against miracles; the comparative tables; citation and provenance discipline
SUPPORTING	Locke's corpuscular talk of "insensible corpuscles"; Berkeley's account of illusion, science and other minds; Berkeley on natural law as the settled grammar of a divine language; the Samuel Johnson stone-kicking anecdote as reception , never as an argument
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	Whether Locke's substratum is a humble realist posit or an empty placeholder; whether the Master Argument proves anything beyond a scope confusion; whether Hume is better read as a destructive sceptic or as a naturalist
NOT OWNED HERE	Descartes', Spinoza's and Leibniz's positive systems (Topic 02); Kant's critical system as a doctrine (Topic 04); Hegel's dialectic as a doctrine (Topic 05); Moore's and Russell's own positive philosophies (Topic 06); Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" and every question about it (Topic 11); Locke's political philosophy; Berkeley's mathematical controversies; Hume's passions, ethics, history and economics

ANALYSIS: **Ownership boundary, stated once.** Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell appear here **only** because three routed questions - 2020 Q2(a), 2024 Q2(a) and 2018 Q3(a) - explicitly demand the response. In each case the empiricist argument must be completed **before** the reply is reported. The three papers that mention Quine's *Two Dogmas of Empiricism* (2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c) and 2025 Q4(b)) share a word with this item and belong entirely to Topic 11.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

Every subtopic below runs in the same order, so the shape becomes automatic:

Step	What it gives you
DEFINITION	plain-language definition, then the technical one
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING	a sentence you can adapt directly as an introduction or a conclusion
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS	the terms that signal control of the topic
Plain-language visual	the idea before the vocabulary
VISUAL: VISUAL	the diagram that carries the argument
Numbered teaching	the doctrine, argument by argument, with sources
HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH	claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, written out for this subtopic
Exam link	which PYQ this subtopic answers, and how
UPSC traps	the specific ways candidates lose marks here
Revision notes	the compressed recall list
CLOSING RECALL FLOW	the subtopic reduced to one flow you can redraw from memory

Complete the Basic block first. Interpretive depth is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections, so that the core doctrine stays easy to learn and immediately usable. Nothing in the optional block is needed to write a complete answer to any of the twelve routed questions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

British empiricism is not three separate biographies. It is one rule about the origin of cognitive content, read more strictly at each stage, across roughly sixty years of publication.

- 1632-1704 JOHN LOCKE born Wrington, Somerset; died Oates, Essex
- 1689 An Essay Concerning Human Understanding is published
CAUTION: the title page prints 1690, and the work is almost always cited as 1690; both dates are correct in their own sense
- 1690 Essay, 1st edition as dated -> Book I anti-innatism
Book II ideas, qualities, substance
Book III words, abstraction, essence
Book IV knowledge, degrees, God
- 1694 2nd edition ADDS II.xxvii "Of Identity and Diversity"
CAUTION: personal identity is NOT in the original 1690 text
- 1700 4th edition -> the text most modern editions follow
(standard scholarly text: Nidditch, Clarendon 1975)
- |
- 1685-1753 GEORGE BERKELEY Irish; Anglican bishop of Cloyne from 1734
- 1710 A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge
Introduction Sec.6-25 -> the attack on abstract general ideas
Sec.1-4 -> objects of knowledge are ideas; the semantic argument
Sec.3 -> "to be is to be perceived" (esse est percipi)
Sec.8 -> the likeness principle: an idea can be like only an idea
Sec.9-15 -> the parity collapse of primary and secondary qualities
Sec.22-23 -> the Master Argument
Sec.27, 89, 140 -> spirits are known by NOTION, not by idea
Sec.6, 30-33, 48 -> God causes and sustains the order of ideas
- 1713 Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous -> the same case in dialogue
- |
- 1711-1776 DAVID HUME born and died in Edinburgh
- 1739-40 A Treatise of Human Nature
I.i.1 -> impressions and ideas; the missing shade of blue
I.iii.14 -> the search for the impression of necessary connexion
I.iv.2 -> constancy, coherence and the belief in body
I.iv.6 -> "a bundle or collection of different perceptions"
Appendix -> Hume RETRACTS: he cannot explain what unites the bundle
- 1748 An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding
CAUTION: published in 1748 as Philosophical Essays concerning Human Understanding and renamed in 1758; Hume disowned the Treatise as a juvenile work, and the Enquiry DROPS personal identity
II -> the copy principle | IV -> the problem of induction
V -> custom, "the great guide of human life"
VII -> necessary connexion and the TWO definitions of cause
X -> miracles | XII -> mitigated scepticism; "commit it then to the flames"
- 1779 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion (published posthumously)
-> the critique of the design argument
- |
- 18th c. JOSEPH BUTLER and THOMAS REID (Reid 1710-1796) attack Locke on personal identity: the circularity charge and the Brave Officer
- REPORTED Samuel Johnson kicks a stone: "I refute it thus!"
CAUTION: reception, not an argument. Berkeley's thesis was never that the stone is unreal or unfelt.

- FACT: The order is causal, not merely chronological. Berkeley reads Locke and quotes his general-triangle passage back at him at *Principles*, Introduction Section 13; Hume then applies Berkeley's own test to substance, self and causal power.
- ANALYSIS: **Three cautions that protect marks.** First, never date personal identity to 1690: II.xxvii is a **1694 addition**. Second, never merge the *Treatise* and the *Enquiry* without saying which text you are using, because the *Enquiry* silently drops the bundle theory. Third, the *Dialogues* were published only after Hume's death, so his most damaging attack on natural religion is posthumous.

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP

THE EMPIRICIST RULE, THE FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES, AND WHY THE SEQUENCE MOVES

- > LOCKE I: THE ATTACK ON INNATE IDEAS, THE BLANK PAGE, SENSATION AND REFLECTION, SIMPLE AND COMPLEX IDEAS
- > LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE AS PERCEIVED AGREEMENT, THE THREE DEGREES, PROBABILITY, AND REPRESENTATIVE REALISM
- > LOCKE III: ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEAS, NOMINAL AND REAL ESSENCE, AND THE GENERAL TRIANGLE THAT BERKELEY ATTACKS
- > LOCKE IV: PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES AND THE UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM
- > LOCKE V: PERSONAL IDENTITY AS CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS, THE CIRCULARITY OBJECTIONS, AND THE DEMONSTRATIVE PROOF OF GOD
- > BERKELEY I: THE DESTRUCTION OF ABSTRACTION AND THE NOMINALIST REPLACEMENT
- > BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR IMMATERIALISM AND WHAT "TO BE IS TO BE PERCEIVED" DOES AND DOES NOT CLAIM
- > BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, NOTIONS, GOD, CONTINUITY, COMMON SENSE, AND THE MOORE, RUSSELL AND HEGEL COMPARISONS
- > HUME I: IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE COPY PRINCIPLE, ASSOCIATION, THE FORK, AND THE DISSOLUTION OF SUBSTANCE
- > HUME II: THE BUNDLE SELF, THE APPENDIX RETRACTION, KANT'S REPLY, THE EXTERNAL WORLD, AND THE FAILURE OF THE PROOFS OF GOD
- > HUME III: CAUSATION, THE TWO DEFINITIONS, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION, KANT'S SECOND ANALOGY, AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM
- > COMPARISON, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVE DECODING AND PROVENANCE DISCIPLINE

This is a route map, not a substitute for the thirteen complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 - THE EMPIRICIST RULE, THE FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES, AND WHY THE SEQUENCE MOVES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Empiricism is the view that the raw materials of thought come from experience, so any idea that cannot be traced back to something experienced is under suspicion - and the three British empiricists disagree about how much of the ordinary world survives that test.

Technical definition: British empiricism is the doctrine that every simple cognitive content originates in experience - Locke's outer *sensation* and inner *reflection*, Hume's *impressions* - while the mind's own operations of comparing, combining and abstracting are retained; applied successively to knowledge, substance and qualities, self and God, it yields Locke's representative realism, Berkeley's immaterialism and Hume's mitigated scepticism.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Empiricism is not three biographies sharing a chapter but one rule about the **origin of content** enforced with rising severity: Locke keeps a material world he admits he cannot know, Berkeley keeps the world by deleting the matter behind it, and Hume keeps only perceptions, custom and the beliefs nature makes unavoidable - so the slide from realism to idealism to scepticism is a measure of the rule's consistency, not of philosophical decline.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **origin of content, not denial of reason** - the rule governs materials, not operations
- **sensation and reflection** - experience is two-channelled from the start
- **representative realism -> immaterialism -> mitigated scepticism**
- **the four printed test cases** - knowledge; substance and qualities; self and God; scepticism
- **the added premise** - each step needs one, and naming it earns the mark
- **natural belief** - what survives when justification does not

How to use them: open with the origin-of-content rule rather than with a caricature of "anti-reason"; name the four printed test cases so the examiner sees the syllabus; then show that each move from Locke to Berkeley to Hume requires **one further premise**, and name it.

Plain-language visual - one rule, three temperaments

THE RULE EVERYONE ACCEPTS

```
+-----+
| If you claim an idea, show me the experience it came from. |
+-----+
```

 LOCKE says: "Fine - and the ideas of primary qualities resemble the world." keeps matter but cannot inspect it v REPRESENTATIVE REALISM	 BERKELEY says: "Then stop talking about MATTER, which no experience ever delivers." keeps the world, deletes the matter behind it v SUBJECTIVE IDEALISM	 HUME says: "Then apply it to SUBSTANCE, the SELF and CAUSAL POWER too." keeps perceptions, loses the substrate, the simple self and objective necessity v MITIGATED SCEPTICISM
---	---	---

In simple words: three people are handed the same instruction. The first obeys it about *ideas* but quietly exempts *matter*. The second notices the exemption and removes it. The third notices two more exemptions - the self and causal power - and removes those as well. Nobody changes the rule; they only differ about where they stop applying it. That single sentence, written early, converts a list into an argument.

Remember first	Meaning
Origin, not warrant	empiricism is about where content comes from; the rationalist quarrel is about what justifies necessity
Experience is two-channelled	outer sensation and inner reflection, from Locke onward
Operations survive	comparing, combining and abstracting are never denied
The slide needs premises	each step adds one; state it
Scepticism is the endpoint, not the programme	Hume's conclusion is mitigated, not Pyrrhonian

One-line memory: empiricism disciplines the **materials** of thought, not the **activity** of thinking.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the four printed test cases and the added premise at each step

```

SYLLABUS PRINTS FOUR TEST CASES - EVERY ANSWER SHOULD SHOW THEM
=====
1 THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE      what ideas are, where they come from,
                           and how far they can be trusted
2 SUBSTANCE AND QUALITIES what a thing is behind its qualities,
                           and which qualities are really in it
3 SELF AND GOD             what unites a life, and what can be
                           proved about the divine
4 SCEPTICISM            how much doubt the rule finally forces
=====
                           |
                           | THE SAME RULE, APPLIED THREE TIMES, WITH AN ADDED PREMISE
                           |
LOCKE ----->
rule + "ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE their causes"
  |   ADDED PREMISE: resemblance across the perceptual boundary
  v
BERKELEY ----->
rule + "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" (Principles Sec.8)
  |   ADDED PREMISE: comparability - a resemblance nobody could
  |   ever check is empty; so matter is not unknown but meaningless
  v
HUME ----->
rule + "impressions are separable atoms, so no relation is given
      WITH its terms"
  |   ADDED PREMISE: atomism of impressions; therefore substance,
  |   self and necessary connexion have no source impression
  v
RESULT: bundles, habit, natural belief and MITIGATED scepticism
=====
WHY KANT MATTERS AT ALL HERE: he accepts the negative result and
denies the atomism, which is why he is the routed reply in 2020
and 2025 - and why he is NOT part of the empiricist doctrine.

```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The examiner's reward is concentrated in the middle column. A script that reports three positions has described the topic; a script that names the **added premise** at each step has explained it.

1. The rule, stated exactly - and what it does not say

FACT: Every **simple** idea traces to experience. Locke's channels are **sensation** (outer sense: colour, sound, warmth, solidity) and **reflection** (inner sense: the mind noticing its own thinking, doubting, willing, believing). Hume's version is the **copy principle**: every simple idea is a faint copy of a corresponding simple impression.

WRONG: Empiricism is **not** the claim that the mind is inert, that reason is worthless, or that there are no *a priori* truths at all. Hume's own "relations of ideas" are known by thought alone. What is denied is innate **ideas or principles** in Locke's target sense - not native faculties.

2. The four printed test cases, and where each thinker lands

Test case	Locke	Berkeley	Hume
Theory of knowledge	knowledge is the perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas; three degrees	all knowledge is of ideas immediately perceived; no veil	perceptions split into impressions and ideas; the fork sorts all enquiry
Substance and qualities	primary versus secondary qualities; substratum is "something I know not what"	the distinction collapses; there is no material substance at all	no impression of substance, so it is a fiction of the imagination
Self and God	self is continuity of consciousness; God is demonstrated causally	self is an active spirit known by notion; God causes and sustains the ideas of sense	self is a bundle of perceptions; every proof of God fails
Scepticism	rejected; humility, not doubt	explicitly refuted, and blamed on the materialist	embraced, but mitigated by nature and custom

3. Why the sequence moves - the mechanism in four lines

- Locke's ideas of primary qualities are said to **resemble** qualities in bodies.
- Berkeley points out that resemblance is a relation between comparable items, and nothing unperceivable is comparable - so the resemblance claim is not merely unverified, it is **unintelligible** (*Principles* Section 8).

3. Removing matter leaves ideas and the minds that have them, so Berkeley must supply an active cause for the involuntary order of sense: **God**.
4. Hume then asks Berkeley's question about **spirit** and about **causal power**, finds no impression of either, and the sequence terminates in bundles, habit and mitigated scepticism.

ANALYSIS: Each arrow is an argument, not a historical drift. This is why "Locke -> Berkeley -> Hume" must be presented as a **pressure test** of one premise, and why it is legitimate to say the endpoint reveals the premise to be incomplete - which is exactly the diagnosis Kant makes.

4. What the three men actually share

- FACT: A **genetic** method: explain a concept by exhibiting the experience that produced it.
- FACT: A hostility to *unexperienceable* explanatory posits, whether scholastic forms or Cartesian innate content.
- FACT: A conviction that philosophy should describe the human understanding rather than legislate for it - Locke's "under-labourer" modesty, Berkeley's appeal to the plain man, Hume's science of human nature.
- CAUTION: What they do **not** share is a verdict on how much of ordinary life survives, which is why calling them "the empiricists" without an internal differentiation loses marks in every comparative question.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The movement from Locke to Hume is generated by consistency, not by disagreement about the empiricist rule itself. **Named evidence.** All three accept that simple content originates in experience; Locke nevertheless asserts at *Essay* II.viii that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes, Berkeley answers at *Principles* Section 8 that "an idea can be like nothing but an idea", and Hume's search at *Treatise* I.iii.14 for an impression of necessary connexion finds only a determination of the mind. **Analysis.** Each successor removes an exemption his predecessor had quietly granted: Locke exempts matter, Berkeley exempts spirit and causal agency, and Hume exempts nothing, so the terminal scepticism is the rule's own shadow rather than an external attack on it. **Qualification.** The sequence is a reconstruction for exam use, and each step needs an additional premise - comparability for Berkeley, the atomism of impressions for Hume - so it demonstrates the rule's severity without proving that the rule is true.

Exam link

- Every comparative question in this item - 2018 Q3(a), 2024 Q2(a) - opens more strongly if the added premise is named in the first paragraph.
- **2022 Q4(c)** and **2023 Q2(c)** both begin from the rule stated in Section 1; the innate-ideas material in Session 2 is the second half of that answer.
- The four printed test cases in Section 2 are the safest available structure for any unexpected "Empiricism in general" question.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Empiricists deny reason"	They restrict the origin of content ; Hume's relations of ideas are known by thought alone
"Experience means the five senses"	Locke's reflection is inner experience of the mind's own operations
Presenting the slide as decline	Each step is the previous position taken consistently, which is why Kant treats it as a diagnosis
Treating the three as interchangeable "empiricists"	The whole examinable content lies in the differences
Importing Quine's <i>Two Dogmas of Empiricism</i>	That is Topic 11; sharing the word "empiricism" creates no ownership

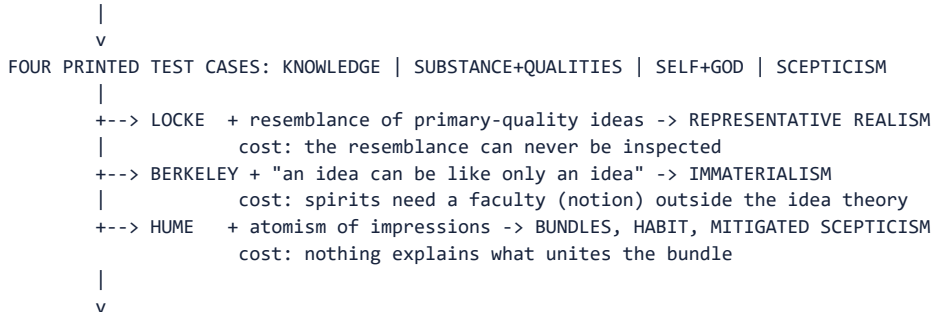
Revision notes

- One rule: every simple content traces to experience - sensation and reflection, impressions and ideas.
- Operations are never denied; innate **ideas and principles** are.

- Four printed test cases: knowledge; substance and qualities; self and God; scepticism.
- Added premises: resemblance (Locke) -> comparability (Berkeley) -> atomism of impressions (Hume).
- Landing points: representative realism -> subjective idealism -> mitigated scepticism.
- Kant is the routed reply, never part of the doctrine.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE EMPIRICIST RULE AND THE PRESSURE SEQUENCE

RULE: EVERY SIMPLE CONTENT TRACES TO EXPERIENCE (SENSATION + REFLECTION)



KANT ENTERS ONLY AS THE ROUTED REPLY (2020, 2025): he keeps the negative result and attacks the atomism

TRAP: not anti-reason | not five senses only | not three biographies

ANSWER LINE: the slide measures the rule's consistency, not philosophy's decline

SESSION 2 - LOCKE I: THE ATTACK ON INNATE IDEAS, THE BLANK PAGE, AND THE CONSTRUCTION OF IDEAS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Locke argues that we are not born knowing anything; the mind starts as unwritten paper, experience writes on it through the outer senses and through our awareness of our own mental operations, and everything complex is then built by the mind out of those simple deliveries.

Technical definition: Locke's genetic epistemology denies innate ideas and innate practical or speculative principles, derives all ideas from **sensation** and **reflection**, distinguishes passively received **simple ideas** from actively constructed **complex ideas** - sorted as **modes, substances and relations** - and thereby makes the origin of an idea the test of its legitimacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's refutation of innate ideas is not an appeal to nursery observation but a demand for redundancy: since every idea alleged to be innate can be shown to arrive through sensation or reflection, and since "to be in the mind" means for Locke "to be perceived by the mind", the innatist hypothesis explains nothing that experience has not already explained and posits something the theory of ideas cannot contain.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **universal assent refuted** - children and the cognitively impaired lack the alleged content
- **no unconscious ideas** - an unperceived thought is a contradiction in Locke's sense
- **the redundancy or genetic argument** - experience suffices, so innateness is idle
- **white paper, void of all characters** - Locke's own words at II.i.2
- **blank slate (tabula rasa)** - a later label, not Locke's phrase
- **sensation and reflection** - the two fountains of knowledge
- **simple -> complex: modes, substances, relations**

How to use them: give the three grounds in order, then the decisive premise about what "in the mind" means, then the concession that Descartes' *dispositional* innatism survives it - that concession is what separates a first-class answer from a textbook one.

Plain-language visual - three ways to attack an inborn idea

CLAIM UNDER ATTACK: "Some ideas are stamped on the mind at birth."

ATTACK 1 UNIVERSAL ASSENT

```
+-----+
| If it were inborn, |
| EVERYONE would have it. |
| Children and the |
| cognitively impaired |
| do not. |
+-----+
```

ATTACK 2 NO HIDDEN IDEAS

```
+-----+
| "There is an idea in your |
| mind you have never |
| thought" is, for Locke, |
| a contradiction: to be in |
| the mind IS to be |
| perceived by the mind. |
+-----+
```

ATTACK 3 REDUNDANCY

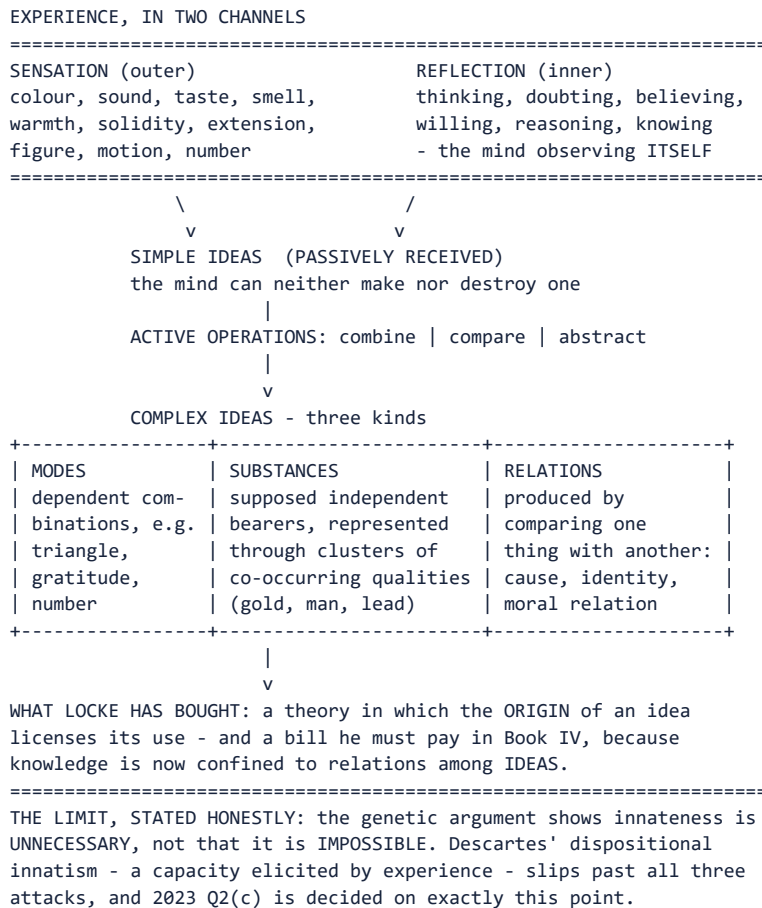
```
+-----+
| Every "innate" idea can be |
| traced to sensation or |
| reflection. If experience |
| already explains it, the |
| inborn hypothesis is idle. |
+-----+
```

In simple words: Locke never claims that babies are stupid. He claims that if you say an idea was inside all along but nobody noticed, you have described nothing that experience cannot describe better - and you have used the phrase "in the mind" in a way that, on his account of ideas, has no meaning. Attack 3 is the one that does the philosophical work; attacks 1 and 2 clear the ground for it.

Remember first	Meaning
Target	innate ideas and principles , not native faculties
"White paper"	Locke's own words; <i>tabula rasa</i> is the tradition's label
Sensation	ideas from external objects acting on the senses
Reflection	ideas from noticing the mind's own operations
Simple ideas	passively received; the mind cannot invent a new one
Complex ideas	actively made: modes, substances, relations

One-line memory: the mind supplies the **workmanship**; experience supplies the **stock**.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the pipeline from experience to knowledge, with the limit marked



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Read the diagram as an account with a debt. Sessions 3 and 4 collect the debt: if knowledge is the perception of agreement among ideas, the external world must be reached by an inference the theory has made difficult.

1. The three grounds of refutation, in Locke's order

Ground	Locke's argument	The target
Universal assent fails	If certain ideas or principles were innate, every human being - including children and "idiots" - would possess them; manifestly they do not	The standard innatist appeal to universal agreement
No unconscious ideas	A thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory, because for Locke "to be in the mind" is "to be perceived by the mind"	The retreat to ideas present but unnoticed
A genetic account is available	Every idea claimed as innate - God, identity, non-contradiction - can be shown to arise from sensation or reflection; if experience suffices, innateness is idle	All alleged innate content, speculative and practical

FACT: Ground 2 is the decisive one. Grounds 1 and 3 are empirical and can be conceded by a determined innatist; ground 2 is a **stipulation about what "in the mind" means**, and it is that stipulation, not the nursery evidence, that closes the escape route.

2. The blank page - the exact words and the exact provenance

- FACT: Locke writes that the mind is "**white paper, void of all characters**" (*Essay* II.i.2).
- ANALYSIS: **Provenance mark worth free marks:** *tabula rasa* is **not Locke's phrase**. It is Scholastic and Aristotelian vocabulary applied to him by the tradition. Write: "the mind as 'white paper, void of all characters' - the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*."
- WRONG: The blank-page thesis does **not** say the mind is passive. It denies innate **content**; it leaves the faculties of perceiving, remembering, comparing, combining and abstracting entirely intact.

3. The two fountains, and why reflection matters

- **Sensation** delivers ideas from external objects impinging on the senses.
- **Reflection** delivers ideas of the mind's own operations - thinking, doubting, willing, believing.
- **ANALYSIS:** Reflection is the single most under-used word in weak answers. It is what allows Locke to be an empiricist about **logic, mathematics and the self** without appealing to innate content, and it is what Hume later exploits when he locates the impression of necessary connexion **internally**.

4. Simple and complex ideas - the workmanship of the understanding

- **FACT: Simple ideas** are passively received and unanalysable; the mind cannot invent a wholly new simple sensory content, which is why a person born blind has no idea of scarlet.
- **FACT: Complex ideas** are actively formed by combining, comparing and abstracting:
- **modes** - dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number;
- **substances** - supposed independently existing bearers, represented through clusters of qualities;
- **relations** - ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause, identity or moral relation.
- **ANALYSIS:** The classification is not decoration. "Substance" appearing as a *complex idea* is already the admission that Session 5 exploits: what we have is a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.

5. The reply Locke must face - and the honest verdict

- **CAUTION: Descartes' dispositional reply.** Innate ideas were never claimed to be consciously present from birth; they are **capacities** of the intellect, elicited on an appropriate occasion, in the way a family disease is innate before it appears.
- **ANALYSIS: Adjudication.** Against a **naïve** innatism of consciously possessed inborn propositions, Locke wins outright. Against the **dispositional** innatism Descartes actually held, ground 1 misses and ground 3 is inconclusive, so everything turns on ground 2 - and ground 2 is a stipulation, not a discovery.
- **FACT: The line that earns the mark:** Leibniz's later formula - nothing is in the intellect that was not first in the senses, **except the intellect itself** - shows that innatism survives Locke as a thesis about *structure*, which is precisely the form Kant will vindicate.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Locke's refutation of innate ideas succeeds against the doctrine as he states it and leaves the dispositional version standing. **Named evidence.** Essay Book I mounts three attacks - the failure of universal assent, the impossibility of an idea in the mind that the mind does not perceive, and the availability of a genetic account through sensation and reflection - while II.i.2 replaces innate content with "white paper, void of all characters". **Analysis.** The empirical grounds can be absorbed by an innatist who claims only a capacity, so the weight falls on Locke's premise that to be in the mind is to be perceived by it; that premise is a decision about the meaning of "idea" rather than an observation, and once it is questioned the refutation loses its grip. **Qualification.** The dispute is therefore not empirical but conceptual, and Leibniz's rejoinder that the intellect itself is what the senses never supplied shows the surviving form of innatism to be structural - the form Kant later develops, and the reason 2023 Q2(c) cannot be answered by listing Locke's points alone.

Exam link

- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** - "Why and how does John Locke refute the innate ideas? Elucidate the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology." Section 1-4 are the whole answer, with Session 3 supplying the degrees of knowledge.
- **2023 Q2(c), 15 marks** - routed to Rationalism, but the Locke half is Section 1 and Section 5; the dispositional reply is compulsory there.
- Any question on empiricist method opens from Section 2 and Section 3.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Quoting " <i>tabula rasa</i> " as Locke's words	His words are "white paper, void of all characters"; the Latin tag is the tradition's
"Blank slate means the mind is passive"	Only simple ideas are passive; complex ideas are the workmanship of the understanding
Giving only the children-and-idiots argument	That is the weakest ground; the decisive one is that nothing can be in the mind unperceived
Omitting reflection	Without it Locke cannot explain ideas of thinking, willing or the self, and the answer looks like crude sensationalism
Presenting the refutation as complete	Dispositional innatism survives; say so and grade the verdict

Revision notes

- Three grounds: universal assent fails · no unconscious ideas · genetic account available.
- Decisive premise: "in the mind" = "perceived by the mind" - a stipulation.
- II.i.2: "white paper, void of all characters"; *tabula rasa* is a later label.
- Two fountains: sensation (outer) and reflection (inner).
- Simple ideas passive; complex ideas = modes, substances, relations.
- Verdict: naive innatism destroyed; dispositional innatism survives; Leibniz's "except the intellect itself" states the survivor.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOCKE I: INNATE IDEAS AND THE SOURCES OF IDEAS

```

INNATIST CLAIM: SOME IDEAS ARE STAMPED ON THE MIND AT BIRTH
|
+--> GROUND 1 universal assent fails (children, the impaired)
+--> GROUND 2 no idea can be in the mind unperceived <-- DECISIVE
+--> GROUND 3 experience already explains every candidate
|
v
REPLACEMENT: "WHITE PAPER, VOID OF ALL CHARACTERS" (Essay II.i.2)
  label caution: tabula rasa is the tradition's phrase, not Locke's
  |
  v
TWO FOUNTAINS: SENSATION (outer) + REFLECTION (inner operations)
  |
  v
SIMPLE IDEAS (passive) --combine/compare/abstract--> COMPLEX IDEAS
  MODES | SUBSTANCES | RELATIONS
  |
  v
RESIDUAL: dispositional innatism survives; Leibniz - "except the intellect
itself"; Kant later vindicates the structural form
TRAP: tabula rasa as a quotation | passivity | omitting reflection
ANSWER LINE: Locke shows innateness is unnecessary, not impossible

```

SESSION 3 - LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE AS PERCEIVED AGREEMENT, THE THREE DEGREES, PROBABILITY AND THE VEIL OF PERCEPTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: For Locke, to know something is to see that two of your own ideas do or do not fit together; that seeing comes in three strengths, and everything below the weakest strength is not knowledge but reasonable belief.

Technical definition: Locke defines knowledge as the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas, grades it as **intuitive**, **demonstrative** and **sensitive**, assigns everything beyond these grades to **probability** and judgement, and combines this with **representative realism** - the doctrine that we perceive ideas which represent external objects,

generating the epistemic gap his successors exploit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's theory of knowledge is generous in its account of where ideas come from and severe in its account of what may be called knowledge: because knowing is the perception of agreement **between ideas**, the existence of the external world can be reached only by the weakest of his three degrees, and that structural asymmetry - rich origins, thin certification - is what makes representative realism unstable enough for Berkeley to attack.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas**
- **intuitive, demonstrative, sensitive** - the three degrees, in that order of certainty
- **probability and judgement** - the vast domain below knowledge
- **representative realism** - ideas represent; objects are inferred
- **the veil of perception** - the gap the theory creates
- **sensitive knowledge** - Locke's own weakest degree, and the exam pressure point

How to use them: define knowledge first, then the three degrees with one example each, then show that the external world sits at the bottom of the ladder - and finish by naming the veil objection rather than waiting for the examiner to name it.

Plain-language visual - a ladder with a shaky bottom rung

HOW SURE CAN LOCKE BE?

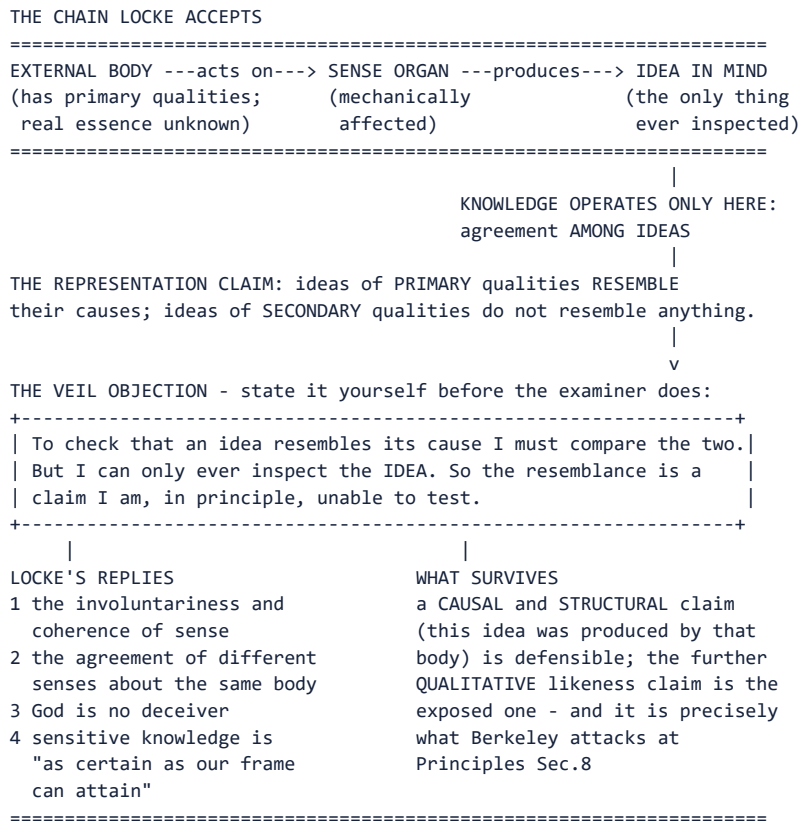
INTUITIVE	"white is not black" the mind sees the agreement IMMEDIATELY	most certain
DEMONSTRATIVE	proofs in mathematics; the existence of God agreement seen through INTERVENING ideas	
SENSITIVE	"there is a sheet of paper before me now" the existence of PARTICULAR external things	least certain
----- below this line is not knowledge -----		
PROBABILITY	testimony, analogy, everyday expectation, the whole of natural history and much science	

In simple words: Locke is not a sceptic, but he is a minimalist about the word "knowledge". Most of what we confidently believe - that the sun will rise, that this medicine works, that a friend is trustworthy - is not knowledge on his definition at all; it is well-grounded probability. Saying this early shows the examiner that you understand the **scale** of his restriction, which is the point Hume will later exploit without mercy.

Remember first	Meaning
Knowledge	perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas
Intuitive	immediate, no middle term
Demonstrative	mediated by intervening ideas; a chain of intuitions
Sensitive	that particular things exist; the weakest degree
Probability	judgement, not knowledge; where most of life happens
Representative realism	we perceive ideas that represent objects

One-line memory: rich sources, **narrow** certification - and the world sits on the bottom rung.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the causal chain, the representation claim, and the gap it opens



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Do not present the veil as a knock-down refutation. Present it as the **cost** of an otherwise powerful theory, list Locke's four replies, and then say exactly which part of the representation claim survives. That is the difference between reporting a criticism and adjudicating one.

1. The definition, and why it constrains everything after it

FACT: **Knowledge is the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas.** Everything Locke can subsequently say about the world must be expressed as a relation among ideas - which is why the existence of things outside the mind is the hardest thing for his system to certify, and why he must introduce a third, weaker degree specially for it.

2. The three degrees, with their examples

Degree	Mechanism	Example	Certainty
Intuitive	the agreement is seen immediately, with no intervening idea	"white is not black"; "a circle is not a triangle"; my own existence	highest
Demonstrative	the agreement is seen through a chain of intervening ideas, each link intuitive	mathematical proof; the existence of God	high, but liable to error in long chains
Sensitive	the existence of particular things now affecting the senses	"there is a sheet of paper before me"	lowest of the three, "though still reliable"

FACT: Naming **sensitive knowledge** as Locke's own term, and admitting it is his weakest degree, is what allows you to explain the internal pressure on the system without misrepresenting him as a sceptic.

3. Probability - the domain Locke does not call knowledge

- ANALYSIS: Beyond the three degrees lies **judgement**, governed by probability: the conformity of a claim with our own experience, and the testimony of others weighed by number, integrity, skill and consistency.
- FACT: This is where most of natural philosophy, all history and all everyday reasoning live. Locke's epistemic humility is not doubt; it is a careful refusal to inflate belief into knowledge.
- CAUTION: The unresolved tension: sensitive knowledge and high probability shade into one another, and Locke never draws the boundary sharply.

4. Representative realism, and the four defences

- FACT: We do not perceive objects directly; we perceive **ideas** that represent external objects.
- ANALYSIS: The gap is real, and Locke does not ignore it. His defences are: sense ideas are **involuntary**; different senses **agree** about the same body; pleasure and pain accompany real bodies in ways imagination cannot reproduce; and God would not construct us to be systematically deceived in what matters for the conduct of life.
- FACT: **What survives the veil objection**: a **causal** and **structural** representation claim - that this idea was produced by that body, and that measurable structure corresponds. What is exposed is the further **qualitative resemblance** claim, and that is the exact target of *Principles* Section 8.

5. Why Locke is not a sceptic

- FACT: He denies that we can know **real essences** or the intrinsic nature of substance; he does not deny that we know enough for "the conveniences of life and the information of virtue".
- ANALYSIS: The famous image is the plumb line: our candle burns bright enough for our purposes, and complaining that it is not the sun is a misuse of the faculties we have.
- WRONG: Never write that Locke "leads to scepticism" as though he endorsed it. Write that his structure **makes a sceptical challenge available**, and that Berkeley claims to remove the challenge by removing the veil.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Locke's epistemology is generous about the origin of ideas and severe about the certification of knowledge, and that asymmetry rather than any sceptical intention is what destabilises representative realism. **Named evidence.** Knowledge is defined as the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas and graded as intuitive, demonstrative and sensitive, with the existence of particular external things assigned to the weakest degree, while everything else - testimony, analogy, natural history - is relegated to probability and judgement. **Analysis.** Because all certification is internal to ideas, the claim that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes cannot be checked by the only procedure the system allows, so Berkeley's later objection is not an external attack but a demand that Locke apply his own standard to his own thesis. **Qualification.** The damage is nevertheless limited: the involuntariness and inter-sensory agreement of sense support a causal and structural representation claim, and only the qualitative resemblance thesis is genuinely exposed - which is why Locke should be read as an epistemically humble realist rather than as an unwilling sceptic.

Exam link

- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** - the second limb, "the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology", is answered from Section Section 1-3.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** - the veil and the resemblance thesis in Section 4 are what Berkeley's rejection of primary qualities exploits.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** - Berkeley's "immediately perceived" is defined against Locke's mediated perception, so Section 4 is the contrast this answer needs.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Locke is a sceptic"	He is a moderate realist with a narrow definition of knowledge
Listing the three degrees without examples	The examples are what show you understand the mechanism
Ignoring probability	Most of Locke's own epistemic life happens below the knowledge line
Treating the veil as Locke's own doctrine	"Veil of perception" is the critics' image, not his phrase
Saying representation is refuted outright	Causal and structural representation survives; qualitative resemblance does not

Revision notes

- Knowledge = perceived agreement or disagreement of ideas.

- Degrees: intuitive (immediate) -> demonstrative (chained) -> sensitive (particular existents).
- Below knowledge: probability and judgement - testimony, analogy, natural history.
- Representative realism: ideas represent; objects are inferred.
- Four defences: involuntariness · inter-sensory agreement · pleasure and pain · divine non-deception.
- Survives: causal and structural representation. Exposed: qualitative resemblance.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOCKE II: KNOWLEDGE, DEGREES AND THE VEIL

```

KNOWLEDGE = PERCEIVED AGREEMENT OR DISAGREEMENT OF IDEAS
|
+--> INTUITIVE      immediate: "white is not black"
+--> DEMONSTRATIVE  chained: mathematics; the existence of God
+--> SENSITIVE      particular external things - WEAKEST DEGREE
|
v
BELOW THE LINE: PROBABILITY AND JUDGEMENT (testimony, analogy, science)
|
v
REPRESENTATIVE REALISM: body -> sense organ -> IDEA (the only inspectable item)
  claim: primary-quality ideas RESEMBLE; secondary-quality ideas do NOT
  |
  +--> VEIL OBJECTION: the comparison can never be made
  +--> LOCKE'S REPLIES: involuntariness | inter-sensory agreement |
                        pleasure and pain | God is no deceiver
  |
  v
SURVIVES: causal + structural representation | EXPOSED: qualitative likeness
TRAP: Locke as sceptic | degrees without examples | veil as his own phrase
ANSWER LINE: generous about origins, severe about certification

```

SESSION 4 - LOCKE III: ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEAS, NOMINAL AND REAL ESSENCE, AND THE GENERAL TRIANGLE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Everything that exists is a particular thing, yet almost every word we use is general; Locke explains the gap by saying the mind strips away what makes ideas particular and keeps a stripped-down idea that stands for a whole class - and the class-name then means that stripped-down idea, not the hidden inner nature of the things.

Technical definition: Locke's doctrine of **abstract general ideas** holds that words become general by signifying general ideas, and ideas become general by **abstraction** - separation from the circumstances of time, place and all concomitant ideas - producing a "general representative" that is the **nominal essence** annexed to a sortal name, as distinct from the unknown **real essence** or internal constitution of the thing.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's doctrine of abstraction is the hinge of the whole empiricist quarrel about language: because he holds that everything existing is particular, that words are general only by signifying general ideas, and that classification is therefore "the workmanship of the understanding", the general idea of a triangle must be "all and none" of the determinate triangles at once - a concession he makes himself at *Essay* IV.vii.9, and the concession on which Berkeley builds his entire immaterialism.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **everything that exists is particular** (*Essay* III.iii.1)
- **abstraction** - separation from "circumstances of time and place"
- **general representative** - the abstract idea's job
- **nominal essence** versus **real essence**
- **conceptualism, not Platonic realism** - universals are creatures of the understanding
- **"something imperfect, that cannot exist"** - Locke's own admission

How to use them: state the eight-step argument, produce the triangle passage, and then - before any objection is raised - distinguish an idea with a feature **left undetermined** from an idea with **contradictory features assigned**. That distinction is Locke's best defence and it decides the 2025 answer.

Plain-language visual - how one idea can stand for many things

```

THE PROBLEM
things that exist:   this dog | that dog | the other dog  (all particular)
words we use:       "dog"                                     (general)
                    ^
                    |
LOCKE'S SOLUTION: SUBTRACTION
+-----+
| Take the idea of THIS dog.  Remove: the time you saw it, the |
| place, its colour, its size, its bark, its owner...         |
| What is left is a stripped idea that can stand for ANY dog. |
| That stripped idea IS the meaning of the word "dog".        |
+-----+
                    |
BERKELEY'S REPLY: SELECTION, NOT SUBTRACTION
+-----+
| Keep the idea of THIS dog, complete and determinate. Simply |
| ATTEND to what it shares with others, and let it STAND FOR  |
| all of them. The geometer draws this black inch-long line and |
| proves a theorem about all lines.                             |
+-----+

```

In simple words: the whole dispute is whether generality lives in a **special stripped idea** or in the **use** to which an ordinary idea is put. Locke says the idea is special; Berkeley says the use is special. Once you can say that sentence, you can answer the 2025 question in your first line.

Remember first	Meaning
Particularity	everything that exists is particular
Abstraction	strip time, place and concomitants
General representative	the stripped idea standing for the sort
Nominal essence	the abstract idea annexed to the general name
Real essence	the internal constitution producing observable properties
Conceptualism	universals are inventions of the understanding, not things

One-line memory: we classify by **nominal** essence and are ignorant of **real** essence - so sorting is our workmanship, not nature's dictation.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the eight-step argument, the triangle, and the two essences

LOCKE'S ARGUMENT, NUMBERED (Essay III.iii and IV.vii.9)

- ```
=====
1 Everything that exists is PARTICULAR III.iii.1
2 A separate name for every particular is impossible -
 memory could not hold them and communication would fail III.iii.2-4
3 Therefore language requires GENERAL TERMS
4 Words are general only by being signs of GENERAL IDEAS III.iii.6
5 Ideas become general when the mind SEPARATES them from
 circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea III.iii.6-9
6 What remains serves as a "GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE" of all
 particulars of the same sort
7 The abstract idea annexed to a sortal name IS the
 NOMINAL ESSENCE by which we classify III.iii.15
8 "General and universal belong not to the real existence
 of things; they are the inventions and creatures of the
 understanding" III.iii.11
=====
```

THE CANONICAL EXAMPLE - AND THE ADMISSION Essay IV.vii.9

```
+-----+
| The general idea of a triangle "must be neither oblique nor |
| rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but |
| all and none of these at once." |
| Locke concedes it is "something IMPERFECT, THAT CANNOT EXIST", |
| and that framing it "requires some pains and skill." |
+-----+
```

TWO ESSENCES - KEEP THEM APART

| NOMINAL ESSENCE              | REAL ESSENCE                |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| the abstract idea annexed to | the internal constitution   |
| the name: "gold" = yellow,   | (Locke's "insensible        |
| heavy, malleable, soluble in | corpuscles") from which the |
| aqua regia                   | observable properties flow  |
| KNOWN - we made it           | UNKNOWN - we posit it       |
| fixes CLASSIFICATION         | fixes NOTHING we can use    |

FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS THE ARGUMENT NEEDS

- P1 meaning is IDEATIONAL - a word signifies by standing for an idea  
P2 ideas are IMAGISTIC and particular in origin  
P3 mental SUBTRACTION leaves something still contentful  
P4 ONE IDEA PER GENERAL WORD - generality lives in the idea, not the use

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Presuppositions P1 and P4 are the load-bearing ones. Berkeley's attack in Session 6 destroys P2 and P3; Wittgenstein's later attack destroys P1 and P4, which is why the deepest verdict on this dispute is that the casualty is the **ideational theory of meaning**, not abstraction as such.

### 1. Why Locke needs the doctrine at all

The doctrine is not an optional flourish. Without it, Locke has no account of how a mind furnished only with particular ideas can use general words, and therefore no account of classification, of definition, or of the nominal essences on which the whole of Book III depends. Berkeley understood this exactly, which is why he attacks abstraction **first**, in the Introduction, before saying a word about matter.

### 2. The two essences, applied

- FACT: **Real essence** = the internal constitution of a thing - for Locke, the arrangement of its "insensible corpuscles" - that gives rise to all its observable properties. We usually do not know it.
- FACT: **Nominal essence** = the abstract idea associated with a general name. Classification proceeds by nominal essence.
- ANALYSIS: Consequence worth stating: because we sort by nominal essence, **species boundaries are conventional in their sharpness though not arbitrary in their materials**. Locke is agnostic about real essences without denying that things have them; that is epistemic humility, not anti-realism.

### 3. Locke as a conceptualist

- FACT: Universals are neither Platonic Forms subsisting apart nor mere noises: they are ideas made by the understanding for its own use, and they "concern only signs" (III.iii.11).

- ANALYSIS: This places Locke between Plato and the strict nominalist. Naming the position - **conceptualism** - is a one-word gain in precision that most scripts never make.

#### 4. The concession that decides the dispute

- FACT: Locke himself says the abstract general idea of a triangle is "**something imperfect, that cannot exist**". Berkeley quotes the passage **verbatim** at *Principles*, Introduction Section 13.
- ANALYSIS: **Locke's best available reply** - the distinction that saves him: an abstract idea is **partial**, not **contradictory**. It is the idea of three-sidedness with the specific angles **left undetermined**, not with contradictory angles **assigned**. Determinables need not be determinate.
- CAUTION: **The price of that reply**: it requires giving up the imagistic model of ideas that Locke elsewhere retains. Modern commentators generally accept the determinable reading, but it turns the abstract idea into a non-imagistic act of the understanding - and then it is no longer an "idea" in Locke's own official sense.

#### 5. The verdict to carry into Session 6

ANALYSIS: **Executable verdict**: Berkeley wins against the **imagistic** Locke and loses against the **determinable** Locke. The lasting damage is not to abstraction but to the ideational theory of meaning that made abstraction necessary - which is why the argument's true heir is not Hume but Wittgenstein's family-resemblance treatment of generality.

#### HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Locke's doctrine of abstract general ideas is an answer to a genuine problem about generality, and it is vulnerable only on a particular reading of what an idea is. **Named evidence.** *Essay* III.iii.1-15 argues that all existents are particular, that words are general by signifying general ideas, that ideas become general by separation from circumstances of time and place, and that the resulting nominal essence is what classification uses, while IV.vii.9 concedes that the general triangle is "all and none" of the determinate triangles and is "something imperfect, that cannot exist". **Analysis.** The concession is fatal only if ideas must be images, for an image cannot be indeterminate; if the abstract idea is instead a determinable with its specific angles left unassigned, the alleged contradiction dissolves and Berkeley's *Principles* Introduction Section 13 objection misses its target. **Qualification.** The rescue is not free, since a non-imagistic determinable is not an idea in Locke's own official sense, so the dispute ends by exposing the ideational theory of meaning itself - the presupposition both men share and neither examines.

#### Exam link

- **2025 Q4(c), 15 marks** - "Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas." The refutation cannot be explained without the doctrine refuted; this session is the first half of that answer.
- **2022 Q4(c), 15 marks** - nominal essence is part of "the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology".
- Any question on Locke's account of language or classification is answered from Section Section 1-3.

#### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                     | Correction                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confusing nominal with real essence                      | Nominal is the idea we made and use; real is the internal constitution we do not know     |
| Calling Locke a Platonic realist about universals        | He is a <b>conceptualist</b> : universals are creatures of the understanding              |
| Reporting the triangle as Berkeley's example             | It is <b>Locke's own</b> , quoted back at him at <i>Principles</i> Intro Section 13       |
| Treating abstraction as obviously absurd                 | The determinable reading is a serious defence; grade it                                   |
| Forgetting that abstraction is the base of immaterialism | Berkeley's "matter" is an abstract general idea; kill abstraction and matter goes with it |

#### Revision notes

- All existents particular; general words need general ideas; ideas made general by abstraction.



- Abstraction = separation from time, place and concomitants -> **general representative**.
- Nominal essence = abstract idea annexed to the name; real essence = unknown internal constitution.
- Locke is a **conceptualist**; universals "concern only signs" (III.iii.11).
- IV.vii.9: the general triangle is "all and none" and "imperfect, that cannot exist".
- Best reply: **partial, not contradictory** - determinable versus determinate.
- Four presuppositions: ideational meaning · imagistic ideas · possible subtraction · one idea per word.

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOCKE III: ABSTRACTION AND ESSENCE

```

ALL EXISTENTS ARE PARTICULAR (III.iii.1) BUT WORDS ARE GENERAL
|
v
WORDS ARE GENERAL BY SIGNIFYING GENERAL IDEAS (III.iii.6)
|
v
ABSTRACTION: strip time, place, concomitants -> GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE
|
+--> NOMINAL ESSENCE: the abstract idea annexed to the name (known)
+--> REAL ESSENCE: internal constitution producing properties (unknown)
|
v
CONCEPTUALISM: universals are "inventions and creatures of the understanding"
|
v
THE TRIANGLE (IV.vii.9): "all and none"; "imperfect, that cannot exist"
|
+--> BERKELEY quotes it verbatim at Principles Intro Sec.13
+--> LOCKE'S BEST REPLY: partial, NOT contradictory (determinable)
+--> PRICE: the abstract idea stops being imagistic
|
v
VERDICT: Berkeley beats imagistic Locke, loses to determinable Locke; the real
casualty is the IDEATIONAL THEORY OF MEANING
TRAP: nominal vs real | Platonic misreading | triangle attributed to Berkeley
ANSWER LINE: classification is our workmanship, not nature's dictation

```

## SESSION 5 - LOCKE IV: PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES AND THE UNKNOWN SUBSTRATUM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Locke separates the features a body really has whatever anyone thinks - its solidity, size, shape, motion and number - from the features that are only its power to make us see colours, hear sounds or feel warmth; and behind both he supposes a support he admits he cannot describe.

**Technical definition:** Locke's doctrine of qualities distinguishes **primary qualities**, which are inseparable from body and whose ideas **resemble** them, from **secondary qualities**, which are powers grounded in primary-quality configurations to produce sensations in us and whose ideas resemble nothing in the object; both are borne by a supposed **substratum** of which we have "no positive idea" - the famous "something, I know not what" of *Essay* II.xxiii.2.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's distinction between primary and secondary qualities is not a claim about which perceptions are pleasant but a claim about which properties do **explanatory work**: solidity, extension, figure, motion and number are the properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body however small, while colour and warmth are powers relative to a perceiver - and it is because Locke adds to this defensible distinction a further **resemblance** thesis, and beneath it an admittedly unknown substratum, that Berkeley finds two targets rather than one.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **primary qualities** - solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number
- **secondary qualities** - colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold
- **powers** - the exact word for secondary qualities



- **resemblance thesis** - ideas of primary qualities resemble; ideas of secondary qualities do not
- **inseparability test** - every fragment of a body retains the primary qualities
- **substratum** - "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (II.xxiii.2)

**How to use them:** give the list, then the **basis** of the distinction (inseparability plus explanatory role), then the resemblance thesis **separately**, because the resemblance thesis is what Berkeley refutes and the explanatory distinction is what survives him.

### Plain-language visual - divide the sugar cube

```

TAKE A CUBE OF SUGAR AND CUT IT IN HALF. AGAIN. AND AGAIN.
+-----+
| Every piece, however small, still has: |
| SOLIDITY EXTENSION FIGURE MOTION OR REST NUMBER |
| -> these are PRIMARY QUALITIES: inseparable from body itself |
+-----+
| But its SWEETNESS is not "in" the fragment the way its shape is. |
| Sweetness is the POWER of that shape-and-texture arrangement to |
| produce a taste in a creature with a tongue like ours. |
| -> COLOUR, SOUND, TASTE, SMELL, WARMTH are SECONDARY |
+-----+
|
AND UNDERNEATH? Locke says: something must SUPPORT these qualities.
But when he looks for it he finds no idea at all -
only "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".

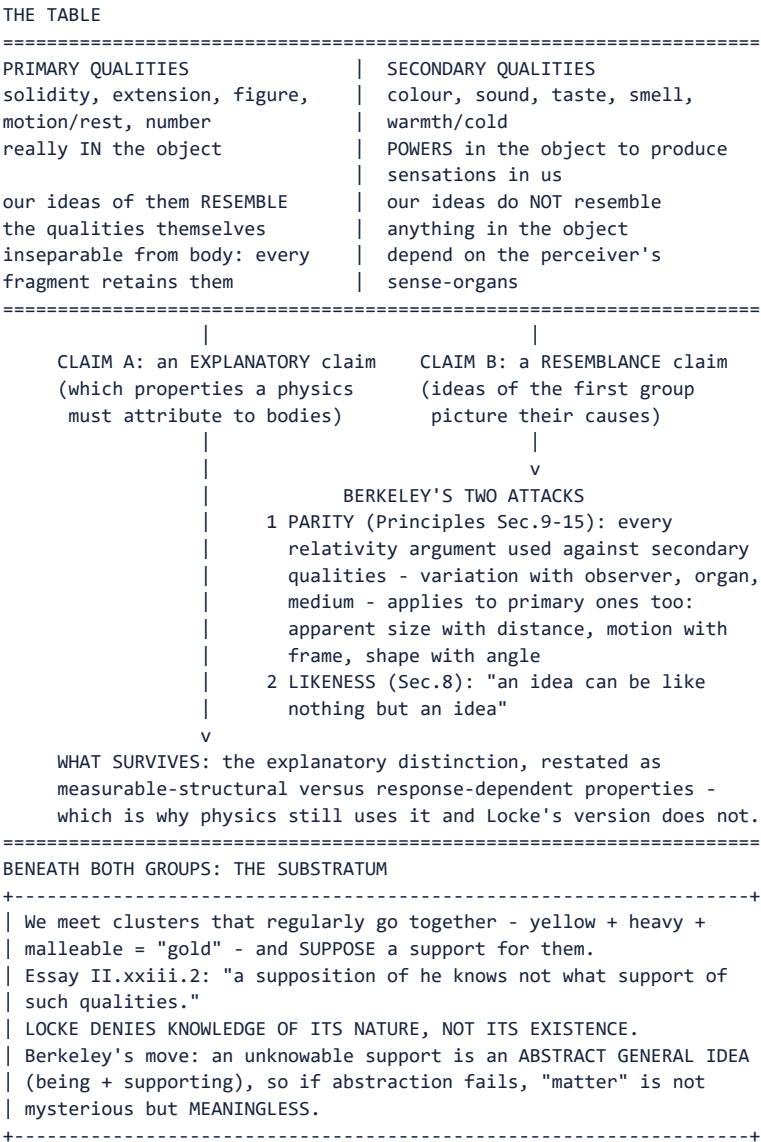
```

**In simple words:** the test is not "can I sense it?" but "would a body still have it if I sliced it to invisibility?". Shape survives the slicing; sweetness does not, because sweetness was always a relation to a taster. The substratum question is different again: it asks what **has** the shape - and Locke's honest answer is that he does not know.

| Remember first    | Meaning                                                        |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary           | inseparable from body; enter physical explanation              |
| Secondary         | <b>powers</b> in the object to produce sensations in us        |
| Resemblance       | primary-quality ideas resemble; secondary-quality ideas do not |
| Substratum        | supposed support of co-occurring qualities                     |
| "I know not what" | its <b>nature</b> is unknown; its existence is not denied      |
| Not idealism      | Locke never says the qualities are all in the mind             |

**One-line memory:** primary qualities **explain**; secondary qualities are **powers**; the substratum is a **posit**, not an observation.

**VISUAL: VISUAL - the two-quality table, the two claims, and the two attacks they invite**



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Separating Claim A from Claim B is the single highest-value move in the 2024 answer. Berkeley destroys Claim B and merely embarrasses Claim A; a script that treats them as one claim cannot explain why the distinction survives in modern science.

**1. The lists, and the basis of the division**

| Primary qualities                                          | Secondary qualities                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number        | Colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold             |
| Really <i>in</i> the object                                | <b>Powers</b> in the object to produce sensations in us |
| Our ideas of them <b>resemble</b> the qualities themselves | Our ideas do <b>not</b> resemble anything in the object |
| Inseparable from body - every fragment retains them        | Depend on the perceiver's sense-organs                  |

FACT: **Basis:** primary qualities are those that *any* body must have no matter how small; they are objective in the sense of entering the explanation of what bodies do. Secondary qualities are **relational** - the result of primary-quality configurations *acting on* our sense-organs.

**2. The word that keeps the doctrine accurate**

ANALYSIS: Secondary qualities are **powers**, not illusions and not "things in the mind". The sugar really does have the power to taste sweet to us; what it does not have is a sweetness resembling our sensation. Writing "secondary qualities are subjective" without the word *power* is the most common way of misstating Locke in this item.

### 3. Real essence, again - the link to Session 4

- FACT: Behind the primary qualities lies the **real essence**, the arrangement of insensible corpuscles that produces all observable properties. We know *that* things have internal constitutions; we do not know *what* they are.
- ANALYSIS: So Locke's physics-friendly distinction is combined with a confession of ignorance about the very level at which the explanation would have to be completed. That combination is the honest shape of his empiricism, and it is what makes him vulnerable rather than incoherent.

### 4. The substratum - stated exactly, and defended fairly

- FACT: We experience clusters of qualities that regularly go together - yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia - and suppose there is an underlying **substratum** that *supports* them.
- FACT: We have **no positive idea** of what this substratum is: it is "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2).
- ANALYSIS: **Locke does not deny that substance exists.** He denies that we can know its nature. This is representative realism with an epistemic ceiling, not idealism and not scepticism.
- ANALYSIS: **The fairest defence:** the substratum is an **explanatory posit** tied to the stability of qualities and kinds, not a claimed object of intuition. Qualities do not float; something is qualified. Berkeley's reply is that "support" here is a dead metaphor borrowed from pillars and floors, and that stripping the metaphor leaves the abstract idea of *being in general* plus the relative notion of *supporting* - which is precisely an abstract general idea.

### 5. The two attacks, and the exact adjudication

| Attack                                                                      | Berkeley's form                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Parity</b> ( <i>Principles</i> Section Section 9-15; <i>Dialogues</i> I) | Extension cannot be conceived without colour; motion and rest are relative to the observer; figure is inseparable from extension. Every relativity argument Locke accepts for secondary qualities applies to primary ones | ANALYSIS: <b>Objection to the objection:</b> perceptual relativity does not entail mind-dependence. That a thing looks different from different positions is exactly what one should expect of a <i>mind-independent</i> thing with a real shape                                          |
| <b>Likeness</b> ( <i>Principles</i> Section 8)                              | "An idea can be like nothing but an idea"; and if the supposed originals are unperceivable, no comparison is even possible, so a resemblance-claim we could never in principle check is empty                             | FACT: <b>This lands.</b> The qualitative resemblance thesis is indefensible. <b>But</b> structural or mathematical resemblance - isomorphism - does not require qualitative likeness: a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. That is the standard modern rescue of Locke |

ANALYSIS: **Executable verdict:** the distinction survives as a distinction between *measurable-structural* and *response-dependent* properties, but not as Locke's **resemblance** thesis. Locke's mistake was to make the distinction depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role; reconstructed as a claim about which properties enter physical explanation, it is defensible - which is why it survives in science while Locke's version does not.

### HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Locke's quality distinction contains two separable theses, and only one of them is destroyed by Berkeley. **Named evidence.** *Essay* II.viii lists solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest and number as inseparable from body while classifying colour, sound, taste, smell and warmth as powers to produce sensations, and adds that ideas of the first group resemble their qualities while ideas of the second resemble nothing; II.xxiii.2 then places both on a substratum that is only "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities". **Analysis.** Berkeley's parity argument at *Principles* Section Section 9-15 shows only that primary qualities are perceptually relative, which a realist can accept, whereas the likeness principle at Section 8 shows that a resemblance between an idea and an unperceivable quality could never be checked and is therefore empty - so the explanatory thesis stands and the pictorial thesis falls. **Qualification.** What survives is a distinction between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties defended by isomorphism rather than by likeness, and Locke's substratum survives only as an explanatory posit whose intelligibility depends on the doctrine of abstraction that Berkeley attacks first.

### Exam link

- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** - "Is rejection of Locke's notion of primary qualities instrumental in Berkeley's leaning towards idealism?" This session is the first limb; the answer is **yes, but through the likeness principle and the anti-abstraction argument, not through relativity alone**.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** - Berkeley's "immediately perceived" presupposes the collapse of the quality distinction.
- Any "substance" question in this item begins from Section 4.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                           | Correction                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Secondary qualities are illusions"            | They are <b>powers</b> ; the object really has them, relative to perceivers                  |
| "Locke denies substance"                       | He denies <b>knowledge of its nature</b> ; he affirms its existence                          |
| Treating relativity as decisive                | Relativity alone does not entail mind-dependence; the likeness principle is the sharp weapon |
| Merging the explanatory and resemblance claims | Only the resemblance claim falls; say which                                                  |
| Quoting the substratum phrase loosely          | The words are "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (II.xxiii.2)    |

### Revision notes

- Primary: solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number - inseparable, explanatory.
- Secondary: colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold - **powers** relative to perceivers.
- Resemblance thesis: primary ideas resemble; secondary ideas do not.
- Substratum II.xxiii.2: "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".
- Berkeley: parity (Section 9-15) plus likeness (Section 8); likeness is the one that lands.
- Survives: measurable-structural versus response-dependent, defended by isomorphism.

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOCKE IV: QUALITIES AND SUBSTANCE

QUALITY = THE POWER IN A BODY TO PRODUCE AN IDEA IN US  
|  
+--> PRIMARY: solidity, extension, figure, motion/rest, number  
|     inseparable from body; ideas RESEMBLE; enter physical explanation  
+--> SECONDARY: colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth/cold  
|     POWERS grounded in primary configurations; ideas resemble nothing  
|  
v  
TWO SEPARABLE THESES: (A) EXPLANATORY DIVISION    (B) RESEMBLANCE PICTURE  
|  
+--> BERKELEY PARITY (Sec.9-15) attacks A -> answered: relativity is  
|     what a real shape would produce  
+--> BERKELEY LIKENESS (Sec.8) attacks B -> LANDS: an unverifiable  
|     resemblance is empty; rescue = isomorphism, not likeness  
|  
v  
BENEATH BOTH: SUBSTRATUM = "a supposition of he knows not what support of  
such qualities" (II.xxiii.2) - NATURE unknown, EXISTENCE not denied  
|  
v  
BERKELEY'S NEXT STEP: an unknowable support is an ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA;  
kill abstraction and "matter" becomes meaningless, not mysterious  
TRAP: illusions | denial of substance | relativity as decisive  
ANSWER LINE: the explanatory distinction survives; the picture does not

# SESSION 6 - LOCKE V: PERSONAL IDENTITY AS CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS, THE OBJECTIONS, AND THE DEMONSTRATIVE PROOF OF GOD

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** For Locke, what makes you the same person as the child in an old photograph is not the same body and not the same soul but the fact that your present consciousness can reach back and claim that child's experiences as your own - which is why "person" is fundamentally a term about responsibility.

**Technical definition:** Locke's account of personal identity, added at *Essay* II.xvii in the second edition of 1694, distinguishes the identity of a **substance**, a **human animal** and a **person**; personal identity consists in the extension of **consciousness** backwards over past thoughts and actions, with **memory** as its chief vehicle and evidence, making "person" a **forensic** term tied to accountability.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Locke's most radical move on personal identity is not the appeal to memory but the prior separation of three questions that his predecessors ran together: the identity of a substance, of a living human organism, and of a person are three different identities with three different criteria, and once "person" is defined as "a thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places", identity of person must be settled by consciousness - which is why the doctrine is best judged as a theory of accountability rather than as a theory of metaphysical substance.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **person, human animal (man), substance** - three identities, three criteria
- **continuity of consciousness** - the constitutive notion
- **memory as vehicle and evidence** - not as the definition
- **appropriation** - consciousness claiming a past act as its own
- **forensic** - Locke's own word for the concept of person
- **prince and cobbler** - the case that separates person from man
- **circularity (Butler, Reid)** and the **Brave Officer (Reid)**

**How to use them:** state the three-fold distinction first, then define person, then the criterion, then the prince-and-cobbler case, then the two objections and Locke's repair. A script that opens with "memory theory" and never separates person from man has already lost the structure of the answer.

## Plain-language visual - three questions people confuse

THE SAME WHAT?

|                         |                                                                                              |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+           |                                                                                              |
| SAME SUBSTANCE          | is it the same underlying stuff,<br>  material or immaterial?                                |
| +-----+-----+           |                                                                                              |
| SAME MAN (human animal) | is it the same continuing living<br>  organism?                                              |
| +-----+-----+           |                                                                                              |
| SAME PERSON             | can this present consciousness<br>  APPROPRIATE that past thought or<br>  action as its own? |
| +-----+-----+           |                                                                                              |

THE PRINCE AND THE COBBLER

prince's consciousness --transferred into--> cobbler's body

RESULT: the PERSON who wakes up is the prince

the MAN who wakes up is the cobbler

THEREFORE: personal identity is neither bodily nor substantial identity.

**In simple words:** Locke's question is not "what am I made of?" but "whose deeds are mine?". Punishment, praise, promise-keeping and reward all presuppose that a present self can own a past act. Locke builds the concept of person to fit that job, and then follows the criterion wherever it leads - even into a thought-experiment where a prince wakes up in a cobbler's body.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Person         | "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places" (II.xxvii.9) |
| Criterion      | extension of consciousness, not sameness of substance                                                                                                                  |
| Memory         | the vehicle and evidence of that extension                                                                                                                             |
| Forensic       | a term of law and morals, tied to accountability                                                                                                                       |
| 1694           | the chapter is a <b>second-edition addition</b>                                                                                                                        |

**One-line memory:** same substance, same animal and same person are **three** questions; only the third is settled by consciousness.

### VISUAL: VISUAL - the criterion, the two objections and the repair

```

LOCKE'S CRITERION Essay II.xxvii
=====
PRESENT CONSCIOUSNESS -----appropriates-----> PAST THOUGHT OR ACTION
 |
 +--- as far as this reaches, the PERSON extends -----+
MEMORY is how the reach is exercised and evidenced, but the
CONSTITUTIVE notion is CONSCIOUSNESS. Reducing the theory to bare
memory INTENSIFIES the circularity problem - do not do it.
=====
 |
OBJECTION 1 - CIRCULARITY (Butler, Reid)
+-----+
| I can remember only MY OWN experiences. So "genuine memory" |
| already presupposes identity. If identity is then DEFINED by |
| memory, the definition is circular. |
+-----+
REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from the
EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory). Contested - the objector answers that
"consciousness of X as mine" smuggles the same ownership back in.
 |
OBJECTION 2 - TRANSITIVITY: REID'S BRAVE OFFICER
+-----+
| BOY (flogged at school) <--remembers-- YOUNG OFFICER |
| YOUNG OFFICER <--remembers-- OLD GENERAL |
| BOY <--NOT remembered by-- OLD GENERAL |
| | |
| So: boy = officer, officer = general, but boy != general. |
| Identity is transitive. Locke's criterion is not. |
+-----+
REPAIR: OVERLAPPING CHAINS of consciousness - identity is the
ANCESTRAL of direct appropriation. Locke's criterion is thereby saved
at the price of no longer being a simple episodic-memory criterion.
 |
OBJECTION 3 - GAPS: dreamless sleep, anaesthesia, amnesia
REPLY: continuous CAPACITY for appropriation, not constant recollection.
RESIDUAL: capacity-talk strains the account, and Locke concedes that
whether the same substance persists through a gap is unknowable to us.
=====

```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The examiner's word in 2021 Q1(d) is "**Examine**". That directive requires the doctrine **and** the test; an answer that states the criterion and stops has performed only half the instruction.

#### 1. The definition, and why it is built the way it is

FACT: A person is "**a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places**" (Essay II.xxvii.9). Self-reflexive awareness is written into the definition, so the identity condition must be an awareness-condition.

#### 2. The three identities, kept apart

- FACT: **Same substance** - sameness of the material or immaterial bearer. Unknowable to us in the immaterial case.
- FACT: **Same man (human animal)** - participation in one continued life of the same organised living body.

- FACT: **Same person** - the extension of present consciousness over past thoughts and actions.
- ANALYSIS: Locke's radicalism is precisely this **separation**. It is what allows him to say that the same man may be two persons, or the same person two men - and it is what makes a purely bodily or purely substantial criterion unavailable.

### 3. Consciousness, memory and appropriation

- FACT: Personal identity extends as far as present consciousness can **appropriate** a past thought or action as its own.
- FACT: **Memory is the chief mechanism and evidence** of this backward extension, but the constitutive notion is consciousness. ANALYSIS: Reducing the theory to bare memory intensifies the circularity problem, so the precise formulation is itself a defensive move.
- FACT: **Forensic concept**: Locke ties personal identity to **moral responsibility** - we are accountable only for acts we can appropriate. "Person" belongs, in his own words, to law and to reward and punishment.

### 4. The prince and the cobbler

FACT: If the prince's consciousness, carrying the memory of his princely life, enters and informs the cobbler's body, then the **person** is the prince while the **man** is the cobbler. The case is decisive because it shows in one stroke that personal identity is neither bodily nor substantial identity, and it does so without requiring any metaphysical commitment about souls.

### 5. The objections, and the honest verdict

| Objection                                       | Source                 | Force                                                                                                                                                                                           | Best reply                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Circularity</b>                              | Butler, Reid (18th c.) | Memory presupposes identity - I can remember only <i>my own</i> experiences, so identity must already be settled before memory can confirm it                                                   | Distinguish the <b>constitutive</b> criterion (consciousness) from the <b>evidential</b> criterion (memory). CAUTION: Contested: "consciousness of it as <i>mine</i> " may reintroduce ownership |
| <b>Transitivity failure - the Brave Officer</b> | Reid (1710-1796)       | Boy -> young officer -> old general. The officer remembers the boy; the general remembers the officer but not the boy. By the criterion, general ≠ boy, yet officer = boy and general = officer | <b>Overlapping chains</b> : identity is the ancestral of direct appropriation. ANALYSIS: Saves transitivity, but abandons the simple episodic reading                                            |
| <b>Gaps in consciousness</b>                    | Critics generally      | Dreamless sleep and amnesia would interrupt the person                                                                                                                                          | Continuous <b>capacity</b> for appropriation rather than constant recollection. ANALYSIS: This strains the account, and Locke himself admits the substance question is undecidable for us        |

ANALYSIS: **Executable verdict**: Locke's theory is best defended as a **repaired psychological-continuity** account, and on that reading it survives Reid; but the repaired version is no longer the simple memory criterion the textbooks attribute to him, and the circularity charge remains genuinely open. Saying exactly this is what "examine" requires.

### 6. Locke on God - the demonstrative proof

- FACT: God's existence is known by **demonstration** - not by intuition and not by sensitive knowledge. The chain runs: something cannot come from nothing; I exist and I know that I exist with intuitive certainty; therefore there has existed from eternity a most powerful and most knowing being.
- ANALYSIS: It is a **cosmological-style** argument conducted inside an empiricist framework, and it is consistent with Locke's own ladder: God is reached at the **second** degree of knowledge, above the external world and below self-knowledge.
- ANALYSIS: **The exposed premise** is the causal principle that nothing comes from nothing - precisely the principle Hume will later refuse to certify, because there is no impression of causal necessity. This is the cleanest single link between Locke's God and Hume's scepticism, and it belongs in any comparative answer on God in this item.
- WRONG: There is no innate idea of God for Locke; that was one of the candidates Book I dismissed.



## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Locke's theory of personal identity is a theory of accountability, and it survives its classic objections only in a repaired form. **Named evidence.** *Essay* II.xxvii, added in the second edition of 1694, defines a person as a thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places, separates the identity of person from that of man and of substance, illustrates the separation with the prince and the cobbler, and calls "person" a forensic term. **Analysis.** Butler's and Reid's circularity charge and Reid's Brave Officer case both attack the criterion where it is stated as bare episodic memory, so the defensible Lockean position must locate identity in consciousness rather than recollection and must define it through overlapping chains of appropriation rather than through single acts of remembering. **Qualification.** That repair preserves transitivity at the cost of the simple memory criterion, and it does not silence the circularity objection, since consciousness *of a past act as mine* may already presuppose the identity it is meant to constitute - which is why the honest verdict grades the theory as forensically indispensable and metaphysically incomplete.

### Exam link

- **2021 Q1(d), 10 marks** - "Examine the concept of personal identity by Locke." Doctrine from Section 1-4, objections from Section 5, and a graded verdict.
- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** - Locke's account is the position Hume dismantles; the contrast belongs in the first paragraph of that answer.
- Locke's God in Section 6 supplies the comparative material for any "God in the empiricists" question.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                          | Correction                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Calling it simply "the memory theory"         | The constitutive notion is <b>consciousness</b> ; memory is vehicle and evidence |
| Ignoring the person/man/substance distinction | It is the structural core of the chapter                                         |
| Dating the doctrine to 1690                   | II.xxvii is a <b>1694</b> second-edition addition                                |
| Reporting objections without a reply          | "Examine" requires the repair and a verdict                                      |
| Saying Locke has an innate idea of God        | Book I explicitly denies it; the proof is <b>demonstrative</b>                   |

### Revision notes

- Person defined at II.xxvii.9; chapter added 1694.
- Three identities: substance · man (living organism) · person.
- Criterion: extension of consciousness; memory is vehicle and evidence; appropriation is the key verb.
- Prince and cobbler: person follows consciousness, man follows organism.
- Objections: Butler/Reid circularity; Reid's Brave Officer transitivity; gaps.
- Repair: overlapping chains; capacity rather than constant recollection.
- God: demonstrative, cosmological-style; rests on the causal principle Hume later attacks.



## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LOCKE V: SELF AND GOD

QUESTION: WHAT MAKES THE PERSON AT T2 THE SAME AS THE PERSON AT T1?

|  
v

SEPARATE THREE IDENTITIES: SUBSTANCE | MAN (organism) | PERSON

|  
v

PERSON (II.xxvii.9, added 1694) = thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places

|  
v

CRITERION: present consciousness APPROPRIATES a past act

memory = vehicle and evidence, NOT the definition

FORENSIC: the concept is built for accountability

|

---> PRINCE AND COBBLER: person = prince, man = cobbler

|

---> BUTLER/REID CIRCULARITY -> constitutive vs evidential (contested)

---> REID'S BRAVE OFFICER -> OVERLAPPING CHAINS restore transitivity

---> GAPS -> continuous CAPACITY, not constant recollection

|  
v

GOD: demonstrative, not intuitive or sensitive; nothing comes from nothing;

I exist -> an eternal most powerful and most knowing being

EXPOSED PREMISE: the causal principle Hume will refuse to certify

TRAP: "memory theory" | 1690 dating | omitting the objections

ANSWER LINE: forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete

## SESSION 7 - BERKELEY I: THE DESTRUCTION OF ABSTRACTION AND THE NOMINALIST REPLACEMENT

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Berkeley says you cannot form an idea of a colourless extension or of a triangle that is no particular triangle; what you can do is take one perfectly ordinary particular idea and let it stand for all the others of its kind - and once you accept that, the word "matter" turns out to name nothing at all.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's **nominalism** denies the existence of abstract general ideas while affirming general **ideas**: an idea becomes general not by being stripped of determinations but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (*Principles*, Introduction Section 12), and since Locke's *material substance in general* is precisely an abstract general idea, the failure of abstraction makes "matter" a **meaningless expression** rather than an unknown thing.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Berkeley's nominalism is not a side-issue in his system but its foundation: he places the attack on abstract general ideas in the **Introduction** to the *Principles*, before a single word about matter, because his immaterialism is a corollary of it - Locke's "material substance in general" is the abstract idea of being conjoined with the relative notion of supporting, so if no such idea can be framed, matter is not a mysterious unknown but an expression without content.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **separation of what can exist apart** - the abstraction Berkeley allows
- **abstraction proper** - separating what cannot exist apart; this he denies
- **"all and none of these at once"** - Locke's triangle, quoted at Intro Section 13
- **"made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort"** (Intro Section 12)
- **selective attention** - the positive mechanism
- **language does not always stand for ideas** (Intro Section Section 19-20)
- **matter as an abstract general idea** - the metaphysical payload

**How to use them:** run the seven numbered steps, then give the positive replacement with the geometer example, then the payload - and only then move to *to be is to be perceived*. The order matters: abstraction first, matter second.

## Plain-language visual - two kinds of "separating"

| WHAT BERKELEY ADMITS HE CAN DO                           | WHAT HE SAYS NOBODY CAN DO |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| +-----+                                                  | +-----+                    |
| Imagine a HAND without the                               | Imagine EXTENSION with no  |
| rest of the body.                                        | colour at all.             |
| Imagine a HEADLESS torso.                                | Imagine MOTION with no     |
|                                                          | determinate speed.         |
| These parts COULD exist                                  | Imagine A MAN who has no   |
| apart, so the separation is                              | stature and no complexion. |
| legitimate.                                              | These CANNOT exist apart,  |
|                                                          | so the "idea" is empty.    |
| +-----+                                                  | +-----+                    |
| \                                                        | /                          |
| v                                                        | v                          |
| AND LOCKE'S TRIANGLE IS THE WORST CASE:                  |                            |
| "neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral,     |                            |
| equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these      |                            |
| at once." -> that is not an idea; it is a contradiction. |                            |

**In simple words:** Berkeley is not saying imagination is weak. He is saying that "separating" only makes sense where the separated items could exist on their own. You can picture a hand by itself because hands can be severed; you cannot picture extension by itself because nothing extended is colourless. Then he turns to Locke's own sentence and lets it do the work.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                       |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Allowed        | separating parts that could exist apart                       |
| Denied         | separating what cannot exist apart                            |
| The quotation  | Locke's triangle, at <i>Principles</i> Intro Section 13       |
| Replacement    | a determinate particular idea <b>made to stand for</b> a sort |
| Mechanism      | selective attention to a respect of resemblance               |
| Payload        | "matter" is an abstract general idea; so it means nothing     |

**One-line memory:** generality lives in the **use of a sign**, not in a stripped-down picture.

## VISUAL: VISUAL - the seven steps, the replacement and the payload

BERKELEY'S DEMOLITION, NUMBERED                      Principles, Introduction 6-25  
=====

- 1 I concede I can imagine particular things I have perceived, and compound and divide such ideas - a hand without a body, a headless torso. This is SEPARATION OF PARTS THAT COULD EXIST APART.
- 2 But abstraction PROPER requires separating what CANNOT exist apart: extension without any colour; motion without a determinate speed; "man" without any determinate stature or complexion.
- 3 Locke's own triangle - neither equilateral nor scalene, yet all and none at once - is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY; no such idea can be framed. (Berkeley quotes the passage VERBATIM at Intro Sec.13.)
- 4 THEREFORE there are no abstract general ideas.
- 5 POSITIVE REPLACEMENT: an idea is general not by being abstract but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (Intro Sec.12). A determinate particular idea, SELECTIVELY ATTENDED TO, does duty for a class: the geometer draws THIS black inch-long line and proves a theorem about ALL lines.
- 6 COROLLARY AGAINST THE WHOLE TRADITION: words do not always stand for ideas at all; language also raises passion, prompts action and disposes the mind (Intro Sec.19-20).
- 7 METAPHYSICAL PAYLOAD: Locke's MATERIAL SUBSTANCE IN GENERAL and SUBSTRATUM are precisely abstract general ideas - the abstract idea of BEING plus the relative notion of SUPPORTING. If abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a MEANINGLESS EXPRESSION. Immaterialism therefore RESTS ON the nominalism.

=====

|

THE COUNTER-PRESSURE YOU MUST ALSO KNOW

+-----+

|                                                                    |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| If a particular idea stands for a class, what fixes WHICH respect  |  |
| it is attended to under? The resemblance-respect looks like the    |  |
| abstract idea returning under another name. This is the standard   |  |
| modern rejoinder, and it makes the dispute far less one-sided than |  |
| textbooks suggest.                                                 |  |

+-----+

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Step 6 is the step almost no script contains, and it is a genuine anticipation of the later Wittgensteinian point that meaning is use. Flagging it converts a descriptive answer on nominalism into one that shows the argument's reach.

### 1. What the doctrine denies, and what it does not

- FACT: Berkeley denies **abstract general ideas**; he does not deny **general ideas**, general words, or general knowledge. Geometry proceeds perfectly well on his account.
- WRONG: He is therefore not a "nominalist" in the crude sense of denying that classification is possible. His nominalism is about the **vehicle** of generality, not about its legitimacy.

### 2. The argument's dependence on the imagistic reading

ANALYSIS: Step 3 works because Locke's idea is treated as an **image**, and an image cannot be indeterminate. Locke's best reply - that the abstract idea is **partial** rather than **contradictory**, with the angles left undetermined instead of contradictorily assigned - was set out in Session 4. Berkeley's argument therefore proves what it proves **only against imagistic Locke**, and a first-class answer says so.

### 3. The positive account, and its unpaid bill

- FACT: **Selective attention**: I consider *this* determinate triangle only in respect of its three-sidedness, and my proof is valid for all triangles because nothing in it depends on the features I ignored.
- CAUTION: **The bill**: what fixes the respect? If the answer is "a further idea of the respect", the abstract idea has returned; if the answer is "a practice of use", Berkeley has moved beyond the theory of ideas altogether - which is exactly the direction step 6 points.

### 4. Why this is the base of immaterialism

FACT: The order of Berkeley's own book is the order of his argument. Abstraction is destroyed in the Introduction so that in Section Section 1-4 the identification of a sensible thing with a collection of ideas cannot be resisted by appeal to an abstract "something" underlying them. **Berkeley's immaterialism rests on his nominalism, not the reverse** - say this sentence in the 2025 answer and the whole structure becomes visible.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Berkeley's refutation of abstract ideas is the foundation of his immaterialism rather than an independent thesis about psychology. **Named evidence.** In the Introduction to the *Principles* he concedes the separation of parts that could exist apart, denies the separation of what cannot, quotes Locke's own admission at IV.vii.9 that the general triangle is "all and none" of the determinate triangles, replaces abstraction with a determinate idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" at Section 12, and observes at Section Section 19-20 that words need not stand for ideas at all. **Analysis.** Because Locke's *material substance in general* is compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting, the collapse of abstraction converts matter from an unknown thing into an expression with no content, which is why the attack precedes the metaphysics in Berkeley's own order of exposition. **Qualification.** The argument succeeds only against an imagistic conception of ideas, and Berkeley's positive account owes an explanation of what fixes the respect under which a particular idea represents its class - so the durable casualty is the ideational theory of meaning shared by both men rather than generality itself.

### Exam link

- **2025 Q4(c), 15 marks** - "Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas." This session is the answer; Session 4 supplies the doctrine refuted.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** - the payload in Section 4 is why rejecting Locke's primary qualities is *instrumental* rather than merely contributory.
- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** - "Mind and its ideas alone are real" is unintelligible without the anti-abstraction ground clearing.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                      | Correction                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Berkeley denies general ideas"           | He denies <b>abstract</b> general ideas; particular ideas made to stand for a sort are general |
| Presenting nominalism after immaterialism | Berkeley's own order is the reverse, and the order is the argument                             |
| Giving the conclusion without the steps   | "Explain" demands the derivation, not a synonym for the conclusion                             |
| Omitting Section Section 19-20            | The claim that words need not stand for ideas is the argument's longest reach                  |
| Treating the refutation as complete       | The determinable reading of Locke and the respect-of-representation problem both survive       |

### Revision notes

- Allowed: separating parts that could exist apart. Denied: separating what cannot.
- Locke's triangle quoted verbatim at *Principles* Intro Section 13.
- Replacement at Section 12: a particular idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort".
- Mechanism: selective attention; example: the geometer's inch-long line.
- Section Section 19-20: words also raise passion, prompt action, dispose the mind.
- Payload: matter = abstract idea of being + relative notion of supporting -> meaningless.
- Counter-pressure: what fixes the respect of representation?

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - BERKELEY I: ANTI-ABSTRACTION

LOCKE: GENERALITY LIVES IN A STRIPPED-DOWN ABSTRACT IDEA

|  
v

BERKELEY, PRINCIPLES INTRODUCTION Sec.6-25

- 1 separation of parts that COULD exist apart: ALLOWED
- 2 separation of what CANNOT exist apart: IMPOSSIBLE
- 3 Locke's triangle "all and none" is self-contradictory (quoted, Sec.13)
- 4 therefore NO abstract general ideas
- 5 REPLACEMENT (Sec.12): a determinate particular idea "made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort"
  - selective attention; the geometer's inch-long line
- 6 words do not always stand for ideas at all (Sec.19-20)
- 7 PAYLOAD: matter = abstract idea of BEING + relative notion of SUPPORTING
  - > not unknown but MEANINGLESS

|  
v

IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON NOMINALISM, NOT THE REVERSE

|

- +--> LIMIT 1: works only against IMAGISTIC Locke (determinable reply)
- +--> LIMIT 2: what fixes the RESPECT of representation?

TRAP: "denies general ideas" | wrong order | conclusion without derivation

ANSWER LINE: generality lives in the use of a sign, not in a stripped picture

## SESSION 8 - BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR IMMATERIALISM AND WHAT "TO BE IS TO BE PERCEIVED" CLAIMS

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Berkeley holds that a chair is nothing more than the collection of sights, sounds and feels you get from it, that for such things existing just *is* being perceived, and that the extra "matter" philosophers place behind them is an empty word - so the chair is exactly as real as it ever was, and only the philosopher's ghost has been removed.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's **immaterialism** or **subjective idealism** holds that sensible things are collections of ideas immediately perceived, that for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (*esse est percipi*) (*Principles* Section 3), and that "material substance" - an unperceiving, unperceivable substratum - is an incoherent abstraction; reality consists of **spirits** and their **ideas**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

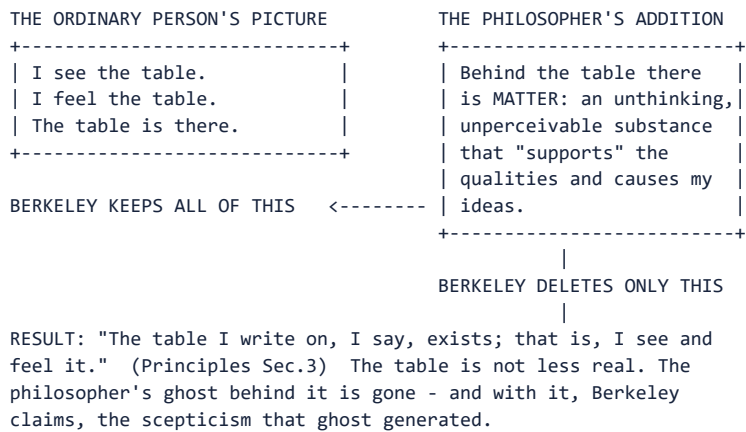
*To be is to be perceived* is a conclusion, not a slogan, and the difference between an average and a first-class answer on Berkeley is whether the five supporting arguments are named: the **semantic** identification of sensible things with ideas, the **likeness** principle, the **parity** collapse of the quality distinction, the **Master Argument** about conceiving the unconceived, and the argument from **continuity** to an infinite spirit - five arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **sensible things** - things immediately perceived by sense
- **collection of ideas** - the identification that carries the system
- **to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)** - *Principles* Section 3, Berkeley's own Latin
- **likeness principle** - "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" (Section 8)
- **parity argument** - relativity applies equally to primary qualities (Section Section 9-15)
- **Master Argument** - conceive an unconceived body (Section Section 22-23)
- **absolute existence without relation to being perceived** - the phrase Berkeley calls unintelligible

**How to use them:** name all five arguments, give the presupposition of each, and give the strongest objection to at least two. That structure alone answers 2018 Q3(a) and 2021 Q1(c) and half of 2024 Q2(a).

## Plain-language visual - what is actually being denied



**In simple words:** Berkeley thinks the materialist invented an unknowable world and then worried about whether we can reach it. Remove the unknowable world and the worry disappears. This is why he calls himself the defender of common sense and calls the materialist the sceptic - a reversal that must be stated in any answer or the position will be misdescribed.

| Remember first          | Meaning                                                        |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sensible thing          | what is <b>immediately</b> perceived by sense                  |
| The identification      | an apple, a stone, a tree, a book = collections of ideas       |
| <i>Esse est percipi</i> | for <b>sensible things</b> , existence = being perceived       |
| What is denied          | matter as an unperceiving substratum                           |
| What is kept            | tables, chairs, the order of nature, science, other minds, God |
| Direction of attack     | the materialist is the sceptic, not Berkeley                   |

**One-line memory:** Berkeley deletes the **substratum**, never the **table**.

## VISUAL: VISUAL - five arguments, five presuppositions, three objections

### ARGUMENT 1 - SEMANTIC / ANALYTIC Principles Sec.1-4

1 The objects of human knowledge are ideas: (a) imprinted on the senses, (b) perceived by attending to the passions and operations of the mind, (c) formed by memory and imagination.

2 "Sensible things" MEANS things immediately perceived by sense.

3 An apple, a stone, a tree, a book are nothing but collections of such immediately perceived ideas.

4 It is impossible that ideas should exist unperceived - their esse is percipi.

5 THEREFORE for sensible things esse est percipi, and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible.

PRESUPPOSITION: step 3 is a DEFINITION, not a discovery. Grant it and immaterialism follows in four lines; deny it and nothing follows.

### ARGUMENT 2 - THE LIKENESS PRINCIPLE Principles Sec.8

1 Locke says ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE qualities in bodies.

2 But "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" - a colour or figure can be like nothing but another colour or figure.

3 If the supposed originals are unperceivable, no comparison with them is even possible; a resemblance we could never check is empty.

4 THEREFORE the representative-realist resemblance is unintelligible.

PRESUPPOSITION: resemblance requires comparability by a perceiver.

OBJECTION: structural/mathematical resemblance (ISOMORPHISM) needs no qualitative likeness - a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. This is the standard modern rescue of Locke.

### ARGUMENT 3 - PARITY Principles Sec.9-15; Dial. I

Every relativity argument Locke accepts for secondary qualities - variation with observer, with organ, with medium - applies equally to primary ones: apparent size with distance, motion with frame of reference, shape with angle. So ALL qualities are ideas, and nothing is left for "material substance" to be.

PRESUPPOSITION: perceptual relativity entails mind-dependence.

OBJECTION: it does not - looking different from different positions is what one should expect of a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with a real shape.

### ARGUMENT 4 - THE MASTER ARGUMENT Principles Sec.22-23

1 Conceive one extended movable body existing unconceived, and Berkeley concedes materialism.

2 You reply: I easily conceive a tree standing alone in a park with nobody by.

3 But in doing so YOU are conceiving it - you have framed ideas in your own mind and have not conceived the tree UNCONCEIVED at all.

4 THEREFORE the supposition is self-refuting.

PRESUPPOSITION (the fatal one): that conceiving "X existing unconceived" requires the act of conceiving to be part of the CONTENT conceived.

OBJECTION (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois): a SCOPE or use-mention confusion. What is inconceivable is "I conceive of X THAT IT IS NOT CONCEIVED BY ME"; what is required is only "I conceive THAT X exists and is not conceived" - perfectly coherent, exactly as I can think ABOUT an unthought-of number.

BERKELEY'S BEST REPLY: for him there is no object over and above the idea, so the distinction the objector needs is precisely what is at issue - the argument begs the question only if immaterialism is already false.

### ARGUMENT 5 - GOD AS GUARANTOR OF CONTINUITY Sec.6, 30-33, 48; Dial. II

1 Ideas are passive and inert; they cannot cause anything.

2 Yet the ideas of sense come to me INVOLUNTARILY, in steady order.

3 Whatever produces them must be an ACTIVE SPIRIT whose power and wisdom exceed mine.

4 THEREFORE God. The "laws of nature" are the settled grammar of God's language of ideas: regularities are SIGNS, not causes.

5 THEREFORE objects persist unperceived by finite minds because they are always perceived by the infinite Mind.

PRESUPPOSITION: only spirits are active causes (Berkeley's voluntarism).

OBJECTION: this makes "existence unperceived" a hypothesis about an unobserved being - the very move Berkeley forbade Locke.

REPLY: spirit is known not by IDEA but by NOTION (Sec.27, 89, 140) - an asymmetry critics call ad hoc, but which Berkeley holds is forced, since an idea, being passive, could never picture activity.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Naming the five arguments - semantic, likeness, parity, master, continuity - is the single largest available differentiator on this sub-topic. Add one presupposition and one objection and the answer is already in the top band.

### 1. The formula, stated with its scope

- FACT: For **sensible things**, existence is being perceived: "The table I write on, I say, exists; that is, I see and feel it" (*Principles* Section 3).
- ANALYSIS: The scope restriction is not a technicality. *Esse est percipi* applies to **sensible ideas**; spirits are active perceivers and willers, and are known by **notion**, not as passive perceived ideas.
- ANALYSIS: **Provenance mark:** the expanded formula "to be is to be perceived or to perceive" (*esse est percipi aut percipere*) is a **later commentators' expansion** to accommodate spirits. Do not present it as Berkeley's quoted Latin.

### 2. What immaterialism deletes and what it keeps

- WRONG: Deleted: **material substance** - an unthinking, unperceiving, unperceivable substratum.
- FACT: Kept: tables and chairs (as orderly collections of ideas), the distinction between real things and imagination, natural law, science, other minds, and God.
- FACT: **Reality = minds (spirits) + their ideas.** This is subjective idealism, also called immaterialism.

### 3. Berkeley "saves" common sense - the reversal

- FACT: Berkeley insists he is not denying the reality of tables and chairs; he denies only the **philosopher's fiction** of matter. The ordinary person never believed in Locke's veil of perception: they believe they perceive things *directly* - and so does Berkeley.
- FACT: He accuses the **materialists** of undermining common sense by positing an unknowable world behind appearances, and of thereby manufacturing the sceptical problem they then fail to solve.
- ANALYSIS: **Assessment worth including:** the defence is strong about *objects* and weaker about *causes*, because the plain man does think fire heats water, whereas for Berkeley fire is a sign and God is the cause.

### 4. Illusion, science and other minds - the four objections he must answer

| Objection                                               | Berkeley's answer                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What distinguishes reality from imagination?            | Ideas of sense are involuntary, vivid, coherent and law-governed; ideas of imagination are comparatively voluntary and irregular                                               |
| What about illusions - the bent oar, the distant tower? | The presented idea genuinely exists; error lies in the <b>judgment</b> about which further ideas will follow, not in the existence of what is perceived                        |
| Does this destroy science?                              | No. Natural laws describe stable sequences in God's language of ideas and support prediction; what is denied is material efficient power behind them, not empirical regularity |
| Does this leave only me - solipsism?                    | Other finite spirits are not perceived as ideas but inferred by <b>analogy</b> from purposive signs and behaviour, while God explains the comprehensive involuntary order      |

ANALYSIS: Honest residual: this blocks crude solipsism, but knowledge of other spirits and of God is **less immediate** than awareness of one's own activity and of the ideas presented.

### 5. Why Berkeley is an anti-sceptic

- FACT: He claims to **refute** scepticism: it is the materialist who produces doubt by positing an unknowable world behind ideas. By identifying reality with ideas immediately perceived, Berkeley claims certainty, and God guarantees continuity.
- FACT: His idealism is therefore **dogmatic theistic idealism** - a metaphysical thesis about what exists, not a doubt about knowledge.
- WRONG: Never classify Berkeley as a sceptic, and never write that he denies the external world.



## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Berkeley establishes that minds and their ideas alone are real by five distinct arguments, only one of which is the notorious challenge about conceiving an unconceived object. **Named evidence.** *Principles* Section Section 1-4 identify sensible things with collections of immediately perceived ideas; Section 8 denies that an idea can be like anything but an idea; Section Section 9-15 extend Locke's own relativity arguments from secondary to primary qualities; Section Section 22-23 challenge the reader to conceive an unconceived body; and Section Section 6, 30-33 and 48 infer an infinite active spirit from the involuntary, law-governed order of sense. **Analysis.** The arguments are not redundant: the semantic argument fixes what a sensible thing is, the likeness principle removes the representative relation, the parity argument removes the last quality that might have belonged to matter, the Master Argument blocks the intuitive rejoinder, and the continuity argument supplies the positive metaphysics that replaces the deleted substratum. **Qualification.** Each rests on a contestable premise - the identification in Section 3 is a definition, relativity does not entail mind-dependence, and the Master Argument arguably confuses conceiving *that* an object is unconceived with conceiving *of* it as unconceived - so the system is best judged as internally economical rather than as demonstratively established.

### Exam link

- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** - "Sensible things are those only which are immediately perceived by sense." Argument 1 is the direct answer; the word **immediately** is the hinge.
- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** - "How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real?" is answered by naming all five arguments before turning to Moore and Russell.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** - arguments 2 and 3 are the "rejection of Locke's primary qualities" limb.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                                              | Correction                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Berkeley denies the external world"                                              | He denies <b>matter</b> ; the world of tables and chairs remains, as ideas sustained by God |
| Quoting <i>esse est percipi aut percipere</i> as Berkeley's Latin                 | The expansion is a later commentators' gloss; Section 3 gives only <i>esse est percipi</i>  |
| Reducing the case to the Master Argument                                          | It is the weakest of the five and the easiest to answer                                     |
| Answering "immediately perceived" without contrasting Locke's mediated perception | The whole point of <i>immediately</i> is the denial of the veil                             |
| Calling him a sceptic                                                             | He is an <b>anti-sceptic</b> who blames scepticism on the materialist                       |

### Revision notes

- Five arguments: semantic (Section Section 1-4) · likeness (Section 8) · parity (Section Section 9-15) · master (Section Section 22-23) · continuity (Section Section 6, 30-33, 48).
- *Esse est percipi* at Section 3, scoped to **sensible things**; spirits are known by notion.
- Deletes matter; keeps objects, science, other minds, God.
- Reality distinguished from imagination by involuntariness, vividness, coherence and law.
- Illusion concerns judgment, not the existence of the presented idea.
- Anti-sceptic: the materialist invents the unknowable world.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - BERKELEY II: THE FIVE ARGUMENTS

SENSIBLE THING = WHAT IS IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED BY SENSE  
|  
v  
FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR "MIND AND ITS IDEAS ALONE ARE REAL"  
1 SEMANTIC (Sec.1-4): objects = collections of ideas -> esse est percipi  
2 LIKENESS (Sec.8): an idea can be like only an idea  
3 PARITY (Sec.9-15): relativity hits primary qualities too  
4 MASTER (Sec.22-23): you cannot conceive the unconceived  
5 CONTINUITY (Sec.6, 30-33, 48): involuntary order -> infinite active spirit  
|  
+--> PRESUPPOSITIONS: definition | comparability | relativity=dependence |  
| content of conceiving | only spirits act  
+--> OBJECTIONS: isomorphism rescues Locke | relativity is what a real  
| shape produces | scope/use-mention confusion (Russell, Prior, Gallois)  
|  
v  
DELETES: material substratum    KEEPS: tables, science, other minds, God  
REALITY vs IMAGINATION: involuntary, vivid, coherent, law-governed  
ILLUSION: error is in JUDGMENT, not in the existence of the idea  
|  
v  
ANTI-SCEPTIC: the materialist invented the unknowable world  
TRAP: "denies the world" | percipere as Berkeley's Latin | master-argument-only  
ANSWER LINE: Berkeley deletes the substratum, never the table

## SESSION 9 - BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, NOTIONS, GOD, CONTINUITY, AND THE MOORE, RUSSELL AND HEGEL COMPARISONS

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Having deleted matter, Berkeley must say what is left: active minds, which he calls spirits, and the ideas they perceive; we know minds not by having a picture of them but by a different kind of awareness he calls a notion, and the biggest mind of all - God - is what keeps the world running when nobody human is looking.

**Technical definition:** Berkeley's positive ontology consists of **spirits** - active, indivisible substances that perceive and will - and their **ideas**, which are passive and inert; spirits are known by **notion** rather than by idea (*Principles* Section 27, 89, 140), and the infinite spirit, **God**, causes the involuntary order of sense and secures the continued existence of sensible things unperceived by finite minds.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Berkeley's God is not a piece of piety appended to an epistemology but the load-bearing member of it: having argued that ideas are passive and that only spirits act, he must explain why the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily and in a settled order, and the infinite spirit that supplies both the cause and the continuity is doing exactly the work Locke's matter had done - which is why the strongest criticism of immaterialism is not that it is impious but that it replaces an unknowable **substance** with an unperceivable **spirit**.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **spirit** - active, perceiving, willing; the only substance Berkeley retains
- **notion** - the non-idea awareness by which spirit is known
- **passivity of ideas** - the premise that forces an external cause
- **language of nature** - laws are the settled grammar of signs, not causes
- **continuity** - unperceived things persist because God perceives them
- **subjective idealism** versus **absolute idealism**
- **act-object distinction** - Moore's line of attack
- **logical construction** - Russell's alternative

**How to use them:** derive God from the passivity of ideas rather than asserting him; then take the two comparisons the papers actually demand - Moore and Russell in 2018, Hegel in 2024 - and treat them as matched axes, not as separate essays.

### Plain-language visual - why Berkeley cannot stop at "ideas"

STEP 1 Look at what you perceive right now. You did not choose it.  
You cannot make the window vanish by willing it.

|  
STEP 2 Ideas are PASSIVE - a colour does not do anything.  
So an idea cannot be the cause of another idea.

|  
STEP 3 Something ACTIVE must be producing them.  
Not me: I did not choose them, and I cannot stop them.

|  
STEP 4 Only SPIRITS are active. So an OTHER spirit is producing them,  
one whose power and wisdom exceed mine.

|  
STEP 5 That spirit is GOD - and because he always perceives, the tree  
in the quad does not blink out when you leave the quadrangle.

NOTE THE COST: Berkeley now knows something he cannot have an idea of.  
He answers: spirit is known by NOTION, not by idea, because an idea is  
passive and could never picture an activity. Critics call this ad hoc.

**In simple words:** Berkeley's argument for God is an argument from **involuntariness plus order**. It is not "somebody must be watching or things would vanish" as a nervous afterthought; it is the only available cause once ideas are declared inert. Present it as a derivation and the answer looks structural rather than devotional.

| Remember first | Meaning                                                               |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ideas          | passive, inert, cannot cause                                          |
| Spirits        | active; perceive and will; not perceived as ideas                     |
| Notion         | the awareness we have of spirit, of relations and of activity         |
| God            | the infinite spirit; cause of sense-ideas and guarantor of continuity |
| Laws of nature | the settled grammar of a divine language; <b>signs</b> , not causes   |
| Other minds    | inferred by analogy from purposive signs                              |

**One-line memory:** ideas are **inert**, so the order of nature needs an **agent** - and that agent, not matter, is what sustains the unperceived.

## VISUAL: VISUAL - the ontology, the two comparisons and the exact contrasts

### BERKELEY'S FINAL ONTOLOGY

| SPIRITS (active substances) |                                | IDEAS (passive)  |  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------|--|
| +-----+                     |                                | +-----+          |  |
| GOD                         | infinite spirit  --produces--> | ideas of SENSE   |  |
| +-----+                     |                                | +-----+          |  |
|                             | sustains continuity            | involuntary,     |  |
|                             | v                              | vivid, coherent, |  |
| +-----+                     |                                | +-----+          |  |
| FINITE SPIRITS              | --produces-->                  | ideas of         |  |
| known: my own by            |                                | IMAGINATION      |  |
| inner awareness;            |                                | voluntary,       |  |
| others by ANALOGY           |                                | faint, irregular |  |
| +-----+                     |                                | +-----+          |  |

KNOWN BY: notion (Sec.27, 89, 140)      KNOWN BY: immediate perception

### COMPARISON A - THE 2018 QUESTION: MOORE AND RUSSELL AGAINST BERKELEY

| AXIS                              | MOORE                                                                                                                                      | RUSSELL                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core attack                       | the idealist conflates the ACT of awareness with its OBJECT: awareness of blue is not identical with blue                                  | idealism mistakes the data of sense for the whole of the object                                 |
| Positive result                   | DIRECT REALISM: the object is presented THROUGH but not CONSTITUTED BY consciousness (transparency of sensation)                           | LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION: objects are inferred or built from sense-data, perspectives and relations |
| Method                            | analysis of common-sense certainties                                                                                                       | analysis into structure                                                                         |
| Shared ground                     | both refuse to reduce object to act or idea                                                                                                |                                                                                                 |
| The DIFFERENCE the examiner wants | Moore keeps the ordinary object and calls it directly known; Russell REPLACES it with a construction and keeps only STRUCTURAL objectivity |                                                                                                 |

### COMPARISON B - THE 2024 QUESTION: BERKELEY VERSUS HEGEL

| AXIS                           | BERKELEY - SUBJECTIVE                                                                                                                                                    | HEGEL - ABSOLUTE                                              |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Basic reality                  | finite spirits, God, ideas                                                                                                                                               | self-developing Absolute Spirit                               |
| Why objects are mind-dependent | sensible existence CONSISTS in being perceived                                                                                                                           | objectivity is a MOMENT within dialectical self-development   |
| Role of the divine/system      | an infinite PERCEIVER who causes and coordinates ideas                                                                                                                   | not an external perceiver preserving private idea-collections |
| Method                         | anti-abstraction plus immaterialist argument                                                                                                                             | dialectical development through determinate negation          |
| VERDICT                        | both reject self-subsisting matter as final reality, but theistic SUBJECTIVE idealism is NOT an early version of OBJECTIVE/ABSOLUTE idealism - the difference is in KIND |                                                               |

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Both comparisons are examiner-set, and both are lost by scripts that write two separate mini-essays. Use matched axes: attack, positive result, method, verdict.

#### 1. Spirit - the one substance that survives

- FACT: The perceiving mind is a **real active substance**: it is the perceiver, not a bundle of perceptions. Berkeley **keeps the self**, which is exactly where Hume will refuse to follow him.
- FACT: We have no **idea** of spirit, because ideas are passive and the mind is active; we have a **notion** of it - a direct awareness that does not fit the impression-to-idea schema.

- ANALYSIS: **The asymmetry and its defence:** critics call the notion doctrine ad hoc. Berkeley's reply is that it is *forced*: an idea, being passive, could never picture an activity, so if activity is known at all it must be known otherwise. The reply is principled; whether it is sufficient is CAUTION: genuinely disputed.

## 2. God - derived, not assumed

1. Ideas are passive and inert; they cannot cause anything.
  2. Yet the ideas of sense come to me involuntarily and in a steady, regular order.
  3. Whatever produces them must be an active spirit, and one whose power and wisdom exceed mine.
  4. Therefore God, and the "laws of nature" are the settled grammar of God's **language** of ideas - regularities are **signs**, not causes.
  5. Therefore objects persist unperceived by finite minds because they are always perceived by the infinite Mind.
- FACT: "Does the tree exist when no one perceives it?" - **Yes**, because God always perceives it.
  - FACT: Berkeley thus uses empiricist premises to **defend theism**: the material world is replaced by God's continual ideation, and his idealism is **theocentric**, not sceptical.
  - ANALYSIS: **The strongest objection:** this makes "existence unperceived" into a hypothesis about an unobserved being - the very move Berkeley forbade Locke. His answer is the notion doctrine of Section 1.

## 3. Common sense, and the honest limit of the defence

- FACT: Berkeley claims to be closer to common sense than the representative realist, because the plain man believes he perceives things directly and never believed in a veil.
- ANALYSIS: The claim is strong about **objects** and weaker about **causes**: the plain man also believes that fire heats water, whereas for Berkeley fire is a sign and God is the agent. Concede this and the answer reads as an assessment rather than a defence brief.
- ANALYSIS: **The Johnson anecdote** - kicking a stone with "I refute it thus!" - is **reception, not refutation**. Berkeley never denied that the stone is felt; the kick confirms an idea of resistance, which is precisely what he says a stone is.

## 4. Moore and Russell - the 2018 comparison, decided

- FACT: **Moore** attacks the idealist inference from "experienced" to "dependent on experience" by distinguishing an **act of awareness** from its **object**: the awareness of blue is not identical with blue. His transparency argument supports **direct realism** - the object is presented *through*, but not constituted by, consciousness.
- FACT: **Russell** also rejects Berkeleyan idealism, but develops an **analytical reconstruction**: ordinary physical objects are inferred or logically constructed from sense-data, perspectives and relations rather than accepted through Moorean direct realism.
- ANALYSIS: **Common ground**: both resist reducing object to act or idea. **The difference**: Moore stresses the act-object distinction and common-sense directness; Russell stresses logical construction and structural objectivity - so Moore *defends* the ordinary object while Russell *replaces* it.

## 5. Berkeley and Hegel - the 2024 comparison, decided

- FACT: For Berkeley, reality is ideas in **finite and divine minds**; for Hegel, reality is the self-development of **Absolute Spirit** through dialectic.
- FACT: Berkeley's idealism is **subjective** - mind-dependence of sensible existence; Hegel's is **objective or absolute** - Mind developing itself as the world's substance.
- ANALYSIS: **The verdict sentence:** they agree only in refusing independently self-subsisting matter as final reality. Berkeley's God is an infinite **perceiver** who coordinates idea-collections; Hegel's Absolute is not an external perceiver at all. Calling Berkeley "an early Hegel" is a category error, and 2024 Q2(a) is testing exactly that discrimination.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Berkeley's God is a structural requirement of immaterialism rather than a devotional addition, and this is what fixes both the strength and the vulnerability of his idealism. **Named evidence.** *Principles* Section Section 6, 30-33 and 48 argue that ideas are passive, that the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily in a settled order, and that only an active spirit of greater power and wisdom can produce them, while Section Section 27, 89 and 140 introduce the doctrine that spirits are known by notion rather than by idea. **Analysis.** Since the infinite spirit both causes sense-ideas and secures their continuity when finite minds look away, God performs precisely the two functions Locke had assigned to matter, so immaterialism should be assessed as a substitution of explanatory posits rather than as their elimination. **Qualification.** The substitution is not obviously an advance, because an unperceivable spirit known only by notion is exposed to the same complaint Berkeley levelled at an unperceivable substratum - although his reply that a passive idea could never picture an activity gives the asymmetry a principled and not merely convenient basis.

### Exam link

- **2018 Q3(a), 20 marks** - Section Section 1-2 establish "Mind and its ideas alone are real"; Section 4 supplies both reactions **and** the difference between them, which is the third limb of that question.
- **2024 Q2(a), 20 marks** - Section 5 is the second limb, and it must be answered on matched axes.
- **2021 Q1(c), 10 marks** - Section 3 supplies the common-sense framing that makes "immediately perceived" more than a slogan.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                         | Correction                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Treating God as an afterthought              | God is derived from the passivity of ideas; present the derivation                          |
| Saying Berkeley has an <i>idea</i> of spirit | He has a <b>notion</b> ; ideas are passive and cannot picture activity                      |
| Using Johnson's stone as a refutation        | It is reception; the felt resistance is exactly what Berkeley calls the stone               |
| Writing Moore and Russell as one reaction    | 2018 explicitly asks for the <b>difference</b> : direct realism versus logical construction |
| Calling Berkeley an early Hegel              | Subjective versus absolute idealism differ in kind, not degree                              |

### Revision notes

- Ontology: spirits (active) + ideas (passive); no third category.
- Spirit known by **notion** (Section Section 27, 89, 140), not by idea.
- God derived: inert ideas + involuntary order -> an active infinite spirit; continuity follows.
- Laws of nature = the settled grammar of a divine language; signs, not causes.
- Other minds by analogy; solipsism blocked but knowledge of spirits is less immediate.
- Moore: act-object distinction, direct realism. Russell: logical construction, structural objectivity.
- Berkeley subjective and theistic; Hegel absolute and dialectical - different in kind.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - BERKELEY III: SPIRITS, GOD AND THE COMPARISONS

IDEAS ARE PASSIVE -> THEY CANNOT CAUSE ANYTHING  
|  
v  
SENSE-IDEAS ARRIVE INVOLUNTARILY AND IN SETTLED ORDER  
|  
v  
ONLY SPIRITS ACT -> AN INFINITE SPIRIT PRODUCES THEM = GOD  
|  
+--> CONTINUITY: the unperceived persists because God perceives it  
+--> LAWS OF NATURE = the grammar of a divine language; SIGNS not causes  
+--> SPIRIT KNOWN BY NOTION (Sec.27, 89, 140), not by idea  
+--> OTHER MINDS by ANALOGY from purposive signs  
|  
v  
OBJECTION: an unperceivable spirit repeats the fault of an unknowable substratum  
REPLY: a passive idea could never picture activity - the asymmetry is forced  
|  
v  
2018 COMPARISON: MOORE act-object distinction -> DIRECT REALISM  
RUSSELL sense-data + relations -> LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION  
difference: Moore DEFENDS the object, Russell REPLACES it  
2024 COMPARISON: BERKELEY subjective + theistic vs HEGEL absolute + dialectical  
different in KIND, not degree  
TRAP: God as afterthought | "idea of spirit" | Johnson's stone as refutation  
ANSWER LINE: God does matter's old job, which is the real question about the system

## SESSION 10 - HUME I: IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE COPY PRINCIPLE, ASSOCIATION, THE FORK, AND THE DISSOLUTION OF SUBSTANCE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Hume divides everything in the mind into vivid originals and faint copies, insists that every simple copy must have had an original, sorts all enquiry into two boxes - what can be worked out by thinking alone and what must be found out by experience - and then asks which box "substance" belongs in. It fits neither.

**Technical definition:** Hume's science of human nature divides all **perceptions** into forceful **impressions** and their faint **ideas**, states the **copy principle** that every simple idea derives from a corresponding simple impression, explains the mind's connections by three principles of **association** - resemblance, contiguity and cause and effect - and demarcates enquiry by the **fork** between **relations of ideas** and **matters of fact**, with the consequence that "substance", lacking any source impression, is a **fiction of the imagination**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume's forensic method has a single form that he applies to substance, to the self and to causal power alike: name the alleged idea, demand the impression from which it is copied, and if none can be produced, reclassify the idea as a fiction produced by the imagination - so the destructive results are not separate discoveries but one instrument used three times, and the instrument itself, the copy principle, is an empirical generalisation Hume admits admits an exception.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **perceptions -> impressions and ideas** - the exhaustive division
- **force and vivacity** - the criterion distinguishing them
- **copy principle** - every simple idea copies a simple impression
- **missing shade of blue** - the exception Hume concedes
- **association: resemblance, contiguity, cause and effect**
- **relations of ideas** versus **matters of fact** - the fork
- **"commit it then to the flames"** - *Enquiry* XII, aimed at divinity or school metaphysics
- **fiction of the imagination** - the verdict on substance

**How to use them:** state the division and the copy principle, then apply the test to substance in three lines, then set out the fork as a table, and finally concede the missing shade **before** the examiner can use it against you.

### Plain-language visual - the test, run once

```

THE HUMEAN AUDIT applied here to "SUBSTANCE"
+-----+
| Q1 What idea are you claiming to have? |
| -> "an underlying something that HAS the qualities" |
+-----+
| Q2 From which IMPRESSION was that idea copied? |
| -> Look. You find yellow. Heavy. Malleable. Shiny. |
| You never find the HAVER, only the HAD. |
+-----+
| Q3 No impression? Then what produced the idea? |
| -> The imagination. Qualities that constantly go together |
| are grouped, and a "support" is INVENTED for them. |
+-----+
| VERDICT: "substance" is a FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION - |
| and this applies to MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance |
| alike. Berkeley kept spirit; Hume does not. |
+-----+

```

**In simple words:** Hume does not argue that there is no substance. He argues that you cannot say what you mean by it, because you cannot produce the experience the word was supposed to name. That is a claim about **content**, and keeping it a claim about content rather than about existence is what protects the answer from the standard misreading.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Impressions        | vivid, forceful originals: sensations, passions, emotions    |
| Ideas              | faint copies used in thinking and remembering                |
| Copy principle     | every <b>simple</b> idea derives from a simple impression    |
| Association        | resemblance · contiguity in time or place · cause and effect |
| Relations of ideas | a priori, necessary; denial is self-contradictory            |
| Matters of fact    | a posteriori, contingent; the contrary is always conceivable |

**One-line memory:** no impression, no legitimate idea - and no third box beyond the fork.



## VISUAL: VISUAL - the architecture of the mind, the fork and the first casualty

ALL CONTENTS OF THE MIND = PERCEPTIONS

| IMPRESSIONS (force and vivacity) |        | IDEAS (faint copies) |  |
|----------------------------------|--------|----------------------|--|
| +-----+                          |        | +-----+              |  |
| of SENSATION: colours,           | copied | memory: retains      |  |
| sounds, tastes, pains            | -----> | order and vivacity   |  |
| of REFLECTION: passions,         |        | imagination: free    |  |
| emotions, the felt               |        | to separate and      |  |
| determination of the mind        |        | recombine            |  |
| +-----+                          |        | +-----+              |  |

COPY PRINCIPLE: every SIMPLE idea derives from a corresponding SIMPLE impression. COMPLEX ideas may be new combinations (a golden mountain). CONCEDED EXCEPTION - THE MISSING SHADE OF BLUE (Treatise I.i.1; Enquiry II): a man acquainted with every shade of blue but one, shown the spectrum with a gap, can form the idea of the missing shade from imagination alone. Hume calls the instance "so singular" that he will not alter the maxim. WHY IT MATTERS FOR MARKS: it shows the copy principle is an EMPIRICAL GENERALISATION, not an analytic truth - so the demolitions of substance, self and necessary connexion rest on a premise Hume admits has an exception. HUME'S AVAILABLE REPLY: the shade is generated by INTERPOLATION BETWEEN impressions actually had, so the principle's SPIRIT survives its LETTER.

THE THREE PRINCIPLES OF ASSOCIATION - the mind's gentle force  
RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY in time/place | CAUSE AND EFFECT  
These are not logical relations; they are the psychological mechanism that later explains BOTH the fiction of the self AND causal belief.

HUME'S FORK

|                              |  |                               |  |
|------------------------------|--|-------------------------------|--|
| +-----+                      |  | +-----+                       |  |
| RELATIONS OF IDEAS           |  | MATTERS OF FACT               |  |
| known a priori, by thought   |  | known a posteriori, require   |  |
| alone                        |  | experience                    |  |
| necessary and certain;       |  | contingent; the contrary is   |  |
| denial is self-contradictory |  | always conceivable            |  |
| "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is      |  | "the sun will rise tomorrow"; |  |
| unmarried"                   |  | "fire causes heat"            |  |
| do not depend on what exists |  | depend on how the world       |  |
| in the world                 |  | actually is                   |  |
| +-----+                      |  | +-----+                       |  |

CONSEQUENCE: anything that is NEITHER is meaningless - "commit it then to the flames" (Enquiry XII), aimed at divinity or school metaphysics. ANCESTRY: this is the direct ancestor of the logical positivists' verification principle - a link worth one clause, not a paragraph.

FIRST CASUALTY: SUBSTANCE

no impression of a substrate -> "substance" is a FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION -> both MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance dissolve -> an object is a stable BUNDLE of co-occurring qualities

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The fork must be drawn as a table, because the 2018 question is decided by placing two sentences correctly inside it. Do not let it become prose.

### 1. The division, and the criterion

- FACT: All contents of the mind are **perceptions**, dividing into **impressions** - vivid, forceful, original experiences (sensations, passions) - and **ideas**, their faint copies used in memory and imagination.
- ANALYSIS: The criterion is **force and vivacity**, a difference of degree. Hume accepts that in fever or madness the difference can blur; the classification is a working psychology, not a definition by essence.

### 2. The copy principle, stated with its exception

- FACT: Every simple **idea** traces back to a corresponding simple **impression**. If no source impression can be located, the alleged idea is suspect, obscure or fictitious.
- ANALYSIS: Note the precision that protects marks: for Hume the failure makes the idea **fictitious or obscure**, not automatically "meaningless" in the later logical-positivist sense. The stronger reading belongs to Topic 07.
- CAUTION: **The missing shade of blue** (*Treatise* I.i.1; *Enquiry* II) is Hume's own conceded counter-example, and he calls it "so singular" that it is not worth altering his general maxim for it.
- ANALYSIS: **Why it earns marks:** deploying it converts a descriptive answer into a critical one, because it shows the copy principle to be an empirical generalisation rather than an analytic truth. **Hume's available reply:** the

missing shade is generated by interpolation *between* impressions actually had, so the principle's spirit survives even if its letter does not.

### 3. Association - the engine of everything that follows

- FACT: Ideas are ordinarily connected through **resemblance**, **contiguity in time or place**, and **cause and effect**.
- ANALYSIS: Association is a **psychological** mechanism, not a logical relation, and it is decisive later: resemblance and causation together produce the fiction of a unified self, and repeated conjunction produces the felt determination that Hume identifies as the source of the idea of necessary connexion. Naming association early makes the later sessions look inevitable rather than surprising.

### 4. The fork, and the 2018 question it decides

| Relations of ideas                               | Matters of fact                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Known a priori; discoverable by thought alone    | Known a posteriori; require experience                     |
| Necessary, certain; denial is self-contradictory | Contingent; the contrary is always conceivable             |
| Examples: "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is unmarried"     | Examples: "the sun will rise tomorrow"; "fire causes heat" |
| Do not depend on what exists in the world        | Depend on how the world actually is                        |

- FACT: **Consequence**: any proposition that is neither a relation of ideas nor a matter of fact is meaningless - "commit it then to the flames" (*Enquiry* XII).
- ANALYSIS: **The 2018 answer in one line**: "2+2=4" is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory; "the sun will rise tomorrow" is a matter of fact whose denial remains perfectly conceivable. They are **not** of the same necessity, and saying they are equally probable is the error the question is designed to catch.
- CAUTION: **The reflexive objection**: is the fork itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it refutes itself. Hume's available answer is that it is a clarification of the meanings of terms - a meta-level classification rather than a first-order claim.

### 5. Substance dissolved

- FACT: Apply the copy principle: do we have an impression of substance? **No**. We have only impressions of particular qualities - redness, hardness, sweetness - never of an underlying substrate.
- FACT: Therefore "substance" is a **fiction of the imagination**: the mind's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities and *inventing* a support for them.
- FACT: Hume dissolves **both** material and spiritual substance; neither has a corresponding impression. **This is exactly where he passes Berkeley**, who retained spirit.
- FACT: **Qualities without substance**: there are only bundles of perceptions - qualities that co-occur regularly. The "object" is a stable bundle; the "self" is a flowing bundle.

### 6. The external world - constancy, coherence and the double-existence theory

- FACT: Sense presents only **interrupted** perceptions; it does not present an object existing continuously while unperceived, or existing distinctly beyond perception.
- FACT: **Constancy** of similar perceptions and **coherence** in their reappearance lead the imagination to feign continued objects and to smooth perceptual gaps.
- FACT: Philosophers respond with a **double-existence theory** - private perceptions representing independently existing objects - but this cannot be verified, because all comparison remains within perceptions.
- ANALYSIS: **The crucial qualification**: Hume does **not** demonstrate that no external world exists. Sceptical reflection undermines the rational justification, while nature restores the unavoidable belief in bodies during ordinary life.
- FACT: This is the pattern of Humean naturalism, and it recurs in every later session: explain why a belief is psychologically inevitable **after** showing that reason cannot establish its metaphysical object.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Hume's dissolution of substance is the first application of a single instrument rather than an independent metaphysical thesis. **Named evidence.** The *Treatise* divides perceptions into impressions and ideas by force and vivacity and states that every simple idea copies a simple impression; introspection yields impressions of redness, hardness and sweetness but never of a bearer; and the *Enquiry* classifies all enquiry as relations of ideas or matters of fact, consigning what fits neither to the flames. **Analysis.** Because the demand for a source impression is a demand about **content** rather than about existence, the conclusion is that "substance" names no clear idea and is supplied instead by the imagination's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities - a result that applies with equal force to Berkeley's spirit, which is why Hume's empiricism is more consistent than his predecessor's. **Qualification.** The instrument is itself an empirical generalisation to which Hume concedes the missing shade of blue as an exception, so the demolition of substance is only as secure as a maxim its author admits is not exceptionless - although interpolation between impressions actually had preserves the principle's spirit if not its letter.

### Exam link

- **2018 Q1(a), 10 marks** - "Are the two truths ... of the same necessity for Hume?" is decided entirely by Section 4.
- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** and **2021 Q1(e), 10 marks** - Section 1-3 are the machinery those answers presuppose.
- Any "substance" question across the item uses Section 5, and any "external world" material uses Section 6.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                   | Correction                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume denies that anything exists"                     | He denies the <b>content</b> of the idea of substance, not the existence of perceptions |
| Treating impressions and ideas as a difference in kind | The difference is <b>force and vivacity</b> , a difference of degree                    |
| Ignoring the missing shade                             | The examiner may raise it; concede it first and supply the interpolation reply          |
| Collapsing relations of ideas into matters of fact     | This is the exact error 2018 Q1(a) is built to catch                                    |
| Saying Hume proves there is no external world          | He shows reason cannot justify the belief; nature imposes it anyway                     |

### Revision notes

- Perceptions = impressions (vivid) + ideas (faint copies); criterion is force and vivacity.
- Copy principle: every simple idea copies a simple impression; missing shade of blue is the conceded exception.
- Association: resemblance · contiguity · cause and effect - psychological, not logical.
- Fork: relations of ideas (a priori, necessary) versus matters of fact (a posteriori, contingent).
- "Commit it then to the flames" - *Enquiry* XII, aimed at divinity or school metaphysics.
- Substance: no impression -> fiction of the imagination; material **and** spiritual alike.
- External world: constancy + coherence -> feigned continuity; double existence unverifiable; nature restores belief.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HUME I: THE INSTRUMENT AND ITS FIRST CASUALTY

ALL PERCEPTIONS = IMPRESSIONS (vivid) + IDEAS (faint copies)  
|  
v  
COPY PRINCIPLE: every SIMPLE idea copies a SIMPLE impression  
CONCEDED EXCEPTION: the missing shade of blue (*Treatise* I.i.1; *Enquiry* II)  
REPLY: interpolation between impressions actually had - spirit survives  
|  
v  
ASSOCIATION: RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY | CAUSE AND EFFECT (psychological)  
|  
v  
THE FORK  
RELATIONS OF IDEAS: a priori, necessary, denial contradictory ("2+2=4")  
MATTERS OF FACT: a posteriori, contingent, contrary conceivable  
("the sun will rise tomorrow")  
NEITHER? -> "commit it then to the flames" (*Enquiry* XII)  
|  
v  
APPLY TO SUBSTANCE: no impression of a bearer -> FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION  
dissolves MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance alike (Berkeley kept spirit)  
|  
v  
EXTERNAL WORLD: interrupted perceptions -> CONSTANCY + COHERENCE ->  
imagination feigns continued bodies; double existence unverifiable;  
reason cannot justify, NATURE compels  
TRAP: "nothing exists" | fork collapse | ignoring the missing shade  
ANSWER LINE: one instrument, three casualties - substance, self, necessity

## SESSION 11 - HUME II: THE BUNDLE SELF, THE APPENDIX RETRACTION, KANT'S REPLY, AND THE FAILURE OF THE PROOFS OF GOD

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** When Hume looks inside for the self he finds only a rapid succession of particular experiences and never the experiencer; so the self, like substance, becomes a collection rather than a thing - and he later admits, with unusual honesty, that he cannot say what holds the collection together.

**Technical definition:** Hume's **bundle theory** holds that the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement" (*Treatise* I.iv.6); the apparent unity is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation** among perceptions, and the Appendix to the *Treatise* records Hume's own failure to explain the principle that unites them.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume's statement that he can never catch himself without a perception is not a report of introspective bad luck but the copy principle applied to the perceiver: if every legitimate idea must be traced to an impression, and introspection delivers only particular perceptions in flux, then the simple continuing self is a fiction of the imagination - and the fact that Hume's own Appendix confesses he cannot say what binds the bundle is the strongest evidence that the fault lies in the atomism of impressions rather than in the self.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- "I never can catch myself" - the introspective report the 2020 paper quotes
- **bundle or collection of different perceptions** - the exact formula
- **perpetual flux** - the phrase that rules out a simple identity
- **fiction of identity** - produced by resemblance and causation
- **the Appendix retraction** - "all my hopes vanish"
- **transcendental unity of apperception** - Kant's formal condition, not an entity
- **design argument, cosmological argument, miracles** - the three fronts on God

**How to use them:** answer the self question with doctrine, then the Appendix, then Kant - in that order, because 2020 Q2(a) requires the empiricist argument to be *complete* before the reply is reported.

### Plain-language visual - looking for the looker

```

CLOSE YOUR EYES AND LOOK FOR YOURSELF.
+-----+
| You find: a twinge in the knee | the sound of a fan | the memory |
| of breakfast | irritation | a patch of red behind the eyelids |
+-----+
| You do NOT find: the one who is finding them. |
+-----+
|
|
SO WHY DOES IT FEEL LIKE ONE CONTINUOUS "I"?
+-----+
| RESEMBLANCE: today's ideas resemble yesterday's memories, and |
| the imagination slides easily between them. |
| CAUSATION: each perception seems to produce the next; memory |
| links them into a chain. |
| -> The EASY TRANSITION is mistaken for an IDENTICAL OBJECT. |
+-----+
|
|
AND THEN, IN THE APPENDIX, HUME ADMITS DEFEAT:
"all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that
unite our successive perceptions."

```

**In simple words:** Hume's argument has two halves and most scripts write only the first. The first half says there is no impression of a self. The second half explains why we nevertheless believe in one. The Appendix then adds a third element that no examiner expects: Hume says the explanation does not work. Include all three and the answer is complete.

| Remember first  | Meaning                                                         |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| The report      | "I never can catch myself at any time without a perception"     |
| The thesis      | the self is a bundle in perpetual flux                          |
| The explanation | resemblance and causation produce a felt continuity             |
| The confession  | the Appendix cannot state the uniting principle                 |
| What is denied  | a <b>simple, identical self-substance</b> , not the perceptions |
| Kant's reply    | a formal condition of unified experience, not an observed ego   |

**One-line memory:** Hume finds the **perceptions** and loses the **owner** - and says so himself.

## VISUAL: VISUAL - the bundle, the fiction, the confession and the reply

```
THE ARGUMENT Treatise I.iv.6
=====
1 COPY PRINCIPLE applied to the self: which impression is the self
 copied from? It would have to be constant and invariable through
 the whole course of a life.
2 INTROSPECTION delivers only particular perceptions - heat, cold,
 light, shade, love, hatred, pain, pleasure - in perpetual flux.
3 NO constant impression is found.
4 THEREFORE the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of
 different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable
 rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement."
=====
BUT WHY THE ILLUSION OF UNITY?
 RESEMBLANCE ---+
 +--> the imagination passes SMOOTHLY along the
 CAUSATION ---+ series and MISTAKES an easy transition for
 an identical object -> the FICTION of self
=====
THE APPENDIX RETRACTION - the page that earns marks
+-----+
| Hume cannot explain what BINDS the bundle: "all my hopes vanish |
| when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive |
| perceptions." |
| DIAGNOSIS: he has denied BOTH a substance AND any real connexion |
| between distinct existences, so he has removed in advance every |
| resource a principle of unity could have used. |
| THEREFORE the honest verdict: the failure indicts the ATOMISM OF |
| IMPRESSIONS, not the self. |
+-----+
=====
KANT'S REPLY - the 2020 second limb, stated exactly
+-----+
| 1 Kant ACCEPTS that no impression or inner intuition reveals a |
| simple soul-substance. He is not restoring Descartes' ego. |
| 2 He argues instead that the "I THINK" must be able to accompany |
| ALL my representations if they are to belong to ONE experience. |
| 3 The TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION is therefore a FORMAL |
| CONDITION of synthesising a manifold under rules - not another |
| perceived item inside the bundle. |
| 4 LIMIT: this answers the missing unity at the level of POSSIBLE |
| EXPERIENCE; it does not prove an immortal soul or settle every |
| practical question of identity through time. |
| 5 HUMEAN REJOINER: Kant has stated a condition of DESCRIPTION |
| rather than discovered an ENTITY. Kant accepts the non-entity |
| point and insists that rule-governed unity is PRESUPPOSED by |
| judgment. |
+-----+
CROSS-TRADITION BRIDGE (one clause, not a paragraph): the bundle
strikingly resembles the Buddhist no-self doctrine (nairatmyavada).
```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Step 1 of Kant's reply is the step that separates a good answer from a wrong one. A script that reports Kant as "proving the soul exists" has inverted his position and will lose the second limb of the 2020 question entirely.

### 1. The argument, and the exact formula

- FACT: Apply the copy principle to the self: **introspect, and you never find an impression of a "self"** - only particular perceptions in constant flux.
- FACT: The self is **"nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity, and are in a perpetual flux and movement"** (*Treatise* I.iv.6).
- ANALYSIS: **What is denied:** a *simple, identical self-substance*. What is **not** denied: the perceptions, which are real. The trap is to write "Hume says the self does not exist" - he says there is no **owner** behind the perceptions.

### 2. Why we believe in a self anyway

- FACT: The imagination produces the fiction through **resemblance** - present ideas resemble past memories, creating a felt continuity - and through **causation**, since one perception seems to produce the next and memory links them.
- ANALYSIS: The mechanism is the same association introduced in Session 10; the identity we ascribe is therefore a **fictitious** identity, imposed on a succession because the transition between its members is smooth.

### 3. The Appendix - Hume's own retraction

- FACT: In the Appendix to the *Treatise*, Hume confesses that he cannot satisfactorily explain what **binds** the bundle together: "all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions."
- ANALYSIS: **The diagnosis worth stating**: having denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, Hume has removed every resource a principle of unity might have used, so the failure is a symptom of the **atomism of impressions**, not of the self.
- FACT: This honest confession is philosophically significant and is the single most quotable page in any answer on Hume's self.
- ANALYSIS: Note also that the *Enquiry* silently **drops** the personal-identity discussion - a textual fact worth one clause, because it shows Hume's own dissatisfaction.

### 4. Kant's response, stated without distortion

- FACT: Kant **accepts** that no impression or inner intuition reveals a simple soul-substance.
- FACT: He argues instead that the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all representations if they are to belong to one experience at all.
- FACT: The **transcendental unity of apperception** is a **formal condition** of synthesising a manifold under rules, not another perceived item inside the bundle.
- ANALYSIS: This answers Hume's missing unity at the level of **possible experience**; it does not prove an immortal Cartesian soul or by itself settle every practical question of personal identity through time.
- CAUTION: The Humean can reply that Kant has stated a condition of **description** rather than discovered an entity; Kant accepts the non-entity point but insists that rule-governed unity is presupposed by judgment.
- ANALYSIS: **Cross-tradition parallel**, worth one clause: the bundle theory strikingly resembles the Buddhist doctrine of no-self (*nairātmyavāda*), a bridge some examiners reward - but it is a **parallel**, not an influence, and must not be inflated.

### 5. God - the three fronts, all lost

| Front                                                                         | Hume's argument                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Consequence                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cosmological / causal</b>                                                  | We have no impression of a "first cause" or of causation as necessary connexion, so we cannot legitimately infer from experienced effects to an unexperienced transcendent cause                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | The argument Locke used at <i>Essay IV</i> is cut off at its premise |
| <b>Design / teleological</b> ( <i>Dialogues concerning Natural Religion</i> ) | The analogy - universe : designer :: watch : watchmaker - is weak, because the universe is not sufficiently similar to a manufactured artifact; even if granted it proves at most a <b>finite</b> architect working on given matter, not an omnipotent, omniscient, morally perfect creator; order might arise from natural principles without intelligence; and the problem of evil undermines any inference to a perfectly good designer | The design argument survives, if at all, only as a weak analogy      |
| <b>Miracles</b> ( <i>Enquiry X</i> )                                          | A miracle violates the laws of nature; testimony in favour of a miracle is always less probable than the testimony being false                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | It is never rational to believe miracle-reports on testimony alone   |

- ANALYSIS: **Ownership note**: the miracle argument is secondary enrichment here; Hume's **critique of the proofs** is core, because "God" is printed in the syllabus clause.
- ANALYSIS: **Cross-paper link**: the design-argument critique is also the required content for Paper II questions on proofs for God's existence; the argument is the same, the paper is different.



## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Hume's bundle theory dissolves the substantial self without denying the reality of experience, and its most important feature is that its author declares it incomplete. **Named evidence.** *Treatise* I.iv.6 reports that introspection never delivers a constant and invariable impression but only heat, cold, light, shade, love, hatred, pain and pleasure in perpetual flux, and concludes that the self is a bundle or collection of different perceptions; the Appendix then confesses that all his hopes vanish when he comes to explain the principles that unite them. **Analysis.** The unity we experience is produced by resemblance and causation, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object; but because Hume has denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, no principle of unity remains available to him, so the failure indicts his atomism of impressions rather than the self. **Qualification.** Kant's transcendental unity of apperception addresses precisely this gap by treating the "I think" as a formal condition of unified experience rather than as a discovered entity, which is why it is a reply to Hume and not a return to Descartes - though the Humean may fairly answer that a condition of description is not yet the discovery of a subject.

### Exam link

- **2020 Q2(a), 20 marks** - the quoted sentence is answered by Section Section 1-3, and the Kant limb by Section 4. The empiricist argument must be complete before Kant appears.
- **2025 P-II** proofs-for-God questions draw directly on Section 5, and the same material supports any Paper I comparison of God across the three empiricists.
- **2021 Q1(d)** gains its contrast from placing Locke's forensic person beside Hume's bundle.

### UPSC traps

| Trap                                                   | Correction                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume says the self does not exist"                    | He denies a <b>simple identical self-substance</b> ; the perceptions are real |
| Omitting the Appendix                                  | The retraction is the most valuable single item in this session               |
| "Kant proves the soul exists"                          | Kant supplies a <b>formal condition</b> , and explicitly not a soul-substance |
| Making the Buddhist parallel a paragraph               | It is a bridge in one clause; the syllabus owner is Indian Philosophy         |
| Reporting the design argument as merely "weak analogy" | Give the four separate objections, including the finite-architect point       |

### Revision notes

- No constant impression of a self; only perceptions in perpetual flux.
- *Treatise* I.iv.6: "a bundle or collection of different perceptions".
- Fiction of unity produced by **resemblance** and **causation**.
- Appendix: "all my hopes vanish" - the uniting principle cannot be stated; the *Enquiry* drops the topic.
- Kant: the "I think" must be able to accompany representations; transcendental unity of apperception is **formal**.
- God: cosmological cut at the premise; design weak, at most a finite architect, plus the problem of evil; miracles never rationally credible on testimony.



## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HUME II: THE SELF AND GOD

COPY PRINCIPLE APPLIED TO THE PERCEIVER

|  
v

INTROSPECTION: only particular perceptions in PERPETUAL FLUX; no constant and invariable impression of a self

|  
v

SELF = "A BUNDLE OR COLLECTION OF DIFFERENT PERCEPTIONS" (Treatise I.iv.6)

|  
v

---> WHY IT FEELS UNIFIED: RESEMBLANCE + CAUSATION -> easy transition  
| mistaken for an identical object -> FICTION of identity

---> APPENDIX: "all my hopes vanish" - no uniting principle available  
| DIAGNOSIS: the ATOMISM of impressions is at fault, not the self

---> the Enquiry silently DROPS personal identity

|  
v

KANT (2020 second limb): accepts there is no soul-substance; the "I THINK" must be able to accompany all representations; TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION = a FORMAL CONDITION, not an entity

HUMEAN REJOINDER: a condition of description, not a discovered subject

|  
v

GOD - THREE FRONTS, ALL LOST

CAUSAL: no impression of a first cause or of necessary connexion

DESIGN (Dialogues): weak analogy | at most a FINITE architect | natural order without intelligence | the problem of evil

MIRACLES (Enquiry X): testimony is always less probable than its falsehood

TRAP: "self does not exist" | omitting the Appendix | Kant as soul-prover

ANSWER LINE: Hume finds the perceptions and loses the owner - and admits it

## SESSION 12 - HUME III: CAUSATION, THE TWO DEFINITIONS, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION, KANT'S RESPONSE AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Watch one billiard ball strike another as often as you like: you will see one move, then the other, always in that order and always touching - but you will never see the pushing itself. Hume says the "must" we feel is a habit inside us that repetition has installed, not a link we have observed in the world.

**Technical definition:** Hume's analysis of causation replaces objective **necessary connexion** with three observable elements - **constant conjunction**, **temporal priority** and **spatial contiguity** - plus an **impression of reflection**, the felt determination of the mind to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect; from this follow his **two definitions of cause**, the sceptical **problem of induction**, and the positive doctrine of **mitigated scepticism**.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Hume does not deny causation; he **relocates necessity** - from the objects, where no impression of a power or tie is ever given, to the observer, in whom repetition installs a felt determination to pass from cause to effect - and because that relocation converts the foundation of every factual inference into a habit, it produces the problem of induction, which is why the same doctrine answers a question about causation and a question about the limits of reason.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **constant conjunction**, **temporal priority**, **contiguity** - the three observables
- **no impression of necessary connexion** - the negative result
- **impression of reflection** - the felt determination of the mind
- **custom or habit** - "the great guide of human life" (*Enquiry* V)
- **two definitions of cause** - the philosophical and the natural
- **the Uniformity Principle** - and the dilemma that traps it
- **mitigated scepticism** versus **excessive or Pyrrhonian scepticism**

**How to use them:** run the negative argument in numbered steps, produce **both** definitions, then run induction as a formal dilemma, then Kant's Second Analogy, then close on mitigated scepticism. Naming both definitions is the single highest-value move available in this sub-topic.

**Plain-language visual - what you actually see, and what you add**

THE BILLIARD TABLE

Enquiry IV, VII

BALL A moves ---> touches BALL B ---> BALL B moves

WHAT THE SENSES DELIVER:

PRIORITYA moves first

CONTIGUITYthey touch

CONSTANTevery time so far, B has followed A

CONJUNCTION

WHAT THE SENSES NEVER DELIVER:

the POWER, the FORCE, the TIE, the "must"

REPETITION ADDS NOTHING TO THE OBJECTS. The hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first, as far as the balls go.

BUT REPETITION CHANGES \*ME\*. After constant conjunction, my mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. THAT felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION - and the idea of necessary connexion is copied from it.

CONCLUSION: necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects." Causation is not denied; NECESSITY IS RELOCATED.

**In simple words:** the argument is an audit, exactly like the audits of substance and self. Name the idea, demand its impression, search outside, search inside, and follow the search where it goes. Hume even checks the most promising internal case - the will moving a limb - and finds no impression of the mechanism there either.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Observed           | priority, contiguity, constant conjunction                              |
| Not observed       | power, force, necessary connexion                                       |
| Source of the idea | an <b>impression of reflection</b> : the felt determination of the mind |
| Mechanism          | <b>custom or habit</b> , not rational demonstration                     |
| Result             | necessity is <i>projected onto</i> objects, not read off them           |
| Not the result     | that causal inference should stop; nature compels it                    |

**One-line memory:** the necessity is real - it is just in the **spectator**, not in the **collision**.

**VISUAL: VISUAL** - the two arguments, the two definitions and the dilemma

(A) THE NEGATIVE ARGUMENT ON NECESSARY CONNEXION    Treatise I.iii.14;  
Enquiry VII

- 1 COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea derives from a simple impression.
- 2 So if we have a genuine idea of NECESSARY CONNEXION, locate its source impression.
- 3 EXTERNAL SEARCH: in any single instance of causation, sense delivers only priority, contiguity and the succession of qualities. No impression of a POWER or TIE is given.
- 4 Repetition adds no new quality TO THE OBJECTS: the hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first.
- 5 INTERNAL SEARCH: volition does no better. I have no impression of HOW the will moves the limb; nerve and muscle are unknown to consciousness. This rules out the Cartesian and the occasionalist appeal alike.
- 6 But repetition DOES change THE MIND: after constant conjunction the mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. That felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION.
- 7 THEREFORE the idea of necessary connexion is copied from that internal impression. Necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects."
- 8 THEREFORE TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE FOLLOW:

|                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i) OBJECTIVE / PHILOSOPHICAL<br>an object followed by another,<br>where all objects similar to<br>the first are followed by<br>objects similar to the second<br>regularity, external | (ii) SUBJECTIVE / NATURAL<br>an object followed by another,<br>whose appearance CONVEYS THE<br>THOUGHT to the other<br>psychological, internal |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

NAMING BOTH IS THE HIGHEST-VALUE MOVE IN ANY HUME-ON-CAUSATION ANSWER. TENSION worth flagging: the two pull apart and Hume never reconciles them - the origin of the modern regularity-versus-projectivist debate. PRESUPPOSITIONS: P1 the copy principle is exceptionless; P2 single and repeated instances can be compared for ADDED content; P3 impressions are atomic and separable, so no relation is given WITH its terms; P4 "necessity" must be either observed or projected - no third option such as an inferred theoretical posit. CANONICAL EXAMPLES: the two billiard balls (Enquiry IV, VII); bread nourishing the body (Enquiry IV) - the sensible qualities of bread give no clue to its nutritive power.

(B) THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION AS A FORMAL DILEMMA Enquiry IV

- 1 All reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory rests on the relation of cause and effect.
  - 2 Causal inference rests on the UNIFORMITY PRINCIPLE (UP): the future will resemble the past; unobserved cases resemble observed ones.
  - 3 UP can be established only DEMONSTRATIVELY or PROBABLY. <-- THE FORK APPLIED REFLEXIVELY; this exhaustive division is the vulnerable step.
  - 4 NOT DEMONSTRATIVELY: "the course of nature may change" implies no contradiction - it is perfectly conceivable.
  - 5 NOT PROBABLY: every probable or experiential argument already PRESUPPOSES UP, so the argument would be circular.
  - 6 THEREFORE UP has no rational foundation.
  - 7 THEREFORE inductive inference is produced not by reason but by CUSTOM OR HABIT - "the great guide of human life" (Enquiry V).
- EVERY SERIOUS REPLY ATTACKS STEP 3:
- KANT supplies a THIRD category - the synthetic a priori
  - POPPER denies that science needs induction at all
  - STRAWSON argues that demanding a justification of induction AS A WHOLE misapplies the very standards induction constitutes

(C) KANT'S RESPONSE - the routed reply in 2025 Q2(c)

- Kant AGREES that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory impression.
- SECOND ANALOGY: the category of cause is an A PRIORI RULE required to distinguish OBJECTIVE event-succession from the merely SUBJECTIVE succession of my perceptions.
- "Every event has a cause" is therefore SYNTHETIC A PRIORI for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena.
- LIMIT: this rescues objective empirical causation WITHOUT claiming knowledge of causality among things in themselves.
- HUMEAN CHALLENGE: has Kant PROVED the category, or BUILT it into the definition of objective experience? KANT'S REPLY is transcendental -

without such rule-governed synthesis, experience of an EVENT would not be possible at all.

=====

(D) MITIGATED SCEPTICISM - the positive doctrine                      Enquiry XII  
 EXCESSIVE / PYRRHONIAN: total suspension of judgment - UNLIVEABLE  
 MITIGATED: limit enquiry to what experience can answer; avoid  
 speculation beyond possible experience; proportion belief to  
 evidence; accept the natural beliefs custom compels

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Diagram (A) step 5 is the step scripts omit. Hume does not merely say we see no power in billiard balls; he closes the *internal* escape route, and that closure is what makes the conclusion general rather than anecdotal.

### 1. The elements, tabulated

| Element                                   | Hume's analysis                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What we observe                           | constant conjunction (A always followed by B) + temporal priority (A precedes B) + spatial contiguity                                                                                    |
| What we do <b>not</b> observe             | a <i>necessary connexion</i> between cause and effect                                                                                                                                    |
| Source of the idea of necessary connexion | not any impression of objects; an <b>impression of reflection</b> - a <i>feeling</i> in the mind, a determination to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B after repeated experience  |
| Mechanism                                 | <b>custom or habit</b> : after repeated observation of A → B the mind <i>expects</i> B on seeing A; this expectation is a <b>psychological compulsion</b> , not a rational demonstration |
| Conclusion                                | causal necessity is not <i>in</i> objects; it is <b>projected onto</b> them by the mind's habitual association                                                                           |

### 2. Is there any element of necessity in causal relations? - the 2019 answer in two lines

- FACT: **In objects themselves - NO.** There is no impression of objective necessity.
- FACT: **In the mind - YES**, in a psychological sense: the impression of reflection, the felt compulsion to expect B after A, is a kind of **subjective necessity**. But this is a fact about *us*, not about *nature*.
- ANALYSIS: The directive in 2019 Q4(b) is "Is there any element...?", which demands a **yes-and-no with a distinction**, never a flat "no". Answer in the first line, then explain.

### 3. The two definitions - and why both must appear

- FACT: **(i) Objective or philosophical**: an object followed by another, where all objects similar to the first are followed by objects similar to the second.
- FACT: **(ii) Subjective or natural**: an object followed by another, whose appearance **conveys the thought** to the other.
- ANALYSIS: The two pull apart: the first is regularity-based and external, the second psychological and internal, and Hume never reconciles them. That unreconciled tension is the origin of the modern debate between regularity and projectivist accounts of causation, and naming it turns exposition into assessment.

### 4. Induction - the dilemma, and where every reply must strike

The seven steps are set out in diagram (B). The examinable point is that **step 3 is the vulnerable one**: it assumes the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative/probable dichotomy, which is Hume's own fork applied reflexively. Kant breaks that horn with the synthetic a priori; Popper denies science needs induction; Strawson dissolves the demand.

ANALYSIS: **Executable verdict on induction**: the sceptical conclusion depends on the exhaustiveness of a dichotomy that is itself the fork, so Hume's scepticism about induction is not a discovery about the world but the shadow cast by his classification of propositions - which is exactly why it survives only as long as the fork does.

### 5. Kant's response, and how far it goes

- FACT: Kant **agrees** that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory impression - so he is not contradicting Hume's negative result, he is accepting it.

- FACT: In the **Second Analogy** he argues that the category of cause is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish **objective** event-succession from the merely **subjective** succession of perceptions. Without a rule, the difference between a ship drifting downstream and my eye wandering over a house cannot be drawn.
- FACT: "Every event has a cause" is therefore **synthetic a priori** for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena.
- ANALYSIS: Kant rescues objective empirical causation **without** claiming knowledge of causality among things in themselves.
- CAUTION: Hume can challenge whether Kant proves the category or builds it into the definition of objective experience; the Kantian reply is transcendental - without such rule-governed synthesis, experience of an *event* would not be possible.
- ANALYSIS: **Ownership discipline**: Kant is the routed reply, not the doctrine under examination. In 2025 Q2(c) the Hume limb must be complete before the Kant limb begins.

## 6. Mitigated scepticism - the positive recommendation

- FACT: Hume does **not** recommend suspending all belief; that would be unliveable. He distinguishes:
- **Excessive or Pyrrhonian scepticism** - total suspension of judgment, impossible in practice;
- **Mitigated scepticism** - a cautious, modest attitude: limit enquiry to what experience can answer, avoid speculation about things beyond possible experience (substance, God, the soul), and proportion belief to evidence.
- FACT: This is Hume's positive doctrine: philosophical humility plus reliance on the natural beliefs custom compels.
- CAUTION: **The standing objection**: mitigated scepticism looks inconsistent, since Hume *uses* induction while denying its rational basis. **His reply**: nature forces belief on us; philosophy reveals its groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction. ANALYSIS: The position is stable **only if** natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification - which concedes that not all belief needs reason.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** Hume's account of causation relocates necessity from the world to the observer, and the problem of induction is the immediate consequence rather than a separate scepticism. **Named evidence.** *Treatise* I.iii.14 and *Enquiry* VII search for an impression of necessary connexion, find only priority, contiguity and constant conjunction in the billiard-ball case, close the internal route by noting that we have no impression of how the will moves a limb, and locate the idea in the mind's determination to pass from cause to effect, yielding the two definitions of cause; *Enquiry* IV then shows that the Uniformity Principle can be established neither demonstratively, since its denial implies no contradiction, nor probably, since every experiential argument presupposes it. **Analysis.** Because the very habit that produces the idea of necessity is also the mechanism of all factual inference, the analysis of causation and the problem of induction are one result stated twice, and custom becomes the great guide of human life precisely where reason has been shown to be silent. **Qualification.** The result follows from the atomism of impressions rather than from experience itself - if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise - so Kant's Second Analogy is correctly aimed when it attacks the atomism, though the Humean may still ask whether the category has been proved or presupposed.

## Exam link

- **2023 Q2(a), 20 marks** - "Critically analyse Hume's argument that causality is a matter of habit/custom involving psychological principle of association." Diagram (A) plus Section 3 plus the objections; "critically analyse" demands a verdict.
- **2021 Q1(e), 10 marks** - "constant conjunction" is the quoted phrase; the answer is Section 1 plus the impression of reflection.
- **2019 Q4(b), 15 marks** - Section 2 is the whole hinge: not in objects, yes in the mind.
- **2025 Q2(c), 15 marks** - Section Section 1-3 then Section 5, in that order.
- **2018 Q1(a), 10 marks** - the fork from Session 10 plus Section 4's conceivability point.

## UPSC traps

| Trap                                     | Correction                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Hume denies causation"                  | He denies the <b>idea of necessary connexion in objects</b> ; causal inference continues, compelled by custom |
| "Hume's causation = mere succession"     | Constant conjunction <b>plus</b> priority <b>plus</b> contiguity <b>plus</b> the felt necessity               |
| Giving only one definition of cause      | Both are required; naming both is the highest-value move here                                                 |
| Answering 2019 with a flat "no"          | The question asks "any element", so distinguish objects from mind                                             |
| Treating Kant as refuting Hume's premise | Kant <b>accepts</b> the negative result and attacks the atomism instead                                       |
| Calling Hume a Pyrrhonian                | His scepticism is explicitly <b>mitigated</b>                                                                 |

## Revision notes

- Observed: constant conjunction, priority, contiguity. Not observed: power or tie.
- Internal search fails too: no impression of how the will moves the limb.
- Idea of necessity copied from an **impression of reflection**; mechanism is **custom or habit**.
- Two definitions: regularity-based (philosophical) and thought-conveying (natural); unreconciled.
- Induction: UP not demonstrable (denial conceivable), not probable (circular) -> custom.
- Step 3 of the dilemma is the target of Kant, Popper and Strawson.
- Kant: Second Analogy; cause is an a priori rule; synthetic a priori for possible experience; no claim about things in themselves.
- Mitigated, not Pyrrhonian; stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HUME III: CAUSATION, INDUCTION AND SCEPTICISM

DEMAND THE IMPRESSION OF "NECESSARY CONNEXION"

|

+++> EXTERNAL SEARCH: only PRIORITY + CONTIGUITY + CONSTANT CONJUNCTION

+++> REPETITION adds nothing to the OBJECTS

+++> INTERNAL SEARCH: no impression of how the will moves the limb

|

v

FOUND ONLY: the MIND'S DETERMINATION to pass A -> B = IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION

NECESSITY IS RELOCATED: in the mind, not in objects

|

+++> TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE

| (i) philosophical: regular succession of similars

| (ii) natural: appearance CONVEYS THE THOUGHT to the other

| they pull apart and are never reconciled

|

v

INDUCTION AS A DILEMMA (Enquiry IV)

UP: the future resembles the past

not DEMONSTRABLE (denial conceivable) | not PROBABLE (circular)

-> no rational foundation -> CUSTOM, "the great guide of human life"

ATTACK POINT: step 3, the demonstrative/probable dichotomy = the FORK

KANT third category | POPPER no induction needed | STRAWSON dissolve demand

|

v

KANT'S SECOND ANALOGY: cause is an A PRIORI RULE distinguishing objective event-succession from subjective succession; synthetic a priori for possible experience; silent about things in themselves

|

v

MITIGATED SCEPTICISM (Enquiry XII): not Pyrrhonian suspension but bounded enquiry, proportioned belief and reliance on natural belief

TRAP: "denies causation" | mere succession | one definition | flat "no" in 2019

ANSWER LINE: necessity is real, but it lives in the spectator

## SESSION 13 - COMPARISON, CRITICISMS AND REPLIES, ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVES AND PROVENANCE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** This session turns the three systems into one comparison table, lists what each thinker's critics say and what he can answer, and then converts all of it into the sentences and structures that actually earn marks in the examination hall.

**Technical definition:** A synoptic treatment of British empiricism on **matched axes** - matter, qualities, substance, self, causation, God, scepticism and overall position - together with a criticism-reply-residual ledger for each thinker, graded verdicts at 10, 15 and 20 marks, a directive decoder, and the citation and provenance rules that protect factual accuracy.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Comparative questions in this item are lost by scripts that write three summaries and won by scripts that announce a **criterion** first: choose one axis - what each thinker will admit as an object of knowledge - and Locke's represented matter, Berkeley's ideas and spirits, and Hume's perceptions arrange themselves in a single argument, so that every subsequent difference about substance, self, causation and God is a consequence rather than a separate paragraph.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **matched axes** - the same question asked three times
- **criterion announced first** - the structural move that earns the comparison mark
- **criticism -> reply -> residual** - the three-column discipline
- **directive fidelity** - "examine", "critically analyse", "is there any...?"
- **provenance mark** - naming what is a later label and what is the author's own words
- **graded verdict** - a ruling scaled to the marks available

**How to use them:** open with the criterion, run the axes, then rule. Use the criticism ledger for the middle of any 15- or 20-marker, and close with a graded verdict rather than a summary.

### Plain-language visual - the same four questions, asked three times

ASK EACH MAN THE SAME FOUR QUESTIONS AND THE STORY TELLS ITSELF

| QUESTION                                   | LOCKE                                    | BERKELEY                                           | HUME                                   |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Is there matter behind the qualities?      | yes, but its nature is unknown           | no - the word has no content                       | no impression, so no clear idea at all |
| Is there a self that owns the experiences? | yes: a continuing consciousness          | yes: an ACTIVE spirit known by notion              | no: a bundle in perpetual flux         |
| Is there real causal power?                | yes - real power, with limited knowledge | yes - but the only agent is SPIRIT; laws are SIGNS | no - constant conjunction plus habit   |
| Can God be proved?                         | yes, by DEMONSTRATION                    | yes - and he is REQUIRED by the system             | no - every proof fails                 |

MODERATE REALISM      THEISTIC IDEALISM      MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

**In simple words:** a comparison is an argument, not a gallery. If you can say in one line *why* Berkeley must keep spirit while Hume need not, you have shown the examiner the mechanism, and the table then reads as evidence rather than as decoration.

| Remember first     | Meaning                                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Axis               | one question asked of all three                          |
| Criterion          | the standard by which you will rank them                 |
| Residual           | what remains true after the reply is given               |
| Directive fidelity | doing exactly what the command word demands              |
| Provenance         | separating an author's words from the tradition's labels |
| Graded verdict     | a ruling proportioned to the marks                       |

**One-line memory:** announce the **criterion**, run the **axes**, then **rule**.



## VISUAL: VISUAL - the eight-axis comparison and the criticism ledger

### THE EIGHT-AXIS COMPARISON

| AXIS       | LOCKE                                         | BERKELEY                                      | HUME                                                             |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MATTER     | real but unknowable substrate                 | does not exist (a fiction/ meaningless word)  | no impression -> fiction                                         |
| QUALITIES  | primary (objective) vs secondary (subjective) | ALL mind-dependent; the distinction COLLAPSES | all are impressions; no basis for an objective/ subjective split |
| SUBSTANCE  | "something I know not what"                   | spirit only (no material substance)           | no substance at all - material or spiritual                      |
| SELF       | continuity of consciousness (memory)          | active spirit (real), known by NOTION         | bundle of perceptions (no self)                                  |
| CAUSATION  | real power (knowledge of mechanism limited)   | God's will producing ideas in us              | constant conjunction + habit (no real power)                     |
| GOD        | demonstrated by a cosmological-style argument | required to sustain unperceived ideas         | all proofs fail; scepticism                                      |
| SCEPTICISM | rejected (moderate realism)                   | claims to REFUTE scepticism                   | embraced, but MITIGATED                                          |
| OVERALL    | representative realism                        | subjective (theistic) idealism                | phenomenalism + scepticism                                       |

### THE CRITICISM LEDGER - CRITICISM | SOURCE | REPLY | RESIDUAL

#### AGAINST LOCKE

- The primary/secondary distinction is unstable - can extension be conceived without any sensory quality? SOURCE: Berkeley  
REPLY: we can THINK extension abstractly through mathematical reasoning even if we always IMAGINE it with colour.  
RESIDUAL: the reply needs a non-imagistic idea, which strains Locke's own theory of ideas.
- Representative realism generates scepticism - how can ideas be verified against reality? SOURCE: Berkeley and sceptics  
REPLY: God would not make us systematically deceived; inference to external causes is reliable enough for the conduct of life.  
RESIDUAL: this converts an epistemological problem into a theological guarantee.
- Personal identity via memory is circular. SOURCE: Butler, Reid  
REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from the EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory); repair transitivity with overlapping chains.  
RESIDUAL: "consciousness of it AS MINE" may re-import ownership.

#### AGAINST BERKELEY

- Common sense: surely tables exist unperceived.  
SOURCE: reported in Samuel Johnson's stone-kicking - RECEPTION only  
REPLY: the table DOES exist unperceived by you - God perceives it.  
The theory SAVES common sense rather than destroying it.  
RESIDUAL: continuity is bought with a theological premise.
- Solipsism threat: if reality is my ideas, what of other minds?  
REPLY: other spirits are known by ANALOGY; God guarantees the whole system.  
RESIDUAL: knowledge of other spirits is less immediate than awareness of one's own activity.
- Why invoke God at all? This is dogmatic, not empiricist. SOURCE: Hume  
REPLY: Berkeley accepts that he is a theist using empiricist methods to defend theism.  
RESIDUAL: God does exactly the work Locke's matter did.
- How does subjective idealism differ from Hegel's absolute idealism?  
SOURCE: the 2024 examiner  
REPLY: Berkeley - reality is ideas in finite and divine minds; Hegel - reality is the self-development of Absolute Spirit.  
RESIDUAL: the two are different in KIND, not degree.

#### AGAINST HUME

- 8 If there is no real causal power, science becomes inexplicable.  
SOURCE: Kant and scientists  
REPLY: science works by INDUCTIVE HABIT, not by rational insight into necessity; its success is a psychological fact, not a philosophical justification.  
RESIDUAL: an account of success is not an account of warrant.
- 9 What holds the bundle together? SOURCE: critics; HUME HIMSELF  
REPLY: none is offered - "all my hopes vanish" (Appendix).  
RESIDUAL: the failure indicts the atomism, not the self.
- 10 Self-refutation: is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it burns itself. SOURCE: critics  
REPLY: it is a clarification of the meanings of terms - a meta-level classification, not a first-order claim.  
RESIDUAL: the status of the meta-level remains contested.
- 11 Mitigated scepticism is inconsistent: Hume USES induction while denying its rational basis.  
REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction.  
RESIDUAL: stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Use the ledger three columns at a time. A criticism without a reply is journalism; a reply without a residual is advocacy; only the third column shows judgement.

### 1. Why the empiricist sequence "slides" - the mechanism restated

LOCKE : all ideas from experience -> matter is real but unknowable  
| Berkeley asks: if all we know is ideas, what grounds  
| belief in MATTER?

BERKELEY: no impression of matter -> drop material substance  
| Hume asks: apply the same razor to the SELF, to  
| SUBSTANCE, to CAUSATION

HUME : no impression of self, no impression of necessary connexion  
-> bundle, habit, mitigated scepticism

ANALYSIS: Each step is the **previous thinker's premise taken more consistently**. This is the master narrative of the whole item, and it is what provokes Kant to rescue knowledge by adding the *a priori* contribution of the mind.

## 2. Directive decoder - what each command word obliges you to do

| Directive                                             | What it demands                                                    | Structural obligation in this item                                                             | Fatal error                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Explain / Elucidate</b> (2025 Q4c, 2021 Q1c)       | make the doctrine intelligible by exhibiting its <i>derivation</i> | give the numbered argument - Berkeley's five, Hume's two - not the conclusion                  | restating <i>esse est percipi</i> or "constant conjunction" in synonyms |
| <b>Examine</b> (2021 Q1d)                             | state, then test                                                   | doctrine <b>and</b> objection, then a ruling on the objection's force                          | describing the doctrine and stopping                                    |
| <b>Critically examine / Critically discuss</b>        | assessment dominates                                               | three or four lines of reconstruction, then objection -> reply -> <b>adjudication</b>          | listing objections without ruling                                       |
| <b>Critically analyse</b> (2023 Q2a)                  | exposition <b>plus</b> a verdict                                   | both definitions of cause must appear, then the objections, then the ruling                    | the negative half only                                                  |
| <b>Discuss</b> (2019 Q4b, 2018 Q1a)                   | exposition plus assessment, roughly 60:40                          | for causation, both Humean definitions; for the fork, both boxes                               | a one-sided report                                                      |
| <b>Is there any element ...?</b> (2019 Q4b)           | a <b>yes-and-no with a distinction</b>                             | <i>not in objects; yes in the mind</i> , then the impression of reflection                     | a flat "no"                                                             |
| <b>Comment on the statement</b> (quotation-led parts) | locate the sentence in its own text and system first               | name the work and section, state the thesis it encodes, then two consequences, then a judgment | a generic essay on the thinker                                          |
| <b>How does X refute Y?</b> (2022 Q4c)                | a reconstruction of the refuting argument, premise by premise      | Locke's three grounds <b>and</b> the dispositional reply                                       | listing Locke's points only                                             |
| <b>Is A instrumental in B?</b> (2024 Q2a)             | a causal-explanatory verdict                                       | show <i>which</i> rejection does the work - likeness and abstraction, not relativity           | narrating both doctrines separately                                     |

### 3. Graded verdict bank - executable closing positions

| Sub-topic                              | 10-mark verdict                                                                                                                            | 15-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 20-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Innate ideas</b>                    | Locke defeats the naive innatist thesis of universally conscious innate content, but not the dispositional version Descartes actually held | ...Locke's decisive premise is that nothing can be in the mind unperceived; that premise, not the facts about children, does the work - and it is a stipulation                                                 | The dispute is not empirical but about what "in the mind" means. Locke wins the debate as staged and loses it as reformulated; innatism survives as a thesis about <b>structure</b> , which is precisely the form Kant vindicates                                                                            |
| <b>Abstract general ideas</b>          | Berkeley refutes abstraction only on an imagistic reading of ideas; on a determinable reading Locke stands                                 | ...Berkeley's positive account must specify the <b>respect</b> of representation - and the respect looks like the abstract idea readmitted                                                                      | The lasting casualty is not abstraction but the <b>ideational theory of meaning</b> that made abstraction necessary; the argument's true heir is Wittgenstein's family resemblance, not Hume's scepticism                                                                                                    |
| <b>Primary and secondary qualities</b> | The distinction survives as one between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties, but not as Locke's resemblance thesis     | ...Berkeley's parity argument defeats <b>resemblance</b> ; it does not defeat the scientific realist's <b>isomorphism</b> , since structural correspondence needs no qualitative likeness                       | Locke's mistake was to make the distinction depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role. Reconstructed as a claim about which properties enter physical explanation, it is defensible - which is why it survives in science while Locke's version does not                                           |
| <b>Berkeley's idealism</b>             | Berkeley is not denying the world; he denies an unperceivable substratum - his target is the philosopher's matter, not the grocer's apple  | ...He preserves ordinary object-talk at the price of an ad hoc asymmetry: ideas are known by ideas, spirits by "notions"                                                                                        | Berkeley's system is internally the most economical of the three but purchases its economy with God, who does exactly the work Locke's matter did. Immaterialism replaces an unknowable <b>substance</b> with an unperceivable <b>spirit</b> , a change of vocabulary before it is a gain in intelligibility |
| <b>Hume on causation</b>               | Hume does not deny causation; he relocates necessity from the object to the observer                                                       | ...His two definitions pull apart - the first objective and regularity-based, the second psychological - and he never reconciles them; this tension originates the modern regularity-versus-projectivist debate | Hume's result follows from the <b>atomism of impressions</b> , not from experience itself: if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived, and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise. Kant's answer is therefore correctly aimed - he attacks the atomism, not the inference         |
| <b>Induction</b>                       | The problem is genuine and unsolved; Hume's own answer is descriptive (custom), not justificatory                                          | ...The argument is a dilemma, and every serious reply must break a horn - Kant by adding the synthetic a priori, Popper by denying science needs induction, Strawson by dissolving the demand                   | The sceptical conclusion depends on the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative/probable dichotomy. Since that dichotomy is itself the fork, Hume's scepticism about induction is the shadow cast by his classification of propositions - which is why it survives only as long as the fork does                 |
| <b>The self</b>                        | Hume's bundle theory is the copy principle applied without exception to the perceiver                                                      | ...The Appendix retracts it: he cannot explain what unites the bundle, having denied both a substance and any real connexion. That honest failure is his most philosophically valuable page                     | The bundle theory is not a positive doctrine but the last casualty of empiricist atomism; that Hume can find no principle of unity, and says so, shows the atomism and not the self to be at fault - a diagnosis Kant makes explicit                                                                         |

| Sub-topic         | 10-mark verdict                                                                                          | 15-mark verdict                                                                                                                                             | 20-mark verdict                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scepticism</b> | Hume's scepticism is <b>mitigated</b> , not Pyrrhonian: nature compels the beliefs reason cannot justify | ...This yields a stable position only if the natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification - which concedes that not all belief needs reason | The slide from Locke to Hume is not decadence but rigour: each thinker applies the founding principle more consistently. That the principle consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live shows the principle to be <b>incomplete</b> - the conclusion Kant draws |

#### 4. Citation and provenance discipline

All three writers composed in **English**, so no translation issue arises - but edition and section discipline does.

| Text                                                                 | Citation practice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Cautions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Locke, <i>Essay Concerning Human Understanding</i>                   | Cite by <b>Book.Chapter.Section</b> : II.i.2 (white paper), II.viii (qualities), II.xxiii.2 (something I know not what), II.xxvii.9 (person), III.iii.6-11 (abstraction), IV.vii.9 (the general triangle)                                                                                                                                                            | FACT: Section references are edition-invariant. ANALYSIS: The <i>Essay</i> was published in <b>1689</b> with <b>1690</b> on the title page, and the personal-identity chapter II.xxvii was <b>added in the second edition of 1694</b> - never describe it as part of the original text                     |
| " <i>Tabula rasa</i> "                                               | ANALYSIS: <b>Not Locke's wording</b> . He writes of the mind as "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Write: "the mind as 'white paper, void of all characters' - the doctrine traditionally labelled <i>tabula rasa</i> ." A free provenance mark                                                                                                                                                               |
| Berkeley, <i>Principles</i> (1710) and <i>Three Dialogues</i> (1713) | Cite <i>Principles</i> by <b>section</b> : Intro Section 6-25, and Section 1-4, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 27, 30-33, 89, 140; cite the <i>Dialogues</i> by dialogue number                                                                                                                                                                                                     | FACT: " <i>Esse est percipi</i> " is Berkeley's own Latin ( <i>Principles</i> Section 3). WRONG: " <i>Esse est percipi aut percipere</i> " is a <b>later expansion</b> by commentators to accommodate spirits - do not present it as a quotation                                                           |
| Berkeley on Locke's triangle                                         | Berkeley quotes <i>Essay</i> IV.vii.9 verbatim at <i>Principles</i> , Intro Section 13                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | FACT: Safe to say "Berkeley quotes Locke's own words back at him" - it is literally true, and examiners notice                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Hume, <i>Treatise</i> (1739-40) and <i>Enquiry</i> (1748)            | Cite the <i>Treatise</i> by Book.Part.Section - I.i.1 missing shade; I.iii.14 necessary connexion; I.iv.2 belief in body; I.iv.6 personal identity; <b>Appendix</b> for the retraction - and the <i>Enquiry</i> by <b>Section</b> - II copy principle, IV induction, V custom, VII necessary connexion and the two definitions, X miracles, XII mitigated scepticism | ANALYSIS: Do not merge the two works: Hume disowned the <i>Treatise</i> as a juvenile work, and the <i>Enquiry</i> <b>drops</b> personal identity. Say which text you are using. The <i>Enquiry</i> appeared in 1748 as <i>Philosophical Essays concerning Human Understanding</i> and was renamed in 1758 |
| "Commit it then to the flames"                                       | <i>Enquiry</i> XII, final paragraph                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | FACT: Safe verbatim; note it is aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| "Reason is, and ought only to be, the slave of the passions"         | <i>Treatise</i> II.iii.3 - <b>Paper II / ethics material</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | WRONG: Do not deploy it as an epistemology quotation; it belongs to the theory of motivation                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| "Constant conjunction"; "custom is the great guide of human life"    | <i>Enquiry</i> V                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | FACT: Safe verbatim                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Samuel Johnson's stone                                               | Reported anecdote                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ANALYSIS: <b>Reception, not argument</b> . Berkeley never denied that the stone is felt                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**WRONG: Never write:** that Hume "denied causation" or that Berkeley "denied the existence of the external world." Both are examiner-flagged misreadings; Hume denies *observable objective necessity*, Berkeley denies *matter as an unperceiving substratum*.

## 5. Answer spines - three worked skeletons

10-MARK SPINE: "Locke's concept of personal identity" (2021 Q1d)

L1 Personal identity = continuity of consciousness; person at T2 = person at T1 iff present consciousness can appropriate T1's experiences.  
Body (i) NOT sameness of soul-substance (ii) NOT sameness of body  
(iii) consciousness is constitutive, memory is vehicle and evidence  
(iv) FORENSIC: identity tied to accountability; prince and cobbler  
Obj Butler/Reid circularity; Reid's Brave Officer breaks transitivity  
Close "Examine" = state + test; rule on the circularity charge's force.

15-MARK SPINE: "Hume's refutation of causal relation and Kant's response" (2025 Q2c)

Frame Hume's challenge: causation is not rationally grounded. Kant's answer.  
Body A no impression of necessary connexion; constant conjunction + custom; BOTH definitions of cause; consequence - induction unjustified.  
Body B Kant: cause is an A PRIORI CATEGORY; the mind imposes causal order; "every event has a cause" is synthetic a priori for possible experience; this rescues science without knowledge of things in themselves.  
Assess Does Kant answer Hume or relocate the problem? Kant attacks the ATOMISM, which is the correct target.  
Close Hume demolished dogmatic metaphysics; Kant rebuilt science on critical foundations.

20-MARK SPINE: "Causality is habit/custom - critically analyse" (2023 Q2a)

Frame Causation is the hinge of empiricism's critique of metaphysics and of science's rational basis.  
Body A Full analysis: constant conjunction + priority + contiguity; no impression of necessary connexion; custom as the source of expectation.  
Body B The impression of reflection; the association mechanism; the DISTINCTION between the PRACTICE of inference and its JUSTIFICATION.  
Body C Objections: (i) Kant - causality is a priori; (ii) pragmatic - science works, so there is real causal order; (iii) self-refutation worry - if causation is mere habit, Hume's own arguments lose force.  
Assess Hume succeeds in showing EXPERIENCE ALONE cannot ground causal necessity. Whether the Kantian a priori or a naturalist solution is best remains open. The sceptical result stands as a permanent constraint on dogmatism.  
Close "Critically analyse" = exposition + verdict; deliver one.

## HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

**Claim.** The three empiricist systems are best compared by a single criterion - what each will admit as an object of knowledge - because every other difference between them follows from that admission. **Named evidence.** Locke admits ideas plus an inferred material world whose primary qualities his ideas resemble; Berkeley admits ideas plus spirits known by notion and denies that "matter" names anything, since it is compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting; Hume admits only perceptions, and finds no impression corresponding to substance, to a simple self, or to necessary connexion. **Analysis.** Once the criterion is fixed, the differences on substance, qualities, self, causation, God and scepticism cease to be six separate disagreements and become six consequences of one decision, which is why the systems form a sequence rather than a set. **Qualification.** The sequence is a reconstruction rather than a historical necessity, since each step requires an added premise its predecessor could have refused - comparability for Berkeley and the atomism of impressions for Hume - so the honest conclusion is that empiricism consistently applied ends somewhere no one can live, which diagnoses the premise rather than refuting philosophy.

## Exam link

- 2018 Q3(a) and 2024 Q2(a) are decided in the comparison section; use matched axes and rule.
- Every 15- and 20-mark answer in this item should draw its middle section from the criticism ledger.
- The provenance table prevents the two most common factual errors in the whole item: quoting *tabula rasa* as Locke's words and quoting *esse est percipi aut percipere* as Berkeley's.

## UPSC traps

| Trap                     | Correction                                                                               |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three parallel summaries | Announce a criterion, then use matched axes                                              |
| Criticism without reply  | Every ledger entry has three columns                                                     |
| Ungraded verdicts        | Scale the ruling to the marks: 10 states, 15 refines, 20 diagnoses                       |
| Ignoring the directive   | "Examine", "critically analyse" and "is there any element" each demand a different shape |
| Loose quotation          | Use the provenance table; mark later labels as later labels                              |

## Revision notes

- Eight axes: matter · qualities · substance · self · causation · God · scepticism · overall position.
- Ledger discipline: criticism -> source -> reply -> **residual**.
- Directive fidelity: explain = derivation; examine = state and test; critically analyse = verdict.
- Graded verdicts scale: 10 states the ruling, 15 refines it, 20 diagnoses the premise.
- Provenance: *tabula rasa* and *esse est percipi aut percipere* are later labels; II.xxvii is a 1694 addition.
- Never write "Hume denied causation" or "Berkeley denied the external world".

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMPARISON AND ANSWER CRAFT

```

ANNOUNCE THE CRITERION: WHAT WILL EACH ADMIT AS AN OBJECT OF KNOWLEDGE?
|
v
RUN THE EIGHT AXES: MATTER | QUALITIES | SUBSTANCE | SELF | CAUSATION |
GOD | SCEPTICISM | OVERALL POSITION
|
+--> LOCKE represented matter -> moderate realism
+--> BERKELEY ideas + spirits -> theistic subjective idealism
+--> HUME perceptions only -> mitigated scepticism
|
v
LEDGER: CRITICISM -> SOURCE -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL (3 Locke, 4 Berkeley, 4 Hume)
|
v
DIRECTIVE DECODER: explain = derivation | examine = state and test |
critically analyse = verdict | "any element?" = yes-and-no with a distinction
|
v
GRADED VERDICT: 10 states | 15 refines | 20 diagnoses the premise
|
v
PROVENANCE: tabula rasa is a label, not a quotation | esse est percipi aut
percipere is a later expansion | II.xxvii added 1694 | Treatise != Enquiry
TRAP: three summaries | criticism without reply | ignoring the directive
ANSWER LINE: empiricism consistently applied ends where nobody can live -
which diagnoses the premise rather than refuting philosophy

```

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### 32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

**Answer placement:** each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

**Coverage:** the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - Theory of Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism - in Locke, Berkeley and Hume, together with innate ideas, sensation and reflection, the degrees of knowledge, abstraction and essence, the quality distinction, the substratum, personal identity, the demonstrative proof of God, nominalism, the five arguments for immaterialism, spirits and notions, the Hegel and Moore-Russell comparisons, impressions and ideas, the fork, the dissolution of substance, the belief in

body and the analysis of causation. The eight remedial drills attack the specific confusions that cost marks every year.

### MCQ 1. What the empiricist rule actually asserts

Consider the following statements about British empiricism as Locke, Berkeley and Hume hold it.

1. Every simple cognitive content must be traceable to experience, which includes inner awareness of the mind's own operations.
2. The mind's operations of comparing, combining and abstracting are themselves denied, since they are not derived from sensation.
3. No proposition whatever can be known independently of experience.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 2 inverts the doctrine, because Locke's whole account of complex ideas depends on the understanding actively combining and comparing what sensation supplies.
- **B:** Incorrect: it retains the denial of mental operations and adds a blanket rejection of a priori knowledge that Hume's own class of relations of ideas immediately contradicts.
- **C:** Correct: the rule governs the **origin of simple content** and expressly includes reflection, while leaving both the mind's operations and Hume's relations of ideas untouched.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting all three converts a thesis about where materials come from into a general hostility to reason that none of the three empiricists holds.

**Examiner trap 1:** Defining empiricism as hostility to reason is the commonest opening error in this item. Define it by the **origin of simple content**, and the answer stays on the printed syllabus from the first line.

### MCQ 2. Locke's grounds for rejecting innate ideas

Which one of the following is **not** among the grounds Locke advances in Book I of the *Essay* against innate ideas?

- A. If certain ideas were innate, every human being including children would possess them, which they manifestly do not.
- B. A thought that the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind.
- C. Every idea alleged to be innate can be shown to arise instead through sensation or reflection.
- D. Innate ideas would have to be lodged in a material substratum whose nature is entirely unknown to us.

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because the failure of universal assent is Locke's opening empirical ground against the innatist appeal to universal agreement.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because the impossibility of an unperceived idea is Locke's second and philosophically decisive ground.
- **C:** Incorrect as an answer, because the availability of a genetic account is the redundancy argument that makes the innate hypothesis idle.
- **D:** Correct: the substratum belongs to Book II's account of substance and plays no part whatever in the anti-innatist argument of Book I.

**Examiner trap 2:** Candidates import the "something I know not what" from the discussion of substance into the discussion of innate ideas. Keep Book I and Book II separate, because the examiner's marking scheme does.



### MCQ 3. Which ground does the decisive work

Locke's refutation of innate ideas is strongest against the dispositional innatism Descartes actually held only if one accepts his premise that

- A. to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind, so an unnoticed idea is a contradiction
- B. children and the cognitively impaired demonstrably lack all of the alleged innate content
- C. the mind at birth is white paper, void of all characters, upon which experience writes
- D. every idea has in fact been traced back to some corresponding act of sensation or reflection

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: only this premise blocks the dispositional retreat, and it is a stipulation about the meaning of "idea" rather than an empirical finding.
- **B:** Incorrect: the empirical observation is compatible with innate ideas that are capacities awaiting an occasion, which is exactly Descartes' position.
- **C:** Incorrect: the blank-page image states Locke's conclusion about content and cannot function as the premise that establishes it.
- **D:** Incorrect: a completed genetic account would show innateness unnecessary, but the dispositional innatist can accept the genesis and still claim a native capacity.

**Examiner trap 3:** Scripts that give only the children-and-idiots argument have chosen Locke's weakest ground. Name the premise about what "in the mind" means, and then say honestly that it is a stipulation.

### MCQ 4. Sorting Locke's complex ideas

Match each of Locke's three kinds of complex idea with its correct description.

1. Modes - 2. Substances - 3. Relations

I. Supposed independently existing bearers, represented through clusters of co-occurring qualities. II. Dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number. III. Ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause or identity.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

- A. 1-II, 2-I, 3-III
- B. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II
- C. 1-III, 2-II, 3-I
- D. 1-II, 2-III, 3-I

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: modes are dependent combinations, substances are supposed bearers represented through quality-clusters, and relations arise from comparison.
- **B:** Incorrect: it makes modes into supposed bearers, which would leave Locke without any category for triangle, gratitude or number.
- **C:** Incorrect: it turns modes into comparative ideas and substances into dependent combinations, dissolving the distinction Locke needs for Book III.
- **D:** Incorrect: it keeps modes right but exchanges substances and relations, so that "gold" becomes a comparison and "cause" becomes a bearer.

**Examiner trap 4:** Listing the three kinds without noticing that **substance appears here as a complex idea** wastes the classification's real payload - the admission that we have a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.

### MCQ 5. The three degrees of knowledge

Match each degree of Lockean knowledge with the case it certifies.

1. Intuitive - 2. Demonstrative - 3. Sensitive

I. The existence of a particular thing now affecting the senses. II. The existence of God, established through intervening ideas. III. That white is not black, seen immediately without a middle term.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II

B. 1-III, 2-II, 3-I

C. 1-II, 2-I, 3-III

D. 1-III, 2-I, 3-II

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it assigns immediate certainty to particular existents and relegates the self-evident case to the middle rank, inverting Locke's own ordering.
- **B:** Correct: intuition is immediate, demonstration proceeds through intervening ideas, and sensitive knowledge concerns particular things now present to sense.
- **C:** Incorrect: it makes God intuitively known, which Locke expressly denies, and demotes the existence of present things to demonstration.
- **D:** Incorrect: it starts correctly but then treats particular existents as demonstrated and God as sensed, which reverses the two lower degrees.

**Examiner trap 5:** The examinable point is not the list but the **placement of the external world at the weakest degree**. Say that, and the instability Berkeley exploits becomes visible in your own answer rather than in the examiner's comment.

### MCQ 6. Locke's account of general words

According to *Essay* III.iii, an idea becomes general when the mind

A. discovers a universal subsisting outside the mind and then forms an exact copy of it

B. selects one particular idea and resolves to let it stand for all the others of that sort

C. compares two particulars and perceives the relation that holds between them in reality

D. separates it from the circumstances of time and place and from every concomitant idea

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: Locke expressly denies that general and universal belong to the real existence of things, calling them inventions and creatures of the understanding.
- **B:** Incorrect: making a determinate particular stand for a class is Berkeley's replacement doctrine at *Principles* Introduction Section 12, offered against Locke.
- **C:** Incorrect: comparison yields ideas of relation, which is a different category of complex idea and does not explain generality.
- **D:** Correct: abstraction is separation from circumstances of time, place and concomitants, leaving an idea that serves as a general representative of the sort.

**Examiner trap 6:** Attributing selective attention to Locke silently hands him Berkeley's solution and leaves the 2025 question with no dispute to explain. Keep **subtraction** with Locke and **selection** with Berkeley.

### MCQ 7. Nominal and real essence

Consider the following statements about Locke's two essences.

1. The nominal essence of gold is the abstract idea annexed to the name, such as being yellow, heavy, malleable and soluble in aqua regia.
2. The real essence is the internal constitution from which the observable properties flow, and we generally do not know it.
3. Classification of things into sorts proceeds by real essence, which is why our species divisions track nature exactly.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Correct: nominal essence is the known idea attached to the name and real essence is the unknown internal constitution, and only the first can do classificatory work.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 contradicts Locke's central claim that sorting is the workmanship of the understanding rather than a reading-off of nature.
- **C:** Incorrect: it correctly describes real essence but then makes it the basis of classification, which would require the very knowledge Locke says we lack.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 alongside the other two makes Locke both agnostic about real essences and dependent on them for sorting.

**Examiner trap 7:** Writing that Locke "denies real essences" is as wrong as writing that we classify by them. He affirms that things have internal constitutions and denies that we know them.

### MCQ 8. What Locke means by a secondary quality

For Locke, the sweetness of a lump of sugar is best described as

- A. an idea existing only in the mind, with nothing at all in the sugar corresponding to it
- B. a power in the sugar, grounded in its primary-quality configuration, to produce a sensation
- C. an illusion produced by the imagination when qualities are constantly conjoined in our experience
- D. a primary quality whose resemblance to our idea is guaranteed by the principle of divine veracity

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it drops the crucial word "power" and leaves the object with no basis at all for the sensation, which is Berkeley's position rather than Locke's.
- **B:** Correct: secondary qualities are **powers** in the object, arising from primary-quality arrangements acting on our sense-organs.
- **C:** Incorrect: fictions produced by constant conjunction belong to Hume's account of substance and necessity, not to Locke's account of qualities.
- **D:** Incorrect: sweetness is precisely not a primary quality, and Locke denies that ideas of secondary qualities resemble anything in the object.

**Examiner trap 8:** "Secondary qualities are subjective" is the sentence that loses the mark. Write "**powers**", because the sugar really does have the power even though our idea resembles nothing in it.

### MCQ 9. The substratum in Locke

Which one of the following most accurately states Locke's position on substance at *Essay II.xxiii.2*?

- A. Substance is a self-contradictory abstraction, since being and supporting cannot be combined into any single idea at all.
- B. Substance is directly perceived by the understanding whenever a cluster of qualities is presented together in experience.
- C. Substance is a fiction of the imagination, invented only because the qualities are found to be constantly conjoined.
- D. Substance exists and supports the qualities, but we have no positive idea of its nature and merely suppose a support.

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the charge that substance-in-general is an incoherent abstraction is Berkeley's conclusion, drawn against Locke rather than stated by him.
- **B:** Incorrect: Locke's whole point is that the cluster is perceived while the supposed support is never presented to sense at all.
- **C:** Incorrect: the diagnosis of substance as an imaginative fiction produced by constant conjunction is Hume's verdict, reached by applying the copy principle.
- **D:** Correct: Locke affirms existence and denies knowledge of nature, describing the substratum as "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".

**Examiner trap 9:** The three positions on substance are easy to swap under time pressure. Fix them by their verbs: Locke **supposes**, Berkeley **denies the sense**, Hume **dissolves into a bundle**.

### MCQ 10. The prince and the cobbler

Locke's case in which the prince's consciousness comes to inform the cobbler's body is designed to establish that

- A. the identity of a person is fixed throughout by the continued existence of the same immaterial soul
- B. bodily continuity and consciousness must always coincide in any case that could actually occur
- C. memory is merely evidential, so that neither consciousness nor the body settles who the person is
- D. personal identity follows consciousness, while the identity of the human animal follows the organism

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the case is constructed precisely to detach personal identity from sameness of substance, immaterial or material.
- **B:** Incorrect: the thought-experiment is valuable because it prisms the two apart, and Locke's argument requires that they can in principle diverge.
- **C:** Incorrect: Locke does treat memory as the vehicle and evidence, but consciousness remains constitutive, so the person is definitely settled.
- **D:** Correct: the person who wakes is the prince and the man who wakes is the cobbler, which separates personal from animal and substantial identity in a single stroke.

**Examiner trap 10:** Retelling the story without stating the **three-fold distinction** it illustrates turns a decisive argument into an anecdote. Name person, man and substance before you narrate.

### MCQ 11. Reid's Brave Officer

The Brave Officer case is directed against Locke's criterion because it shows that

- A. a criterion built on the reach of consciousness need not be transitive, whereas identity is
- B. memories of childhood are frequently unreliable and therefore cannot ground any criterion
- C. consciousness is interrupted every night by dreamless sleep, so no person survives until morning
- D. a person may be punished for an act that he sincerely and permanently fails to remember

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the officer remembers the boy and the general remembers the officer, but the general does not remember the boy, so the relation fails the transitivity that identity requires.
- **B:** Incorrect: the objection is formal rather than evidential, and it would succeed even if every remembered episode were perfectly accurate.
- **C:** Incorrect: the interruption problem is a distinct objection, answered by appeal to a continuing capacity for appropriation rather than to constant recollection.
- **D:** Incorrect: the forensic consequence is a difficulty Locke embraces, since he holds that we are accountable only for what we can appropriate.

**Examiner trap 11:** Stating the objection without the repair is only half the work. The Lockean answer is **overlapping chains** of consciousness, which restores transitivity at the cost of the simple memory reading.

### MCQ 12. How Locke claims to know that God exists

In Locke's classification, the existence of God is known by

- A. intuition, since the idea of a most perfect being contains existence within itself
- B. sensitive knowledge, since the order of the perceived world is immediately given
- C. demonstration, proceeding from one's own existence by way of the causal principle
- D. an innate idea implanted in every mind and elicited on reaching the age of reason

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: an intuitive or definitional route is the ontological strategy, which Locke does not use and which sits ill with his account of ideas.
- **B:** Incorrect: sensitive knowledge is reserved for particular things now affecting the senses and could never reach an eternal being.
- **C:** Correct: from the intuitive certainty of my own existence, together with the principle that nothing comes from nothing, Locke demonstrates an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being.
- **D:** Incorrect: an innate idea of God is one of the candidates Book I explicitly dismisses, so this option contradicts the foundation of Locke's system.

**Examiner trap 12:** The examinable payoff is the **exposed premise**: the causal principle Locke leans on is exactly what Hume later refuses to certify. Name that link and the comparative question answers itself.

### MCQ 13. What Berkeley's attack on abstraction does and does not deny

Consider the following statements about the Introduction to Berkeley's *Principles*.

1. He concedes that we can imagine a hand separately from the body, because such parts could exist apart.
2. He denies that we can frame an idea of extension without any colour or of motion without a determinate speed.
3. He concludes that general words and general reasoning are impossible and must be abandoned.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 3 attributes to Berkeley the destruction of general reasoning, whereas he offers an alternative account of it in the very next section.
- **B:** Correct: he permits separation of what could exist apart, denies separation of what could not, and stops precisely there.
- **C:** Incorrect: it correctly reports the denial but adds a conclusion Berkeley never draws and which would make his own geometry unintelligible.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 turns a targeted attack on abstract ideas into a general scepticism about language that Berkeley expressly rejects.

**Examiner trap 13:** Berkeley denies **abstract** general ideas, not general ideas. A script that reports him as abolishing generality cannot then explain how the geometer proves anything.

### MCQ 14. Berkeley's replacement account of generality

On Berkeley's positive account, an idea is general in virtue of

- A. being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort
- B. having every determinate feature stripped away until only the common nature remains
- C. corresponding to a nominal essence that the understanding annexes to a sortal name
- D. being formed by the imagination out of impressions that resemble one another closely

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the formula of *Principles* Introduction Section 12, and the geometer's determinate inch-long line proving a theorem about all lines is its illustration.
- **B:** Incorrect: stripping determinations is precisely the Lockean abstraction Berkeley has just declared impossible.
- **C:** Incorrect: nominal essence is Locke's device, and Berkeley's objection is that no abstract idea is available to be annexed to the name.
- **D:** Incorrect: building general ideas out of resembling impressions describes a Humean associationist account rather than Berkeley's doctrine of representative use.

**Examiner trap 14:** The unpaid bill in Berkeley's account is what fixes the **respect** under which the particular idea represents. Raise it yourself and the answer reads as assessment rather than as reportage.

### MCQ 15. Matching Berkeley's arguments for immaterialism

Match each argument with the move that characterises it.

1. Likeness - 2. Parity - 3. Master Argument - 4. Continuity

I. Every relativity consideration Locke accepts against secondary qualities applies to primary ones too. II. The involuntary and law-governed order of sense requires an active spirit of greater power than mine. III. An idea can be like nothing but an idea, so an unperceivable original cannot be resembled. IV. You cannot conceive a body existing unconceived, because in conceiving it you conceive it.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1-III, 2-IV, 3-I, 4-II

B. 1-III, 2-I, 3-IV, 4-II

C. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II, 4-IV

D. 1-IV, 2-I, 3-III, 4-II

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it correctly identifies likeness but then exchanges parity and the Master Argument, so the relativity considerations are attributed to the wrong section.
- **B:** Correct: likeness is Section 8, parity is Section 9-15, the Master Argument is Section 22-23, and continuity is Section 6, 30-33 and 48.
- **C:** Incorrect: it treats parity as the likeness principle and continuity as the challenge about conceiving, reversing two independent arguments.
- **D:** Incorrect: it assigns the conceivability challenge to the likeness principle, which confuses a semantic point about resemblance with a psychological one about conceiving.

**Examiner trap 15:** Naming five arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag is the largest single differentiator available on Berkeley. Learn them as **semantic, likeness, parity, master, continuity**.

### MCQ 16. The likeness principle and its strongest answer

The most effective reply available to a defender of Locke against the principle that "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" is that

A. structural or mathematical correspondence needs no qualitative likeness, as a map matches terrain

B. divine veracity guarantees that our ideas of primary qualities resemble what causes them

C. the principle is self-refuting, since Berkeley must compare his own ideas with one another in order to state it at all

D. resemblance between an idea and a quality is a brute relation that stands in need of no further defence whatever

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Correct: isomorphism preserves the representational relation while conceding Berkeley's point that a colour can only be like a colour.
- **B:** Incorrect: appealing to divine veracity answers the sceptical worry about reliability, not the semantic worry about what likeness could even mean here.
- **C:** Incorrect: Berkeley compares ideas with ideas throughout, which is exactly what his principle permits, so no self-refutation arises.
- **D:** Incorrect: declaring the relation brute concedes that it cannot be explained or checked, which is the objection rather than an answer to it.

**Examiner trap 16:** Treating the likeness principle as unanswerable produces an unbalanced answer. Concede that the **qualitative** thesis falls and defend the **structural** one; that is where the modern rescue of Locke lives.

### MCQ 17. The Master Argument and the objection to it

The standard objection that Berkeley's Master Argument commits a scope or use-mention confusion holds that

- A. Berkeley illegitimately assumes that only spirits can be causes, which no materialist need ever concede
- B. the argument proves far too much, since it would equally show that unperceived numbers cannot exist
- C. what is inconceivable is conceiving of X that it is unconceived, not conceiving that X is unconceived
- D. conceiving a tree is a mental act, and mental acts are ideas, so the tree must itself be an idea too

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: voluntarism is the presupposition of the continuity argument, not of the challenge about conceiving an unconceived body.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is a different reductio, and Berkeley would in any case handle abstract objects through his account of representative use.
- **C:** Correct: the objection separates the content of the thought from the act of thinking, exactly as one can think about a number nobody has thought about.
- **D:** Incorrect: this restates Berkeley's own conclusion rather than objecting to it, and the inference from act to object is precisely what Moore later attacks.

**Examiner trap 17:** Building a Berkeley answer around the Master Argument alone is risky, because it is the weakest of the five and has a well-known reply. Use it fourth, and give Berkeley's question-begging rejoinder.

### MCQ 18. Spirits, notions and the work God performs

Consider the following statements about Berkeley's positive ontology.

1. Spirits are known by notion rather than by idea, because an idea is passive and could never picture an activity.
2. The laws of nature describe stable sequences in a divine language, so regularities function as signs rather than as causes.
3. Berkeley infers God from the passivity of ideas together with the involuntary and orderly arrival of sense-experience.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it omits the derivation of God, which is the step that turns the ontology from a bare inventory into an argument.
- **B:** Correct: all three statements are accurate, and together they show that God is a structural requirement of immaterialism rather than a devotional addition.
- **C:** Incorrect: it drops the notion doctrine, without which Berkeley cannot claim to know spirits at all on his own principles.
- **D:** Incorrect: it omits the account of natural law, which is what allows Berkeley to answer the objection that immaterialism destroys science.

**Examiner trap 18:** Presenting God as an afterthought invites the reply that Berkeley is merely pious. Derive him from the **inertness of ideas** and the objection changes from piety to substitution of posits.



### MCQ 19. Berkeley's idealism compared with Hegel's

The decisive difference between Berkeley's subjective idealism and Hegel's absolute idealism is that

- A. Berkeley denies the reality of the external world while Hegel affirms it as a moment of the Absolute
- B. Berkeley reaches idealism by dialectic while Hegel reaches it through an analysis of perception
- C. Berkeley treats matter as unknowable while Hegel treats it as fully knowable by natural science
- D. Berkeley's reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, Hegel's the self-development of Spirit

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Berkeley does not deny the external world; he denies material substance and retains sensible things as collections of ideas.
- **B:** Incorrect: the methods are exactly reversed, since dialectical development is Hegel's procedure and anti-abstraction is Berkeley's.
- **C:** Incorrect: unknowable matter is Locke's substratum, which Berkeley rejects outright rather than adopts.
- **D:** Correct: one is a theistic subjective idealism resting on perception, the other an objective idealism in which objectivity is a moment within self-developing Spirit.

**Examiner trap 19:** Calling Berkeley "an early Hegel" is a category error the 2024 paper is designed to detect. The two differ **in kind**, not in degree, and the answer must say so explicitly.

### MCQ 20. Moore and Russell against Berkeley

The difference between Moore's and Russell's reactions to Berkeley is best stated by saying that

- A. Moore accepts Berkeley's premises but rejects the conclusion, whereas Russell rejects them
- B. Moore defends the ordinary object as directly known, whereas Russell replaces it with a construction
- C. Moore relies on the verification principle of meaning, whereas Russell relies on the picture theory of meaning
- D. Moore denies the act-object distinction altogether, whereas Russell insists that awareness and object are identical

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Moore's central move is to reject the premise that conflates the act of awareness with its object, so he does not accept Berkeley's premises.
- **B:** Correct: Moore's transparency argument supports direct realism, while Russell reconstructs physical objects analytically and keeps only structural objectivity.
- **C:** Incorrect: both doctrines named here belong to other syllabus items and to later phases, and neither is deployed against Berkeley in this context.
- **D:** Incorrect: it inverts both positions, since it is Moore who insists on the act-object distinction and the idealist who collapses it.

**Examiner trap 20:** The 2018 question asks a third thing after the two reactions: whether they **differ**. An answer that reports both and never contrasts them has left a whole limb unanswered.

### MCQ 21. Impressions, ideas and the missing shade of blue

Consider the following statements about Hume's copy principle.

1. It holds that every simple idea derives from a corresponding simple impression.
2. Hume concedes the missing shade of blue as a case in which a simple idea arises without its antecedent impression.
3. The concession shows that the copy principle is an empirical generalisation rather than an analytic truth.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it omits the consequence that makes the concession worth stating, namely the demotion of the principle to an empirical generalisation.
- **B:** Incorrect: it drops the statement of the principle itself, leaving the concession and its consequence without the claim they qualify.
- **C:** Correct: all three are accurate, and together they turn a descriptive report of Hume into a critical one.
- **D:** Incorrect: it asserts the consequence while omitting the very case that generates it, which leaves the criticism unsupported.

**Examiner trap 21:** Concede the missing shade **before** the examiner raises it, and supply Hume's reply that the shade is interpolated between impressions actually had, so the principle's spirit survives its letter.

### MCQ 22. Placing two propositions inside Hume's fork

For Hume, the propositions " $2+2=4$ " and "The Sun will rise tomorrow" differ because

- A. the first is certain and the second is highly probable, though both are ultimately relations of ideas
- B. the first is a matter of fact whose evidence is overwhelming, the second one whose evidence is weaker
- C. the first is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory, the second a contingent matter of fact
- D. both are matters of fact, differing only in the number of past instances that have so far supported them

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it correctly notes the difference in certainty but then places both propositions in the same box, which erases the fork.
- **B:** Incorrect: treating an arithmetical truth as a well-evidenced matter of fact makes its denial merely improbable rather than contradictory.
- **C:** Correct: the fork divides a priori necessary relations of ideas from a posteriori contingent matters of fact, and conceivability is the operative test.
- **D:** Incorrect: counting instances is irrelevant to a relation of ideas, and this option reduces the distinction to a difference in inductive support.

**Examiner trap 22:** The 2018 question is built to catch exactly the answer that says both truths are equally necessary or merely differ in probability. Give the **conceivability** test in the first line.

### MCQ 23. Substance and the belief in body

Consider the following statements about Hume.

1. He concludes that "substance" is a fiction of the imagination, since no impression of a bearer can be found.
2. The dissolution applies to material substance only, spiritual substance being secured by inner awareness.
3. Constancy and coherence among perceptions lead the imagination to feign continued and distinct bodies.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains the false exemption for spiritual substance and omits the general verdict that substance is an imaginative fiction.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 is precisely the point at which Hume passes beyond Berkeley, who did retain spirit as an active substance.
- **C:** Incorrect: accepting statement 2 would make Hume's treatment of the self inconsistent with his treatment of body.
- **D:** Correct: the copy principle dissolves material and spiritual substance alike, while constancy and coherence explain why we nevertheless believe in continuing bodies.

**Examiner trap 23:** Writing that Hume "proves there is no external world" reverses his conclusion. He shows that **reason cannot justify** the belief, and then explains why nature makes it unavoidable.

### MCQ 24. What Hume finds and does not find in causation

In Hume's analysis, the idea of necessary connexion is copied from

- A. the observed contiguity and temporal priority of the two events considered together in one instance
- B. an innate structure of the understanding that organises perceptions
- C. an impression of reflection: the mind's felt determination to pass from cause to effect
- D. the repeated observation that gives the hundredth collision a quality which the first collision lacked

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: contiguity and priority are genuinely observed, but they are precisely the elements that fall short of any necessity.
- **B:** Incorrect: an a priori rule of the understanding is Kant's answer in the Second Analogy, offered against Hume rather than by him.
- **C:** Correct: repetition changes the mind rather than the objects, and the felt determination it installs is the internal impression from which the idea is copied.
- **D:** Incorrect: Hume insists that repetition adds no new quality to the objects, so the hundredth collision is qualitatively identical to the first.

**Examiner trap 24:** Stopping at "constant conjunction" gives only the negative half. The positive half - the **impression of reflection** - is what makes the account an explanation rather than a denial.

### MCQ 25 (remedial). The two definitions of cause

Hume's two definitions of cause are best characterised as

- A. one objective and regularity-based, the other psychological and framed by the thought conveyed
- B. one applying only to physical events and the other exclusively to acts of the human will
- C. two equivalent formulations that Hume explicitly proves to be interchangeable in every case
- D. an earlier definition given in the *Treatise* which he then formally withdraws in the *Enquiry*

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the first defines a cause as an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed; the second as one whose appearance conveys the thought to the other.
- **B:** Incorrect: both definitions are perfectly general, and the discussion of volition is used to close an escape route rather than to found a second domain.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two pull apart rather than coincide, and Hume never demonstrates their equivalence - a tension that generates a modern debate.
- **D:** Incorrect: both definitions appear together in *Enquiry* VII, so there is no withdrawal of one in favour of the other.

**Examiner trap 25:** Giving only one definition is the most expensive omission in this sub-topic. Name **both**, then note that Hume leaves their relation unreconciled.

### MCQ 26 (remedial). What the bundle theory denies

Hume's bundle theory of the self is correctly stated as the claim that

- A. the perceptions themselves are fictions, so that nothing whatever exists in the mind at all
- B. personal identity is constituted by the continuity of the living human organism over time
- C. the self is an active spirit whose existence is known by notion rather than by any idea
- D. there is no simple, identical self-substance, although the perceptions are entirely real

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Hume never doubts the perceptions; his argument is precisely that they are all introspection delivers.
- **B:** Incorrect: an organism-based criterion is Locke's account of the same **man**, which he distinguishes carefully from the person.
- **C:** Incorrect: the active spirit known by notion is Berkeley's doctrine, and Hume's dissolution of spiritual substance is directed against it.
- **D:** Correct: what is denied is the owner behind the perceptions, and the perceptions in perpetual flux are what remain.

**Examiner trap 26:** "Hume says the self does not exist" is the sentence that wrecks this answer. Say that **no simple identical substance** is found, and then add the Appendix confession.

### MCQ 27 (remedial). Kant's two routed replies

Match each Kantian doctrine with the Humean problem it answers.

1. Transcendental unity of apperception - 2. Second Analogy

I. The absence of any source impression for necessary connexion between events. II. The absence of any constant and invariable impression of a continuing self.

Which of the following statements is correct?

- A. 1 answers I, and 2 answers II, since apperception concerns events and the Analogy concerns the subject
- B. Neither answers a Humean problem, since Kant rejects the copy principle
- C. Both answer II, since apperception and the Analogy are two names for the same doctrine of unity
- D. 1 answers II, and 2 answers I, and in both cases Kant accepts Hume's negative finding

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it reverses the pairing, attaching the unity of the subject to the analysis of events and the causal rule to self-consciousness.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant expressly agrees that no impression yields a soul-substance or a necessary connexion, and builds his reply on that agreement.
- **C:** Incorrect: they are distinct doctrines with distinct arguments, one concerning the unity of experience and the other the objectivity of succession.
- **D:** Correct: apperception addresses the missing unity of the self and the Second Analogy the missing necessity in causation, in each case by supplying a formal condition rather than an observed item.

**Examiner trap 27:** Reporting Kant as "proving the soul exists" or as "refuting Hume's premise" inverts him. He **accepts** the negative results and attacks the atomism of impressions instead.

### MCQ 28 (remedial). Where every reply to the problem of induction must strike

Kant, Popper and Strawson all direct their answers to Hume's induction dilemma at the step which asserts that

- A. all reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory rests on cause and effect
- B. the Uniformity Principle can be established only demonstratively or probably, by no third route
- C. the denial of the Uniformity Principle implies no contradiction and is therefore perfectly conceivable
- D. any experiential argument for the Uniformity Principle already presupposes that very principle

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the dependence of factual inference on causal reasoning is accepted by all three respondents and is not the contested step.
- **B:** Correct: the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative-or-probable division is the fork applied reflexively, and each reply breaks it differently.
- **C:** Incorrect: the conceivability of nature changing is granted on all sides, and disputing it would require abandoning Hume's account of possibility.
- **D:** Incorrect: the circularity of experiential support is the least contested move in the argument and is generally conceded outright.

**Examiner trap 28:** An answer that attacks a horn of the dilemma without noticing that the **division itself** is Hume's fork has not located the argument's weight-bearing assumption.

### MCQ 29 (remedial). Two sentences that must never be written

Consider the following two statements.

1. Berkeley denies the existence of the external world.
2. Hume denies causation.

Which of the following corrects both?

- A. Berkeley denies only unperceived objects, while Hume denies only that causes precede their effects
- B. Berkeley denies sensible things but keeps spirits; Hume denies causal inference but keeps conjunction
- C. Berkeley denies material substance but keeps sensible things; Hume denies objective necessity only
- D. Both statements are accurate summaries of the two positions and are safe to use in an examination

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: unperceived objects persist for Berkeley through divine perception, and temporal priority is one of the elements Hume explicitly retains.
- **B:** Incorrect: Berkeley affirms sensible things rather than denying them, and Hume never abandons causal inference, which custom makes unavoidable.
- **C:** Correct: each denial is narrower than the slogan, and stating the exact target is what converts a misreading into an accurate account.
- **D:** Incorrect: both are examiner-flagged misreadings, and either sentence can cost marks even when the rest of the answer is sound.

**Examiner trap 29:** These two slogans are the most frequently penalised sentences in the whole item. Replace them with the exact targets: **matter as unperceiving substratum**, and **observable objective necessity**.

### MCQ 30 (remedial). Provenance and dating

Consider the following statements about the texts of this syllabus item.

1. "*Tabula rasa*" is Locke's own phrase in the *Essay*.
2. "*Esse est percipi aut percipere*" is Berkeley's own Latin in the *Principles*.
3. The chapter on personal identity was added to the *Essay* in the second edition of 1694.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 2 and 3 only

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: only the dating claim is accurate, since Locke writes of "white paper, void of all characters" and Berkeley's own Latin at Section 3 is *esse est percipi* without the addition.
- **B:** Incorrect: both Latin attributions are later labels, one Scholastic in origin and the other a commentators' expansion made to accommodate spirits.
- **C:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the *tabula rasa* misattribution, which is the commonest quotation error in this item.
- **D:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the expanded Latin formula, which Berkeley never wrote.

**Examiner trap 30:** Free marks are available for a single provenance clause. Write "the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*" and cite *esse est percipi* at Section 3 without the expansion.

**MCQ 31 (remedial). What this syllabus item does not own**

Which one of the following belongs to this syllabus item rather than to another owner?

- A. Quine's argument in "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" against the analytic-synthetic distinction
- B. Kant's transcendental exposition of space and time together with his table of the categories
- C. Hume's account of why we believe in continued bodies despite interrupted perception
- D. Hegel's dialectical method and the movement of determinate negation towards the Absolute

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: the *Two Dogmas* material is routed to Quine and Strawson, and sharing the word "empiricism" creates no ownership here.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant's positive system belongs to the next syllabus item and appears here only as the explicitly routed reply on the self and on causation.
- **C:** Correct: constancy, coherence and the feigned continuity of bodies are Hume's own doctrine and sit inside the printed clause on substance and scepticism.
- **D:** Incorrect: Hegel's method belongs to its own item and enters here only as one term of the comparison the 2024 paper requires.

**Examiner trap 31:** Importing another owner's doctrine wastes the words a 15-mark answer cannot spare. Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell enter **only** where a routed question names them.

**MCQ 32 (remedial). What a comparative answer in this item must contain**

A twenty-mark comparative answer on Locke, Berkeley and Hume earns its marks primarily by

- A. narrating each philosopher's system in turn and closing with a paragraph of general observations
- B. announcing a single criterion, running matched axes, and ruling on the sequence it produces
- C. reproducing the chronology of publication so that the historical influences are fully displayed
- D. listing every objection raised against each thinker without adjudicating between them

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:**

- **A:** Incorrect: three parallel summaries display information without explaining the relation the examiner has asked about.
- **B:** Correct: a stated criterion converts six separate disagreements into six consequences of one decision, which is exactly what a comparison is for.
- **C:** Incorrect: chronology prevents anachronism but does not by itself explain why each successor rejects his predecessor's exemption.
- **D:** Incorrect: an unadjudicated list of objections is journalism, and the residual column is where judgement is actually shown.

**Examiner trap 32:** The comparative mark is awarded for the **mechanism**, not for the coverage. State the criterion in the opening sentence and let the table function as evidence for it.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers; the 2019, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts were read directly from the official question papers held in books\philosophy\_optional\, and the 2018 and 2020 parts follow the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger because those two Paper I question papers are not present locally. Doctrinal claims are attributed to their *Essay* Book.Chapter.Section, *Principles* section or *Treatise/Enquiry* location, and interpretive disputes - whether Locke's substratum is a humble posit or an empty placeholder, whether the Master Argument proves anything beyond a scope confusion, whether Hume is better read as a destructive sceptic or as a naturalist - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

**Answer-length convention used throughout this package.** UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

**Coverage:** twelve directly owned Empiricism PYQs from 2018 to 2025 - every part the ledger routes to this syllabus item, in every year of the corpus - and six original solved Mains models, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks.

**Citation discipline used in every answer.** Locke is cited by Book.Chapter.Section of the *Essay* (II.i.2, II.viii, II.xxiii.2, II.xxvii.9, III.iii.6-11, IV.vii.9); Berkeley by section of the *Principles* (Intro Section Section 6-25, and Section Section 3, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 27, 30-33); Hume by *Treatise* Book.Part.Section (I.i.1, I.iii.14, I.iv.2, I.iv.6, Appendix) and by *Enquiry* Section (II, IV, V, VII, X, XII). Latin tags that are later labels rather than the author's own words are marked as such.

#### 2018 · Q1(a) · 10 marks

**Question:** Are the two truths-'The Sun will rise tomorrow' and ' $2+2=4$ ' of the same necessity for Hume? Give reasons in favour of your answer.

#### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Are they ...? Give reasons" - a <b>direct verdict</b> in the first line, then justification                                |
| Core issue      | Whether Hume's fork admits degrees of necessity or two different kinds                                                      |
| Scope boundary  | Ten marks: the fork, the conceivability test, the induction consequence, one verdict                                        |
| Ideal thesis    | No - they belong to different classes, and the difference is in kind, not in degree of evidence                             |
| Non-negotiables | Relations of ideas versus matters of fact; denial-contradiction versus conceivability; custom; no appeal to "more probable" |

#### Independent model answer

No. For Hume the two propositions fall on opposite sides of a division that admits no intermediate case.

" $2+2=4$ " states a **relation of ideas**. It is discoverable by thought alone, its truth does not depend on anything existing in the world, and its denial is self-contradictory. Necessity here is absolute and its warrant is *a priori*.

"The Sun will rise tomorrow" states a **matter of fact**. Its contrary - that the Sun will not rise - implies no contradiction whatever and is perfectly conceivable, which is Hume's operative test. No amount of past regularity converts conceivable falsehood into impossibility.

The reason is structural. Every factual inference beyond present sense and memory runs through cause and effect, and causal inference presupposes that the future will resemble the past. That principle cannot be demonstrated, since its denial is conceivable, and cannot be established from experience without circularity. What sustains the expectation is **custom or habit**, not reason.



So the necessity attaching to the sunrise is psychological - a felt determination of the mind - while the necessity of the arithmetical truth is logical.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Not of the same necessity: one is demonstrative, the other an unavoidable expectation grounded in habit.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q1(a):** the question is a yes/no, and it must be answered before it is explained. A script that describes the fork without ruling has answered a different question.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** verdict in one line; each proposition placed in two or three lines; the induction consequence in four; the closing distinction in one.

- **Structure:** verdict -> classification of each proposition -> the reason the classification holds -> distinction of the two necessities.
- **Doctrine:** relations of ideas; matters of fact; the Uniformity Principle; custom.
- **Evidence:** conceivability of the contrary as the operative test; *Enquiry* IV and V.
- **Distinction:** logical necessity versus a psychological determination of the mind.
- **Criticism:** note that the fork is a classification, so the result is as secure as the fork itself.

### 2018 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

**Question:** How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real? How do Moore and Russell react to Berkeley's view in this regard? Do you find any difference between Moore's reaction and Russell's one? Discuss.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | Three limbs: <b>establish, react, difference</b> - all three must appear                                                     |
| Core issue      | The derivation of immaterialism, and two distinct twentieth-century refusals of it                                           |
| Scope boundary  | Twenty marks: five arguments compressed, two reactions, one explicit contrast, one verdict                                   |
| Ideal thesis    | Berkeley's case is cumulative; Moore rejects the inference, Russell rebuilds the object - they differ in what they preserve  |
| Non-negotiables | Anti-abstraction; <i>Principles</i> Section Section 1-4, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 30-33; act-object distinction; logical construction |

### Independent model answer

Berkeley's case is cumulative, and it begins before metaphysics. In the Introduction to the *Principles* he denies **abstract general ideas**: we may separate what could exist apart - a hand from a body - but not extension from colour, motion from determinate speed, or "man" from every determinate stature. Locke's *material substance in general* is exactly such an abstraction, compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting, so "matter" is not an unknown thing but an expression without content.

Five arguments then follow. The **semantic** argument (Section Section 1-4) holds that the objects of knowledge are ideas, that "sensible things" means what is immediately perceived, and that an apple or a tree is nothing but a collection of such ideas; since ideas cannot exist unperceived, for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (Section 3). The **likeness principle** (Section 8) holds that an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and that a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked, which destroys Locke's representative relation. The **parity** argument (Section Section 9-15) extends Locke's own relativity considerations from secondary to primary qualities, leaving nothing for matter to be. The **Master Argument** (Section Section 22-23) challenges us to conceive an unconceived body and answers that in conceiving it we conceive it. Finally, since ideas are passive yet arrive involuntarily in settled order, an active infinite spirit must produce and sustain them (Section Section 30-33): reality is spirits and their ideas.

**Moore** attacks the inference from "experienced" to "dependent on experience" by distinguishing the **act** of awareness from its **object**: awareness of blue is not identical with blue. His transparency argument yields direct realism, on which the object is presented through, but not constituted by, consciousness.

**Russell** also refuses idealism, but instead of restoring the ordinary object he reconstructs it: physical objects are **logical constructions** from sense-data, perspectives and relations, so what is preserved is structure rather than the familiar thing.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** Both refuse to reduce object to act, but they differ in what they save: Moore **defends** the ordinary object as directly known; Russell **replaces** it and retains only structural objectivity. Moore restores common sense; Russell restores science.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q3(a):** the third limb is the discriminator. Many scripts report both reactions and never contrast them, forfeiting a third of the question.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** anti-abstraction in three lines; the five arguments in a compact paragraph each named; Moore in three lines; Russell in three; the contrast and verdict in three.

- **Structure:** ground clearing -> five named arguments -> two reactions -> explicit contrast.
- **Doctrine:** abstraction, *esse est percipi*, likeness, parity, master, continuity; act-object; logical construction.
- **Evidence:** *Principles* Intro Section Section 6-25 and Section Section 1-4, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 30-33.
- **Distinction:** defending the ordinary object versus replacing it with a construction.
- **Criticism:** note that the identification at Section 3 is a definition, which is why Moore's attack is on an inference and Russell's on an ontology.

### 2019 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

**Question:** Is there any element of necessity in causal relations according to Hume? Discuss.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Is there <b>any</b> element ...? Discuss" - a <b>yes-and-no with a distinction</b> , never a flat denial         |
| Core issue      | Where necessity is located once it is not found in the objects                                                    |
| Scope boundary  | Fifteen marks: the search, the internal find, both definitions, one qualification                                 |
| Ideal thesis    | Not in objects; yes in the mind, as an impression of reflection                                                   |
| Non-negotiables | Constant conjunction, priority, contiguity; the failed internal search; impression of reflection; two definitions |

### Independent model answer

Yes and no, and the distinction is the answer. In the **objects** there is no element of necessity; in the **mind** there is.

Hume applies the copy principle: if we have a genuine idea of necessary connexion, an impression must be produced. The external search fails. In a single instance of one billiard ball striking another, sense delivers only temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and, across instances, **constant conjunction**. No impression of a power or tie is given, and repetition adds no new quality to the objects - the hundredth collision is qualitatively identical to the first.

The internal search fails as well. I have no impression of *how* the will moves a limb; the nerve and muscle are unknown to consciousness. This closes the Cartesian and occasionalist escape routes together.

What repetition does change is the observer. After constant conjunction the mind is **determined** to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect, and that felt determination is an **impression of reflection**. The idea of necessary connexion is copied from it, so necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects".

Two definitions of cause follow: an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed, and an object whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. The first is objective and regularity-based, the second psychological.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: There is a real element of necessity, but it is **subjective**: a fact about us, not about nature. Hume relocates necessity rather than abolishing it - and the two definitions he leaves unreconciled are the origin of the modern dispute between regularity and projectivist accounts.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q4(b):** the word "any" makes a flat "no" wrong. Open with the distinction, then justify it.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** the distinction in one line; the external search in five; the internal search in three; the impression of reflection in four; both definitions in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** distinction -> external search -> internal search -> the positive find -> both definitions -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; constant conjunction; impression of reflection; custom.
- **Evidence:** the billiard balls; the volition case; *Treatise* I.iii.14 and *Enquiry* VII.
- **Distinction:** objective necessity denied, subjective necessity affirmed.
- **Criticism:** the two definitions pull apart and Hume never reconciles them.

### 2020 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

**Question:** "I never can catch myself at any time without perception, and never can observe anything but the perception." How does this statement by Hume problematize the philosophical notion of personal identity? How does Kant deal with this problem in his Critique of Pure Reason?

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | Quotation-led, two limbs: <b>how it problematises</b> , then <b>how Kant deals with it</b>                                      |
| Core issue      | The absence of a constant impression of the self, and the formal condition Kant substitutes                                     |
| Scope boundary  | Twenty marks: the argument, the fiction of unity, the Appendix, then apperception with its limit                                |
| Ideal thesis    | Hume dissolves the substantial self; Kant supplies a formal condition of unity, not a soul                                      |
| Non-negotiables | Copy principle; bundle formula; resemblance and causation; Appendix retraction; "I think"; transcendental unity of apperception |

### Independent model answer

The sentence is the copy principle turned on the perceiver. If every legitimate idea traces to an impression, an idea of the self would require an impression constant and invariable through a whole life. Introspection delivers no such thing - only heat and cold, light and shade, love and hatred, pain and pleasure, succeeding one another in perpetual flux, and never the one who is finding them.

Hume's conclusion follows: the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions" (*Treatise* I.iv.6). The problem this creates is threefold. First, the **substantial** self is dissolved, so nothing owns the experiences and no bearer survives change. Second, **diachronic identity** loses its ground: the unity we feel is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation**, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object. Third, and most damagingly, the **Appendix** confesses that Hume cannot state the principle that unites the perceptions: "all my hopes vanish". Having denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, he has removed every resource such a principle could use - and the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic altogether.

Kant does not answer by restoring a soul. He **accepts** that no inner intuition reveals a simple substance, so the rational psychologist's argument is conceded to Hume. His move is transcendental: the **"I think"** must be able to accompany all my representations if they are to belong to one experience at all. The **transcendental unity of apperception** is therefore a formal condition of synthesising a manifold under rules - not a further item discoverable inside the bundle, and not an intuition of an enduring substance.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** Kant answers the missing unity at the level of possible experience without proving an immortal self or a simple substance. The Humean may reply that a condition of description is not the discovery of a subject; Kant concedes the non-entity point and insists that rule-governed unity is presupposed by judgment. The exchange shows that the fault lay in the **atomism of impressions**, not in the self.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q2(a):** the empiricist argument must be **complete** before Kant appears. A script that rushes to Kant loses the first limb.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** the derivation in five lines; the three problems in six; Kant in six; the verdict in four.

- **Structure:** derivation -> three problems -> the Appendix -> Kant's formal condition -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; bundle; fiction of identity; apperception.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iv.6 and the Appendix; the "I think" formula.
- **Distinction:** a formal condition of experience versus an observed entity.
- **Criticism:** the failure indicts atomism; the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.

### 2021 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

**Question:** "Sensible things are those only which are immediately perceived by sense." Explain Berkeley's theory of knowledge with reference to the above statement.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Explain ... with reference to the above statement" - the sentence must be <b>used</b> , not decorated |
| Core issue      | The force of the word <b>immediately</b> and what it excludes                                          |
| Scope boundary  | Ten marks: the definition, the exclusion of inference, <i>esse est percipi</i> , one consequence       |
| Ideal thesis    | "Immediately" excludes Locke's mediated perception, and with it the veil and the matter behind it      |
| Non-negotiables | Ideas as objects of knowledge; the collection thesis; Section 3; direct perception; no veil            |

### Independent model answer

The sentence fixes a definition, and the whole theory follows from it. For Berkeley the objects of human knowledge are **ideas** - imprinted on the senses, perceived by attending to the mind's own operations, or formed by memory and imagination. A "sensible thing" is by definition what is **immediately** perceived by sense.

The word *immediately* is doing the work. Locke held that we perceive ideas which **represent** external objects, so that the object is reached mediately, by inference. Berkeley's definition removes the inference: if what is immediately perceived is an idea, and a sensible thing is what is immediately perceived, then an apple, a stone or a tree is nothing but a collection of such ideas.

Two consequences follow at once. First, the "veil of perception" disappears, and with it the sceptical problem it generated. Second, since ideas cannot exist unperceived, for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (*Principles* Section 3), and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** Berkeley's theory of knowledge is direct realism about ideas: we know the world itself, not a representation of it - though the price is that the world is not material.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(c):** the quoted line is a **definition of "sensible thing"**. An answer that never analyses "immediately" has not used the statement.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** the definition in three lines; the contrast with Locke in three; the two consequences in four; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** definition -> the force of "immediately" -> contrast with mediated perception -> consequences.
- **Doctrine:** ideas as objects of knowledge; the collection thesis; *esse est percipi*.

- **Evidence:** *Principles* Section 1-4 and Section 3.
- **Distinction:** immediate versus mediate perception.
- **Criticism:** note that the identification of thing with collection is a definition, which is where objections must strike.

### 2021 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

**Question:** Examine the concept of personal identity by Locke.

#### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Examine" - state <b>and</b> test; a ruling on the objections is required                                 |
| Core issue      | Whether continuity of consciousness can constitute identity                                               |
| Scope boundary  | Ten marks: three identities, the criterion, one case, two objections, one verdict                         |
| Ideal thesis    | Forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete                                                     |
| Non-negotiables | Person/man/substance; II.xxvii.9; appropriation; forensic; prince and cobbler; Butler-Reid; Brave Officer |

#### Independent model answer

Locke separates three questions his predecessors ran together: sameness of **substance**, sameness of **man** (the continuing living organism), and sameness of **person**. Only the third is his subject.

A person is "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places" (*Essay* II.xxvii.9, added in the second edition of 1694). Identity of person therefore extends as far as present **consciousness** can **appropriate** a past thought or action as its own. Memory is the vehicle and evidence of that reach, not the definition. "Person" is, in Locke's own word, **forensic**: it is built for accountability.

The prince-and-cobbler case makes the separation vivid: transfer the prince's consciousness and the **person** who wakes is the prince while the **man** is the cobbler.

Two objections press hard. Butler and Reid charge **circularity**, since I can remember only my own experiences. Reid's **Brave Officer** shows the criterion is not transitive: the officer remembers the boy, the general remembers the officer, the general does not remember the boy.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Repaired as overlapping chains of consciousness, the theory survives Reid; the circularity charge remains open. Forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete.

#### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(d):** "Examine" is a two-part instruction. Doctrine alone, however accurate, caps the mark.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** three identities in two lines; definition and criterion in four; the case in two; objections in three; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** three identities -> definition -> criterion -> case -> objections -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** consciousness, appropriation, forensic concept.
- **Evidence:** II.xxvii.9; the 1694 addition; prince and cobbler; the Brave Officer.
- **Distinction:** constitutive criterion versus evidential criterion.
- **Criticism:** the repair costs the simple memory reading.

### 2021 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

**Question:** "The relation between cause and effect is one of constant conjunction". Examine Hume's criticism of causation in the light of the above statement.

## Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Examine ... in the light of the statement" - the quoted phrase must be tested, not merely repeated  |
| Core issue      | Whether constant conjunction exhausts the analysis                                                   |
| Scope boundary  | Ten marks: the three observables, the missing power, the internal find, one qualification            |
| Ideal thesis    | Constant conjunction is necessary but not sufficient; the felt determination completes the account   |
| Non-negotiables | Priority, contiguity, constant conjunction; no impression of power; impression of reflection; custom |

## Independent model answer

The quoted sentence is accurate but incomplete, and examining it is the answer.

Hume's analysis begins with what observation supplies: temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and, across repeated instances, **constant conjunction**. What observation never supplies is a **power** or **tie** binding cause to effect. Applying the copy principle, Hume asks which impression the idea of necessary connexion is copied from. No external impression answers, and repetition adds nothing to the objects themselves.

The internal route also fails: I have no impression of how the will moves a limb.

What repetition does alter is the mind. After constant conjunction it is **determined** to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect, and this felt determination is an **impression of reflection** from which the idea of necessity is copied. Causal necessity is therefore projected onto objects, not read off them, and the mechanism is **custom or habit**.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** Constant conjunction alone is mere regularity; Hume's account requires priority, contiguity **and** the felt determination. He does not deny causation - he relocates its necessity from the world to the observer.

## Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(e):** the examiner supplies a partial formula. The mark is for showing what it omits.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** the three observables in three lines; the failed searches in four; the impression of reflection in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** what is observed -> what is not -> the internal search -> the positive find -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; constant conjunction; impression of reflection; custom.
- **Evidence:** the billiard-ball case; *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* VII.
- **Distinction:** regularity versus the full analysis including felt necessity.
- **Criticism:** "mere succession" is the misreading the quoted line invites.

## 2022 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

**Question:** Why and how does John Locke refute the innate ideas? Elucidate the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology.

## Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                             |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | Two limbs: <b>why and how</b> he refutes, then <b>elucidate</b> nature and source of knowledge          |
| Core issue      | The three grounds and the positive replacement they make room for                                       |
| Scope boundary  | Fifteen marks: motive, three grounds, two fountains, simple/complex, degrees, one qualification         |
| Ideal thesis    | The refutation clears space for a genetic account; it defeats naive but not dispositional innatism      |
| Non-negotiables | Universal assent; no unconscious ideas; redundancy; II.i.2; sensation and reflection; the three degrees |



### Independent model answer

**Why.** Locke's target is the claim that certain ideas and principles are stamped on the mind at birth. If true, it would license appeals to authority that no experience could check, and it would make an account of the *origin* of ideas unnecessary. Locke wants the origin of an idea to be the test of its legitimacy, so the innatist hypothesis must go first.

**How.** Three grounds, in Book I. First, **universal assent fails**: if such ideas were innate, all human beings including children would possess them, and they do not. Second, **there are no unconscious ideas**: a thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind. Third, a **genetic account is available**: every alleged innate idea, including God and non-contradiction, can be traced to experience, so the hypothesis is redundant.

**The positive account.** The mind is "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2) - the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*, though the Latin is not Locke's. Experience has two channels: **sensation**, giving ideas of external objects, and **reflection**, giving ideas of the mind's own operations. **Simple** ideas are passively received; the understanding actively forms **complex** ideas as modes, substances and relations.

Knowledge is then the **perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas**, in three degrees: **intuitive** (immediate), **demonstrative** (through intervening ideas) and **sensitive** (of particular existing things). Everything below is probability and judgement.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Locke defeats naive innatism decisively; against Descartes' **dispositional** innatism his empirical grounds miss, and everything rests on the premise about what "in the mind" means - a stipulation rather than a discovery.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q4(c):** two limbs, two headings. The second limb is not an afterthought: "nature and source" means the definition of knowledge **and** its two fountains.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** motive in three lines; three grounds in six; the positive account in six; the degrees in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** why -> three grounds -> sources -> nature and degrees -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** anti-innatism; sensation and reflection; simple and complex ideas; the three degrees.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* Book I; II.i.2; the classification at II.xii.
- **Distinction:** naive versus dispositional innatism.
- **Criticism:** the decisive ground is a stipulation about the meaning of "idea".

### 2023 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

**Question:** Critically analyse Hume's argument that causality is a matter of habit/custom involving psychological principle of association.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Critically analyse" - exposition <b>plus</b> a delivered verdict                                                    |
| Core issue      | Whether reducing causal necessity to habit is an explanation or a capitulation                                       |
| Scope boundary  | Twenty marks: full analysis, both definitions, association, three objections, ruling                                 |
| Ideal thesis    | Hume succeeds against experience-based grounding of necessity; the result follows from his atomism                   |
| Non-negotiables | Three observables; failed internal search; impression of reflection; both definitions; practice versus justification |

### Independent model answer

Causation is the hinge on which empiricism's critique of metaphysics and science's rational basis both turn, so the argument deserves close statement before assessment.

**The analysis.** Observation of one event producing another delivers temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and **constant conjunction**. It never delivers a power or tie. Applying the copy principle, Hume looks for the impression

from which the idea of necessary connexion could be copied. The external search fails, and repetition adds no new quality to the objects. The internal search fails too: I have no impression of how volition moves a limb, which closes the Cartesian and occasionalist routes at once.

**The positive account.** Repetition changes the observer. After constant conjunction the mind is **determined** to pass from cause to effect; that determination is an **impression of reflection**, and the idea of necessity is copied from it. The mechanism is the **association** of ideas by resemblance, contiguity and causation, and the resulting expectation is **custom**, "the great guide of human life". Two definitions of cause follow - one objective and regularity-based, one psychological, conveying the thought to the other - and Hume never reconciles them.

**Assessment.** Three objections press. **Kant** replies that causality is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish objective succession from the subjective succession of perceptions, so necessity is contributed by the understanding rather than observed in objects. **Pragmatically**, the success of science suggests a real causal order - though Hume answers that success is a psychological fact about creatures built to expect, not a justification. **Self-referentially**, if inference is mere habit, Hume's own arguments lose their force; his defence is that he distinguishes the **practice** of inference, which nature compels, from its **justification**, which reason cannot supply.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Hume establishes that experience alone cannot ground causal necessity. But the result follows from the **atomism of impressions**: if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived, and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise. Kant's reply is therefore correctly aimed, since it attacks the atomism rather than the inference - while Hume's sceptical result stands as a permanent constraint on dogmatic metaphysics.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2023 Q2(a):** "critically analyse" requires a ruling. Exposition alone, however complete, cannot reach the top band.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** frame in two lines; analysis in seven; positive account in six; three objections in six; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** frame -> analysis -> positive account -> three objections -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; association; custom; two definitions.
- **Evidence:** billiard balls and bread; *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* IV, V, VII.
- **Distinction:** the practice of causal inference versus its justification.
- **Criticism:** the atomism of impressions guarantees the conclusion.

### 2024 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

**Question:** Is rejection of Locke's notion of primary qualities instrumental in Berkeley's leaning towards idealism? In this context, also discuss how subjective idealism is different from the absolute idealism proposed by Hegel.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | Two limbs: an <b>instrumentality verdict</b> , then a <b>comparison</b>                                                                       |
| Core issue      | Which rejection actually does the work, and how two idealisms differ in kind                                                                  |
| Scope boundary  | Twenty marks: the quality distinction, parity and likeness, the abstraction ground, then matched axes for Hegel                               |
| Ideal thesis    | Yes, but instrumentally through the likeness principle and anti-abstraction, not through relativity alone                                     |
| Non-negotiables | Primary/secondary lists; Section 8, 9-15; abstraction as the deeper ground; Berkeley subjective and theistic; Hegel objective and dialectical |

### Independent model answer

Yes - but the answer must say **which** rejection is instrumental, since Berkeley uses two different weapons and only one of them is decisive.

Locke divides **primary** qualities - solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number - which are inseparable from body and whose ideas **resemble** them, from **secondary** qualities such as colour and warmth, which are **powers** to produce sensations and whose ideas resemble nothing.



Berkeley's first weapon is **parity** (*Principles* Section Section 9-15): every relativity consideration Locke accepts against secondary qualities applies to primary ones as well - apparent size varies with distance, motion with frame of reference, shape with angle of view. This is suggestive but not decisive, since a realist may reply that varying appearance is exactly what a mind-independent shape would produce.

The decisive weapon is the **likeness principle** (Section 8): "an idea can be like nothing but an idea", and a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked. That removes the last property matter was supposed to have in its own right. Behind both lies the deeper ground: the attack on **abstract general ideas**, since Locke's *material substance in general* is the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. Once abstraction fails, matter is meaningless rather than unknown, and only spirits and ideas remain.

**Subjective versus absolute idealism.** For Berkeley, reality is **ideas in finite and divine minds**; sensible existence *consists in* being perceived, and an infinite spirit causes and coordinates the ideas of sense while sustaining what finite minds do not perceive. For Hegel, reality is the **self-development of Absolute Spirit**, in which objectivity is a moment within a dialectical process driven by determinate negation; the Absolute is not an external perceiver preserving private idea-collections, and its method is developmental rather than perceptual.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: The rejection of primary qualities is instrumental, but as a *removal* rather than a *proof*: it clears matter away, while the positive idealism comes from the anti-abstraction argument and from the argument to an active infinite spirit. And Berkeley's theistic subjective idealism is not an early Hegelianism - the two differ in **kind**, not in degree.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q2(a):** "instrumental" asks for a causal-explanatory ruling, not a narration of two doctrines.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** the distinction in three lines; parity in four; likeness and abstraction in six; the comparison in six; verdict in three.

- **Structure:** the distinction -> parity -> likeness -> abstraction -> matched-axis comparison -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** qualities; likeness; parity; abstraction; two idealisms.
- **Evidence:** *Essay II.viii*; *Principles* Section Section 8, 9-15 and Intro Section Section 6-25.
- **Distinction:** removal versus proof; subjective versus absolute idealism.
- **Criticism:** relativity alone does not entail mind-dependence.

### 2025 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

**Question:** Examine Hume's refutation of Causal relation and Kant's response to it.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Examine" both limbs - state each, then test whether Kant's answer succeeds                                              |
| Core issue      | Whether the Second Analogy answers Hume or presupposes what it must prove                                                |
| Scope boundary  | Fifteen marks: Hume compressed but complete, Kant precise, one adjudication                                              |
| Ideal thesis    | Kant accepts Hume's negative result and attacks the atomism that produced it                                             |
| Non-negotiables | No impression of necessary connexion; custom; both definitions; Second Analogy; synthetic a priori; things in themselves |

### Independent model answer

**Hume.** Observation of causal sequences delivers only temporal priority, spatial contiguity and constant conjunction; no impression of a power or tie is given, and repetition adds nothing to the objects. The internal route through volition fails equally. What repetition alters is the mind, which after constant conjunction is **determined** to pass from cause to effect - an **impression of reflection** from which the idea of necessity is copied. Hence two definitions of cause: regular succession of similars, and an object whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. The consequence is that inductive inference rests on **custom**, not reason.

**Kant.** He does not dispute the negative finding; he agrees that necessary connexion is not copied from a sensory impression. His answer is transcendental. In the **Second Analogy** the category of cause is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish an **objective** succession of events from the merely **subjective** succession of my perceptions. "Every event has a cause" is therefore **synthetic a priori** for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena, and objective empirical causation is rescued without any claim about causality among things in themselves.

**Examination.** The Humean challenge is that Kant has built the category into the definition of objective experience rather than proving it. Kant's reply is that without rule-governed synthesis, experience of an **event** would not be possible, so the presupposition is a condition of the fact to be explained.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Kant is correctly aimed: Hume's conclusion follows from the **atomism of impressions**, and it is that atomism, not the inference, which Kant attacks. Whether a condition of possible experience amounts to knowledge of nature remains contested - which is why the answer should close by grading, not by declaring a winner.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q2(c):** the Hume limb must be complete before Kant begins; ownership discipline is itself a mark.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** Hume in nine lines; Kant in seven; the examination in four; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** Hume -> Kant -> the challenge and reply -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; custom; two definitions; Second Analogy; synthetic a priori.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* IV and VII; the ship-and-house contrast.
- **Distinction:** objective event-succession versus subjective succession of perceptions.
- **Criticism:** does Kant prove the category or presuppose it?

### 2025 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

**Question:** Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas.

### Demand decoding

| Element         | Requirement                                                                                                      |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Directive       | "Explain" - exhibit the <b>derivation</b> , not the conclusion                                                   |
| Core issue      | The doctrine refuted, the refutation, the replacement, and the metaphysical payload                              |
| Scope boundary  | Fifteen marks: Locke's doctrine compressed, Berkeley's steps, the positive account, the consequence for matter   |
| Ideal thesis    | Nominalism is the foundation of immaterialism, not a corollary of it                                             |
| Non-negotiables | III.iii and IV.vii.9; Intro Section Section 6-25; Section Section 12, 13, 19-20; matter as abstract general idea |

### Independent model answer

**The doctrine refuted.** For Locke everything that exists is particular, yet most words are general; words become general by signifying **general ideas**, and ideas become general by **abstraction** - separation from circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea (*Essay* III.iii.6-9). The resulting "general representative" is the **nominal essence** annexed to a sortal name. Locke himself concedes that the general idea of a triangle must be "neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once", and that it is "something imperfect, that cannot exist" (IV.vii.9).

**The refutation.** Berkeley concedes that we may separate what **could** exist apart - a hand from a body, a torso from a head. He denies that we may separate what **cannot**: extension without colour, motion without determinate speed, "man" without stature. He then quotes Locke's own triangle sentence verbatim at *Principles*, Introduction Section 13, and concludes that no such idea can be framed. Therefore there are no abstract general ideas.

**The replacement - nominalism proper.** An idea is general not by being abstract but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (Intro Section 12). A determinate particular idea, **selectively**

**attended to**, does duty for a class: the geometer draws this black inch-long line and proves a theorem about all lines. Berkeley adds that words need not stand for ideas at all (Section Section 19-20).

**The payload.** Locke's *material substance in general* is precisely an abstract general idea - the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. If abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a **meaningless expression**, so immaterialism rests on the nominalism.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Decisive against an **imagistic** Locke; against a **determinable** reading the objection misses, and Berkeley still owes an account of what fixes the respect of representation.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q4(c):** the refutation cannot be explained without the doctrine refuted. Give Locke first, compressed but exact.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** Locke in six lines; the refutation in five; the replacement in five; the payload in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** doctrine refuted -> refutation -> positive replacement -> metaphysical payload -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** abstraction; nominal essence; representative use; language beyond ideas.
- **Evidence:** IV.vii.9 quoted at *Principles* Intro Section 13; Section 12; Section Section 19-20.
- **Distinction:** separating what could exist apart versus what could not.
- **Criticism:** the determinable reading of Locke, and the unfixed respect of representation.

Six original questions in the UPSC idiom - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks - with complete model solutions inside the same word bands. These are practice items, not predictions.

## ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

### Original 1 · 10 marks

**Question:** Is Locke's description of substance as "something, I know not what" an admission of ignorance or an abandonment of the concept? Examine.

### Independent model answer

It is an admission of ignorance, and the distinction is exact.

Locke observes that we meet clusters of qualities that regularly go together - yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia - and cannot conceive them as subsisting on their own. We therefore **suppose** a support. But no impression of that support is ever presented, so we have "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2).

Two things are denied and one is affirmed. Denied: any **positive idea** of the substratum, and any knowledge of the **real essence** it embodies. Affirmed: that something is qualified, since qualities do not float.

The concept is therefore retained as an **explanatory posit** tied to the stability of kinds, not abandoned. Berkeley's counter is that "support" here is a dead metaphor, and that removing it leaves the abstract idea of being conjoined with a relative notion - an abstract general idea.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Ignorance, not abandonment; but the posit's intelligibility depends on a doctrine of abstraction that Berkeley attacks, so Locke's humility is stable only while that doctrine holds.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** the question offers a false dichotomy, and the mark is for refusing it precisely.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** the ruling in one line; the derivation in four; denied-and-affirmed in three; Berkeley in two; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** ruling -> derivation -> what is denied and affirmed -> the counter -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** substratum; real essence; explanatory posit.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* II.xxiii.2.
- **Distinction:** no positive idea versus no existence.

- **Criticism:** the posit depends on abstraction.

### Original 2 · 10 marks

**Question:** Berkeley holds that we have a "notion" of spirit though no idea of it. Is this distinction principled or merely convenient? Discuss.

#### Independent model answer

It is principled in its motive and vulnerable in its result.

The motive is internal to the system. Berkeley's ideas are **passive**; a spirit is **active**, perceiving and willing. An idea, being inert, could never picture an activity, so if activity is known at all it cannot be known by an idea. Hence spirits - my own, other finite minds, and God - are known by **notion** (*Principles* Section Section 27, 89, 140). Notions also cover relations, which likewise are not pictured.

The vulnerability is equally clear. Berkeley's case against matter was that an unperceivable substratum has no content. An unperceivable spirit, known by a faculty introduced for the purpose, invites the same complaint, and critics call the asymmetry ad hoc.

The strongest defence is that the asymmetry is **forced** rather than chosen: the objection assumes that all knowledge is idea-shaped, which is precisely what Berkeley denies once activity enters the ontology. Hume then tests the defence by refusing the exemption and dissolving spiritual substance as well.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: Principled in derivation, unproven in adequacy - and Hume's refusal shows exactly how much weight it was carrying.

#### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** "principled or convenient" demands a two-sided ruling, not a defence brief.

**Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words:** motive in five lines; vulnerability in three; defence in three; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** motive -> vulnerability -> defence -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** passivity of ideas; activity of spirits; notions.
- **Evidence:** *Principles* Section Section 27, 89, 140.
- **Distinction:** forced asymmetry versus convenient exemption.
- **Criticism:** Hume removes the exemption and the self goes with it.

### Original 3 · 15 marks

**Question:** "Berkeley destroys Locke's resemblance thesis but not his distinction between primary and secondary qualities." Critically examine.

#### Independent model answer

The statement is largely correct, and stating why requires separating two theses Locke runs together.

**Thesis A - the explanatory distinction.** Primary qualities are solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest and number: they are inseparable from body, since every fragment retains them, and they are the properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body. Secondary qualities are **powers**, grounded in primary-quality configurations, to produce sensations in us.

**Thesis B - the resemblance claim.** Our ideas of primary qualities **resemble** the qualities themselves; our ideas of secondary qualities resemble nothing in the object.

Berkeley attacks both. His **parity** argument (*Principles* Section Section 9-15) observes that the relativity considerations Locke accepts against secondary qualities apply equally to primary ones. But relativity does not entail mind-dependence: that a coin looks elliptical from an angle is exactly what a genuinely circular coin should produce. Thesis A therefore survives, though it must be restated as a distinction between **measurable-structural** and **response-dependent** properties rather than as a claim about what is "really in" the object.

The **likeness principle** (Section 8) is another matter. If an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and the alleged originals are unperceivable, then the resemblance could never be checked and the claim is empty. Thesis B falls. The available rescue is **isomorphism**: structural correspondence requires no qualitative likeness, as a map corresponds

to terrain without being terrain-coloured - but this concedes Berkeley's point about likeness and defends something weaker.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** Correct with one qualification: what survives is not Locke's distinction as he framed it, but its explanatory core. Locke's error was to make the division depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role - which is why physics retains the distinction while his version of it does not.

#### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** a quotation-led "critically examine" requires you to grade the quotation, not merely to agree.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** the two theses in seven lines; parity in five; likeness in five; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** separate the theses -> parity against A -> likeness against B -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** quality lists; powers; resemblance; isomorphism.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* II.viii; *Principles* Section 8 and 9-15.
- **Distinction:** measurable-structural versus response-dependent properties.
- **Criticism:** the survivor is the explanatory core, not Locke's own formulation.

#### Original 4 · 15 marks

**Question:** Hume's Appendix confesses that he cannot explain what unites successive perceptions. Does this failure refute the bundle theory or diagnose a deeper problem? Discuss.

#### Independent model answer

It diagnoses a deeper problem, and reading it as a simple refutation misses what Hume has shown.

**The doctrine.** Applying the copy principle to the perceiver, Hume finds no constant and invariable impression of a self, only perceptions in perpetual flux, and concludes that the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions" (*Treatise* I.iv.6). The felt unity is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation**, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object.

**The confession.** In the Appendix Hume writes that all his hopes vanish when he comes to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions. The admission is genuine, and the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.

**What it shows.** Hume has denied two things at once: any **substance** in which perceptions inhere, and any **real connexion** between distinct existences. Together these remove every resource a uniting principle could have used. The failure is therefore not an accident of ingenuity but a consequence of the **atomism of impressions** - the doctrine that perceptions are separable atoms, so that no relation is given with its terms.

**The comparison that clinches it.** Exactly the same atomism generates the negative result about causation, where no relation between events can be perceived either. One premise, two failures.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** The bundle theory is not refuted by the confession; it is revealed as the last casualty of empiricist atomism. That Hume can find no principle of unity, and says so, indicts the premise rather than the self - which is precisely the diagnosis Kant makes when he supplies a formal condition of unity instead of an impression.

#### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** the question offers two readings; choose one and show why the other is superficial.

**Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words:** doctrine in six lines; confession in three; diagnosis in six; comparison in two; verdict in three.

- **Structure:** doctrine -> confession -> diagnosis -> parallel with causation -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; bundle; fiction of identity; atomism.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iv.6 and the Appendix; the *Enquiry*'s silence.
- **Distinction:** refutation of a theory versus diagnosis of a premise.
- **Criticism:** one premise produces both the missing self and the missing necessity.

### Original 5 · 20 marks

**Question:** "The movement from Locke through Berkeley to Hume is a logical development rather than a historical accident." Critically analyse.

#### Independent model answer

The claim is defensible but needs one important correction: the movement is logical only because each successor supplies an **additional premise** his predecessor could have refused.

**The shared rule.** All three accept that every simple cognitive content originates in experience - Locke's sensation and reflection, Hume's impressions - while retaining the mind's operations of comparing, combining and abstracting.

**Locke's exemption.** He applies the rule to ideas but exempts **matter**, holding that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes and that a substratum supports co-occurring qualities, though we have "a supposition of he knows not what support" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2). Sensitive knowledge of external things is his weakest degree, so the exemption is asserted at the point of least support.

**Berkeley's step, and its premise.** He removes the exemption with the **likeness principle**: an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked (*Principles* Section 8). Beneath this lies the attack on abstraction, since "material substance in general" is the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. The **added premise** is comparability - that a resemblance no perceiver could verify is empty. A determined Lockean could resist by shifting to structural correspondence, which requires no qualitative likeness.

**Hume's step, and its premise.** He applies the same test to what Berkeley retained: spirit and causal power. No impression of a substantial self is found, so the self becomes a bundle (*Treatise* I.iv.6); no impression of necessary connexion is found, so necessity is relocated to an impression of reflection. The **added premise** is the **atomism of impressions** - perceptions are separable, so no relation is given with its terms. Berkeley could have resisted by denying that activity must be idea-shaped, which is exactly what his doctrine of notions asserts.

**Verdict.** ANALYSIS: The sequence is logical in structure and contingent in premises. Each stage is the previous position made consistent, which is why it is not a historical accident; but each stage also needs a premise that was available to be denied, which is why it is not a proof. That the rule consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live is best read as a diagnosis of the rule's incompleteness - the conclusion Kant draws when he attacks the atomism rather than the inference.

#### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** a "logical development" claim is won by exhibiting the **mechanism** and lost by narrating three systems.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** shared rule in three lines; Locke in five; Berkeley in six; Hume in six; verdict in five.

- **Structure:** shared rule -> exemption -> two removals with their added premises -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** resemblance; likeness; abstraction; bundle; necessary connexion.
- **Evidence:** II.xxiii.2; *Principles* Section 8 and Intro Section Section 6-25; *Treatise* I.iv.6 and I.iii.14.
- **Distinction:** logical structure versus contingent premises.
- **Criticism:** each added premise was resistible, so the slide explains without proving.

### Original 6 · 20 marks

**Question:** Compare the role assigned to God by Locke, Berkeley and Hume, and assess what each system loses if the divine premise is withdrawn.

#### Independent model answer

The comparison is best run on one axis: **what job does God perform in the system?** Answered that way, three very different dependencies appear.

**Locke - God as guarantor and conclusion.** God's existence is known by **demonstration**, not intuition and not sensitive knowledge: from the intuitive certainty of my own existence, together with the principle that nothing comes from nothing, Locke infers an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being. God also does defensive work: divine



non-deception supports the reliability of sense and the trustworthiness of our faculties for "the conveniences of life".

*If withdrawn:* the demonstration is lost, and the defence of representative realism weakens - but the epistemology survives, since the three degrees of knowledge and the two fountains of ideas stand independently.

**Berkeley - God as cause and continuity.** Ideas are passive; the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily in settled order; only spirits are active; therefore an infinite spirit produces them (*Principles* Section Section 30-33). God also secures the persistence of sensible things unperceived by finite minds, and the laws of nature become the settled grammar of a divine language, so regularities are **signs** rather than causes.

*If withdrawn:* the system collapses. Without an active infinite spirit there is no cause of the involuntary order, no continuity for unperceived objects, and no distinction between the real and the imaginary beyond the felt vivacity of one's own ideas. God is load-bearing here in a way he is not for Locke.

**Hume - God as casualty.** Every proof fails. The causal argument is cut at its premise, since there is no impression of necessary connexion licensing an inference to a transcendent cause. The design argument rests on a weak analogy, and even if granted proves at most a **finite** architect working on given matter; natural principles might explain order without intelligence; and the problem of evil blocks the inference to a perfectly good designer. Testimony can never make a miracle more probable than its own falsehood.

*If withdrawn:* nothing is lost, because nothing was resting on it.

**Verdict. ANALYSIS:** The dependency is inversely related to the empiricism's consistency. Locke uses God as a support, Berkeley requires him as a mechanism, Hume dispenses with him as unsupported. The comparison also exposes the deepest criticism of immaterialism: God performs exactly the two functions Locke assigned to matter - causing our ideas and sustaining the unperceived - so Berkeley's economy is a substitution of posits rather than an elimination of them.

### Why this earns marks

**Answer-writing focus:** announce the axis - the **job God performs** - in the first line, and the comparison writes itself.

**Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words:** axis in one line; each thinker in a paragraph with an explicit withdrawal test; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** axis -> three systems each with a counterfactual test -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** demonstrative proof; divine non-deception; passivity and continuity; the three failed proofs.
- **Evidence:** *Essay IV*; *Principles* Section Section 30-33; *Dialogues concerning Natural Religion*; *Enquiry X*.
- **Distinction:** God as support, as mechanism, and as casualty.
- **Criticism:** in Berkeley, God does matter's old job - which is the real question about the system.

## OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

### Prerequisite check before using this block

Nothing below is needed to write a complete answer to any of the twelve routed questions. Use it only after the thirteen Basic sessions, the thirty-two diagnostics and the solved practice are secure, and then only as a single evaluative rider inside a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer. Every item here is a **live scholarly dispute** and is marked CAUTION: accordingly; presenting any of these readings as settled doctrine would be a mistake in the opposite direction from omitting them.

### A1. Locke on real essence and corpuscular explanation CAUTION:

- **The issue:** is Locke a humble realist about hidden structures, or does his talk of substratum and real essence amount to a sceptical placeholder?
- **Competing readings:** a realist or **corpuscular** reading, on which real essences are genuine internal constitutions awaiting discovery; an **anti-essentialist** reading that stresses nominal essence and epistemic modesty; and a middle reading on which real essence exists but rarely functions as usable knowledge.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* - "something I know not what" looks empty.  
*Counter-reply* - Locke can say it is an explanatory posit tied to stable powers and kinds, not a positively known

object of intuition.

- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** one brief refinement inside a Locke substance answer, or when explaining why Berkeley finds Locke unstable.
- **Do not over-study:** the debates on corpuscular chemistry are not marks-essential unless a question explicitly asks about real essence.

## A2. Berkeley's Master Argument after the textbook summary CAUTION:

- **The issue:** does Berkeley really prove that an unperceived object is inconceivable, or only that one cannot *at the same time* conceive an object while conceiving it as unconceived?
- **Competing readings:** a strong **conceivability** argument; an **anti-abstraction polemic** in which the challenge is a corollary of the Introduction; and a **dialectical** reading that targets Locke's representational assumptions more than common realism.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* - I can surely think of a tree standing unperceived in a forest. *Counter-reply* - Berkeley answers that the tree is still conceived *by you* in the very act of the thought; his target is "conceived-as-unconceived", not "not currently seen".
- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** only after *esse est percipi* and the attack on abstract ideas are already in place.
- **Do not over-study:** do not turn the answer into a survey of the analytic literature on conceivability.

## A3. Hume the destructive sceptic versus Hume the naturalist CAUTION:

- **The issue:** does Hume merely dissolve reason into habit, or does he reconstruct philosophy on the basis of ordinary human practice?
- **Competing readings:** the **radical sceptic** reading; the **mitigated or naturalist** reading; and a combined reading on which sceptical critique clears the way for modest common life and science.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* - appealing to custom looks like surrender, not philosophy. *Counter-reply* - Hume's point is that human cognition inescapably runs on habit, and philosophy should explain that limit rather than pretend to escape it by rationalist fiat.
- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** one closing evaluative paragraph in an answer on causation, the self or scepticism. It must never replace the copy principle, the bundle theory or the habit analysis.
- **Do not over-study:** Hume's political, historical and economic writings are outside this owner.

## A4. The reflexive status of Hume's fork CAUTION:

- **The issue:** into which of its own two boxes does the fork itself fall? If it is neither a relation of ideas nor a matter of fact, it appears to license its own consignment to the flames.
- **Competing readings:** the **self-refutation** charge; a **meta-level** reading on which the fork is a clarification of the meanings of terms rather than a first-order claim; and a **methodological** reading on which it is a proposal for enquiry, assessed by fruitfulness rather than by truth.
- **The residual CAUTION::** each rescue makes the fork less like a discovery and more like a stipulation, which weakens every conclusion that leans on its exhaustiveness - most obviously the induction dilemma.
- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** one clause in a scepticism or induction answer, after the dilemma has been set out properly.

## A5. The modal status of the copy principle after the missing shade CAUTION:

- **The issue:** is the copy principle an empirical generalisation, an analytic truth about what an idea is, or a methodological rule for detecting empty terms?
- **Competing readings:** an **empirical** reading, which is what Hume's own concession suggests; a **constitutive** reading, on which nothing would count as an idea without an antecedent impression; and a **regulative** reading, on which the principle is a test rather than a law.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* - if it is empirical, one admitted exception invites others, and the demolitions of substance, self and necessary connexion lose their force. *Counter-reply* - interpolation between impressions actually had preserves the dependence on experiential materials, so the exception is



parasitic on the rule rather than a rival to it.

- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** a single sentence when an answer needs to grade rather than merely report Hume's negative results.

#### A6. Is Berkeley's God an advance on Locke's matter? CAUTION:

- **The issue:** immaterialism removes an unknowable substratum and installs an unperceivable spirit that performs the same two functions - causing our ideas and sustaining the unperceived.
- **Competing readings:** an **economy** reading, on which spirits are already required for perception so no new category is added; a **substitution** reading, on which the change is one of vocabulary; and a **theological** reading, on which the point is precisely to make the world's order personal rather than mechanical.
- **The further objection and the counter-reply:** *Objection* - the notion doctrine is an exemption introduced to protect the favoured posit. *Counter-reply* - the exemption is forced, since a passive idea could never picture an activity, and Berkeley applies the doctrine to finite spirits and relations as well as to God.
- **Safe use ANALYSIS::** as the residual column of the criticism ledger in a twenty-mark answer on immaterialism.

#### Conceptual links - not current-affairs items

Static early-modern philosophy does not require a manufactured contemporary anchor, and none has been forced here. The genuine conceptual links, usable as a closing clause when a question invites breadth, are: the fork running forward into the verification principle of logical positivism; the problem of induction remaining unsolved in the philosophy of science; the bundle self standing beside the Buddhist doctrine of no-self as a **parallel** rather than an influence; and the primary-secondary distinction surviving in science as a contrast between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties. Each belongs to a **later or different owner** and should be named in a clause, not developed.

#### Source trail for this block

Locke, *An Essay Concerning Human Understanding*, Books II-IV; Berkeley, *A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge* and *Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous*; Hume, *A Treatise of Human Nature* Book I with the Appendix, *An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding* Sections II, IV, V, VII, X and XII, and the *Dialogues concerning Natural Religion*. The interpretive positions summarised above follow the repository's advanced Western Philosophy dossier, which names Michael Ayers, Kenneth Winkler, George Pappas, Norman Kemp Smith, Barry Stroud and Don Garrett as the standard modern discussants, together with the scope objection to the Master Argument associated with Russell and refined by Prior and Gallois.

### CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Compressed revision notes for the complete topic, arranged by examinable structure rather than by a fixed template. Read these last, and read them fast. Parts A to L cover every Basic session; the optional advanced material is deliberately excluded, because none of it is required for a core answer.

#### A. The empiricist operating rule and the four printed test cases

- **Origin, not warrant.** Every **simple** cognitive content traces to experience: Locke's **sensation** (outer) and **reflection** (inner), Hume's **impressions**. Mental operations - comparing, combining, abstracting - are never denied.
- The syllabus prints four test cases: **theory of knowledge** · **substance and qualities** · **self and God** · **scepticism**. Show all four in any general answer.
- The added premise at each step: Locke assumes **resemblance**; Berkeley adds **comparability** ("an idea can be like nothing but an idea"); Hume adds the **atomism of impressions**.
- Landing points: **representative realism** -> **subjective idealism** -> **mitigated scepticism**.
- Memory chain: **R -> I -> S**; deletions **M-S-N** (Berkeley deletes Matter; Hume deletes the Substantial self and objective Necessity); verdicts on scepticism **H-A-M** (Humble, Anti-sceptical, Mitigated).
- **WRONG:** Not anti-reason; **WRONG:** not the five senses only; **WRONG:** not three biographies.

## B. Locke - anti-innatism and the sources of ideas

three grounds -> white paper -> sensation + reflection -> simple ideas ->  
combine/compare/abstract -> complex ideas (modes | substances | relations)

- Three grounds: **universal assent fails** · **no unconscious ideas** · **a genetic account is available**.
- The decisive ground is the second, because "to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind" is a **stipulation** that blocks the dispositional retreat.
- Essay II.i.2: the mind as "**white paper, void of all characters**". ANALYSIS: *Tabula rasa* is the tradition's label, **not** Locke's phrase.
- Simple ideas passive; complex ideas actively made as **modes** (triangle, gratitude, number), **substances** (gold, man) and **relations** (cause, identity).
- ANALYSIS: Verdict: naive innatism destroyed; **dispositional** innatism survives. Leibniz's rejoinder - nothing in the intellect that was not in the senses, **except the intellect itself** - names the survivor, and Kant vindicates its structural form.

## C. Locke - knowledge, the three degrees, probability and the veil

- **Knowledge = the perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas**.
- Degrees: **intuitive** ("white is not black") -> **demonstrative** (mathematics; the existence of God) -> **sensitive** (particular existing things). The external world sits on the **weakest** rung.
- Below knowledge lies **probability and judgement**: testimony, analogy, natural history, everyday expectation.
- **Representative realism**: body -> sense organ -> **idea**, which is the only inspectable item; primary-quality ideas are said to **resemble**.
- Veil objection: the comparison can never be made. Locke's four defences - **involuntariness, inter-sensory agreement, pleasure and pain, divine non-deception**.
- FACT: Survives: **causal and structural** representation. WRONG: Exposed: **qualitative resemblance**.
- Locke is epistemically humble, not sceptical: the candle burns bright enough for the conduct of life.

## D. Locke - abstraction, nominal essence and real essence

- Argument: all existents are particular (III.iii.1) -> separate names impossible (III.iii.2-4) -> general terms needed -> words general by signifying **general ideas** (III.iii.6) -> ideas made general by **separation from circumstances of time, place and concomitants** (III.iii.6-9) -> a **general representative** -> the **nominal essence** annexed to the name (III.iii.15) -> universals are "the inventions and creatures of the understanding" (III.iii.11).
- **Nominal essence** = the abstract idea attached to the general name (gold: yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia). **Real essence** = the internal constitution producing observable properties; generally unknown.
- Locke is a **conceptualist**, not a Platonic realist and not a bare nominalist.
- The concession (IV.vii.9): the general triangle is "neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once", and is "**something imperfect, that cannot exist**".
- Best reply: **partial, not contradictory** - a determinable with angles left undetermined. Price: the abstract idea stops being imagistic.
- Four presuppositions: ideational meaning · imagistic ideas · possible subtraction · one idea per general word.

## E. Locke - qualities and the substratum

|        | Primary                                             | Secondary                                   |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| List   | solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number | colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold |
| Status | really in the object; inseparable from body         | <b>powers</b> to produce sensations in us   |
| Ideas  | <b>resemble</b> the qualities                       | resemble nothing in the object              |
| Test   | every fragment retains them                         | vary with the perceiver's organs            |

- Two separable theses: **A** the explanatory division; **B** the resemblance picture.

- Berkeley's **parity** (Section 9-15) attacks A - answered, since relativity is what a real shape would produce. Berkeley's **likeness** (Section 8) attacks B - this lands.
- Survivor: **measurable-structural versus response-dependent** properties, defended by **isomorphism**, not by likeness.
- Substratum (II.xxiii.2): "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" - **nature** unknown, **existence** not denied.
- Berkeley's next move: an unknowable support is an **abstract general idea** (being + supporting), so matter becomes **meaningless**, not mysterious.

## F. Locke - personal identity and God

- Three identities: **substance** · **man** (the continuing living organism) · **person**.
- Person (II.xxvii.9, chapter **added in the second edition of 1694**): "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places".
- Criterion: the extension of **consciousness** by **appropriation**; memory is vehicle and evidence, not the definition. "Person" is a **forensic** term.
- **Prince and cobbler**: person follows consciousness, man follows the organism.
- Objections: **Butler and Reid** - circularity, since memory presupposes identity; **Reid's Brave Officer** - transitivity fails; **gaps** - sleep and amnesia.
- Repairs: **overlapping chains** of consciousness; continuous **capacity** rather than constant recollection.
- ANALYSIS: Verdict: forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete.
- **God**: known by **demonstration** - nothing comes from nothing; I exist; therefore an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being. ANALYSIS: The exposed premise is the causal principle Hume later refuses to certify. WRONG: No innate idea of God.

## G. Berkeley - nominalism and the anti-abstraction base

- **Allowed**: separating parts that **could** exist apart (a hand, a headless torso). **Denied**: separating what **cannot** (extension without colour; motion without determinate speed; "man" without stature).
- Locke's triangle is quoted **verbatim** at *Principles*, Introduction Section 13, and declared self-contradictory.
- Replacement (Section 12): an idea is general "**by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort**" - a determinate particular, **selectively attended to**. The geometer draws this inch-long line and proves a theorem about all lines.
- Section 19-20: words do not always stand for ideas; language also raises passion, prompts action and disposes the mind. ANALYSIS: A genuine anticipation of the later claim that meaning is use.
- **Payload**: matter = the abstract idea of *being* + the relative notion of *supporting*; so **immaterialism rests on the nominalism, not the reverse**.
- Limits: the attack works against **imagistic** Locke; and Berkeley owes an account of what fixes the **respect** of representation.

## H. Berkeley - the five arguments and *esse est percipi*

semantic (Sec.1-4) -> likeness (Sec.8) -> parity (Sec.9-15) ->  
master (Sec.22-23) -> continuity (Sec.6, 30-33, 48)

1. **Semantic**: objects of knowledge are ideas; "sensible things" means what is immediately perceived; an apple or a tree is a **collection of ideas**; ideas cannot exist unperceived; therefore *esse est percipi* (Section 3), and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible. ANALYSIS: Step three is a **definition**, not a discovery.
2. **Likeness (Section 8)**: an idea can be like nothing but an idea; an unverifiable resemblance is empty. **Objection**: isomorphism needs no qualitative likeness.
3. **Parity (Section 9-15)**: Locke's own relativity considerations apply to primary qualities too. **Objection**: relativity does not entail mind-dependence.

4. **Master (Section Section 22-23):** you cannot conceive a body unconceived. **Objection (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois):** a scope or use-mention confusion. **Berkeley's reply:** question-begging only if immaterialism is already false.
5. **Continuity (Section Section 6, 30-33, 48):** ideas are passive, sense-ideas arrive involuntarily in order, only spirits act, therefore God - and unperceived things persist in the infinite Mind.
- Reality versus imagination: **involuntary, vivid, coherent, law-governed**. Illusion is an error of **judgment**, not of existence.
- **WRONG:** Never "Berkeley denies the external world". **ANALYSIS:** *Esse est percipi aut percipere* is a **later expansion**, not his Latin.

## I. Berkeley - spirits, notions, God and the two required comparisons

- Ontology: **spirits** (active substances that perceive and will) + **ideas** (passive). Nothing else.
- Spirits are known by **notion** (Section Section 27, 89, 140), not by idea, because a passive idea could never picture an activity. Critics call it ad hoc; Berkeley holds the asymmetry is forced.
- **God:** derived from the passivity of ideas plus the involuntary order of sense; secures **continuity**; the laws of nature are the settled grammar of a divine language - regularities are **signs**, not causes.
- Other finite minds: inferred by **analogy** from purposive signs. Solipsism blocked, but knowledge of other spirits is less immediate.
- Common sense: Berkeley claims to save it, and blames the **materialist** for inventing the unknowable world. **ANALYSIS:** Strong about objects, weaker about causes. The Johnson stone anecdote is **reception**, not refutation.
- **Moore:** the act-object distinction - awareness of blue is not blue; transparency supports **direct realism**. **Russell:** ordinary objects are **logical constructions** from sense-data, perspectives and relations. Shared ground: no reduction of object to act. **The difference:** Moore *defends* the ordinary object, Russell *replaces* it.
- **Hegel contrast:** Berkeley - reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, and God is an infinite **perceiver**; Hegel - reality is the self-development of **Absolute Spirit**, objectivity a moment within dialectic. Different in **kind**, not degree.

## J. Hume - impressions and ideas, the fork, substance and the belief in body

- Perceptions = **impressions** (vivid) + **ideas** (faint copies); the criterion is **force and vivacity**.
- **Copy principle:** every simple idea derives from a simple impression. **CAUTION:** Conceded exception: the **missing shade of blue** (*Treatise* I.i.1; *Enquiry* II), which shows the principle is an empirical generalisation. **Reply:** interpolation between impressions actually had.
- **Association:** resemblance · contiguity in time or place · cause and effect. Psychological, not logical - and it powers both the fiction of the self and causal belief.
- **The fork:** relations of ideas (a priori, necessary, denial contradictory) versus matters of fact (a posteriori, contingent, contrary conceivable). Neither -> "**commit it then to the flames**" (*Enquiry* XII), aimed at divinity or school metaphysics. Direct ancestor of the verification principle.
- **Substance:** no impression of a bearer -> a **fiction of the imagination**; dissolves **material and spiritual** substance alike, which is where Hume passes Berkeley.
- **Belief in body** (*Treatise* I.iv.2): sense gives only interrupted perceptions; **constancy** and **coherence** lead the imagination to feign continued and distinct objects; the philosophers' **double-existence** theory is unverifiable because all comparison stays within perceptions. **ANALYSIS:** Reason cannot justify the belief; **nature** compels it.

## K. Hume - the self, God and mitigated scepticism

- No constant and invariable impression of a self; only perceptions in **perpetual flux**.
- *Treatise* I.iv.6: the self is "**a bundle or collection of different perceptions, which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity**".
- The felt unity is a **fiction** produced by **resemblance** and **causation**: an easy transition mistaken for an identical object.
- **Appendix**: "all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions."  
ANALYSIS: Having denied both substance and real connexion, no resource remains - the failure indicts the **atomism**. The *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.
- **Kant**: accepts that no soul-substance is found; the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all representations; the **transcendental unity of apperception** is a **formal condition**, not an entity. Humean rejoinder: a condition of description, not a discovered subject.
- **God - three fronts, all lost**. Causal: no impression of a first cause or of necessary connexion. Design (*Dialogues*): weak analogy; at most a **finite** architect; natural order without intelligence; the problem of evil. Miracles (*Enquiry* X): testimony is always less probable than its own falsehood.
- **Scepticism: excessive or Pyrrhonian** suspension is unliveable; **mitigated** scepticism limits enquiry to what experience can answer, proportions belief to evidence and relies on natural belief. CAUTION: Stable only if natural beliefs are exempt from the demand for justification.

## L. Hume on causation and induction; exam craft, PYQ routes and the trap sheet

observe: priority + contiguity + constant conjunction  
 not observed: power or tie  
 internal search: no impression of how the will moves the limb  
 found: the MIND'S DETERMINATION = impression of reflection  
 -> two definitions of cause -> custom -> the induction dilemma

- **Two definitions**: (i) an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed - objective, regularity-based; (ii) an object whose appearance **conveys the thought** to the other - psychological. ANALYSIS: Never reconciled; the origin of the regularity-versus-projectivist debate.
- **Induction (Enquiry IV)**: the Uniformity Principle is neither **demonstrable** (its denial is conceivable) nor **probable** (every experiential argument presupposes it), so inference rests on **custom**, "the great guide of human life" (*Enquiry* V). Every serious reply attacks **step 3**, the demonstrative-or-probable division - Kant with the synthetic a priori, Popper by denying that science needs induction, Strawson by dissolving the demand.
- **Kant's Second Analogy**: the category of cause is an *a priori* rule needed to distinguish **objective** event-succession from the **subjective** succession of perceptions; "every event has a cause" is synthetic a priori for possible experience, with no claim about things in themselves.

### PYQ routes - all twelve, in one place

| Year | Part  | Marks | Route                                                                                                                      |
|------|-------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Q1(a) | 10    | The fork: relation of ideas versus matter of fact; conceivability test                                                     |
| 2018 | Q3(a) | 20    | Five arguments for immaterialism, then Moore's act-object realism versus Russell's logical construction, then the contrast |
| 2019 | Q4(b) | 15    | Not in objects, yes in the mind: the impression of reflection; both definitions                                            |
| 2020 | Q2(a) | 20    | Bundle self, fiction of unity, Appendix; then Kant's transcendental unity of apperception                                  |
| 2021 | Q1(c) | 10    | "Immediately perceived": the semantic argument and the removal of the veil                                                 |
| 2021 | Q1(d) | 10    | Person/man/substance; consciousness and appropriation; Butler-Reid; verdict                                                |
| 2021 | Q1(e) | 10    | Constant conjunction is necessary, not sufficient; the felt determination completes it                                     |
| 2022 | Q4(c) | 15    | Three grounds; white paper; sensation and reflection; the three degrees                                                    |
| 2023 | Q2(a) | 20    | Full causal analysis; association and custom; three objections; ruling                                                     |

| Year | Part  | Marks | Route                                                                                        |
|------|-------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Q2(a) | 20    | Parity and likeness, abstraction as the deeper ground; Berkeley versus Hegel on matched axes |
| 2025 | Q2(c) | 15    | Hume complete, then the Second Analogy, then adjudication                                    |
| 2025 | Q4(c) | 15    | Locke's abstraction, Berkeley's refutation, the Section 12 replacement, the payload          |

**Directive decoder in one line each.** Explain = give the **derivation**. Examine = state **and** test. Critically analyse = exposition **plus** verdict. Discuss = roughly 60:40 exposition to assessment. "Is there any element...?" = a **yes-and-no with a distinction**. "Is A instrumental in B?" = a causal-explanatory ruling.

**Provenance rules that protect marks.** *Tabula rasa* is a later label; Locke writes "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2). *Esse est percipi* is Berkeley's own Latin at Section 3; *aut percipere* is a commentators' expansion. II.xxvii was added in **1694**. The *Essay* appeared in **1689** with **1690** on the title page. The *Treatise* and the *Enquiry* must not be merged; the *Enquiry* drops personal identity, and it appeared in 1748 as *Philosophical Essays* before being renamed in 1758. "Reason is the slave of the passions" is *Treatise* II.iii.3 and belongs to ethics, not epistemology. Samuel Johnson's stone is reception, not argument.

### Trap sheet - ten lines

1. "Berkeley denies the external world" - he denies **matter as an unperceiving substratum**.
2. "Hume denies causation" - he denies **objective necessary connexion**, not causal inference.
3. "Secondary qualities are illusions" - they are **powers**.
4. "Locke denies substance" - he denies **knowledge of its nature**.
5. "*Tabula rasa*" quoted as Locke's words - it is the tradition's label.
6. "Hume says the self does not exist" - no **simple identical substance**; the perceptions are real.
7. "Kant proves the soul" - he supplies a **formal condition** of unified experience.
8. Berkeley called a sceptic - he is an **anti-sceptic** who blames the materialist.
9. Berkeley called an early Hegel - subjective versus absolute idealism differ in **kind**.
10. Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" imported here - it belongs to Topic 11.

**Memory chain - say it in fifteen seconds.** *One rule about the origin of content, applied three times. Locke keeps matter he cannot inspect; Berkeley deletes matter and keeps spirits and God; Hume deletes substance, the simple self and objective necessity, and keeps perceptions, custom and natural belief. Necessity moves from the object to the observer. Kant enters only where a question routes him - apperception for the self, the Second Analogy for causation.*

### COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM



**ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/48: Central question, the shared rule and the realism-idealism-scepticism route**

```
=====
CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT CAN AN EXPERIENCE-ONLY FOUNDATION ACTUALLY JUSTIFY?
|
+--> SHARED RULE: every SIMPLE cognitive content traces to
| experience - Locke's SENSATION (outer) and REFLECTION
| (inner operations of the mind); Hume's IMPRESSIONS
+--> NOT DENIED: the mind's OPERATIONS - compare, combine,
| abstract - nor Hume's a priori "relations of ideas"
+--> DENIED: innate IDEAS and PRINCIPLES in Locke's target sense
|
v
THE FOUR TEST CASES THE SYLLABUS PRINTS BY NAME
 1 THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE 2 SUBSTANCE AND QUALITIES
 3 SELF AND GOD 4 SCEPTICISM
|
+-----+-----+-----+
LOCKE	BERKELEY	HUME
representative	subjective/theistic	mitigated
realism	idealism	scepticism
matter REAL but	NO material	NO substance at all,
"know not what"	substance; esse est	no simple self, no
primary vs secondary	percipi; the quality	objective necessity;
qualities	distinction collapses	bundles + custom
self = continuity of	self = ACTIVE SPIRIT	self = BUNDLE of
consciousness	known by NOTION	perceptions in flux
God = DEMONSTRATED	God = CAUSE and	God = every proof
(causal route)	GUARANTOR of order	fails
NOT a sceptic	ANTI-sceptic	MITIGATED sceptic
+-----+-----+-----+		
+--> ADDED PREMISE, LOCKE: ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE		
+--> ADDED PREMISE, BERKELEY: COMPARABILITY - "an idea can be		
like nothing but an idea" (Principles Sec.8)		
+--> ADDED PREMISE, HUME: ATOMISM of impressions - no relation		
is given WITH its terms		
v
MNEMONICS: slide "R -> I -> S" | deletions "M-S-N" (Matter, Substantial
self, objective Necessity) | scepticism "H-A-M" (Humble, Anti-
sceptical, Mitigated)
```

**ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/48: Central question, the shared rule and the realism-idealism-scepticism route (continued)**

```
=====
SYLLABUS (verbatim): "Empiricism (Locke, Berkeley, Hume) : Theory of
Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism."
Paper I, Section A, item 3.
CORPUS SIGNAL: 12 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts, 2018-2025;
at least one part in EVERY year of the corpus.
```



## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/48: Chronology I - Locke's text, editions and the sections that matter

```
=====
1632-1704 JOHN LOCKE born Wrington, Somerset; died Oates, Essex
1689 An Essay Concerning Human Understanding is published
 CAUTION: the title page prints 1690 and the work is almost
 always cited as 1690; both dates are correct in their own sense
1690 Essay as dated - Book I anti-innatism
 Book II ideas, qualities, substance
 Book III words, abstraction, essence
 Book IV knowledge, degrees, probability, God
1694 SECOND EDITION ADDS II.xxvii "Of Identity and Diversity"
 CAUTION: personal identity is NOT in the original text; never
 date the doctrine to 1690
1700 Fourth edition - the text most modern editions follow
 (standard scholarly text: Nidditch, Clarendon 1975)
 |
SECTION MAP - CITE BY BOOK.CHAPTER.SECTION, WHICH IS EDITION-INVARIANT
II.i.2 "white paper, void of all characters"
II.viii primary and secondary qualities; the resemblance thesis
II.xxiii.2 "a supposition of he knows not what support of such
 qualities"
II.xxvii.9 the definition of a person
III.iii.1 everything that exists is particular
III.iii.2-4 separate names for every particular are impossible
III.iii.6-9 abstraction: separation from time, place, concomitants
III.iii.11 "the inventions and creatures of the understanding"
III.iii.15 the abstract idea annexed to a sortal name = NOMINAL
 ESSENCE
IV.vii.9 the general triangle: "all and none of these at once";
 "something imperfect, that cannot exist"
PROVENANCE: "tabula rasa" is SCHOLASTIC/ARISTOTELIAN vocabulary applied
to Locke by the tradition. It is NOT his phrase. Write: the mind as
"white paper, void of all characters" - the doctrine traditionally
labelled tabula rasa.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/48: Chronology II - Berkeley and Hume, with the section map and cautions

```
=====
1685-1753 GEORGE BERKELEY Irish; Anglican bishop of Cloyne from 1734
1710 A Treatise concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge
1713 Three Dialogues between Hylas and Philonous
SECTION MAP
Intro Sec.6-25 the attack on abstract general ideas
Intro Sec.12 "made to represent or stand for all other particular
 ideas of the same sort"
Intro Sec.13 Locke's triangle quoted VERBATIM back at him
Intro Sec.19-20 words do not always stand for ideas
Sec.1-4 the semantic argument
Sec.3 esse est percipi - Berkeley's OWN Latin
Sec.8 the likeness principle
Sec.9-15 the parity collapse of the quality distinction
Sec.22-23 the Master Argument
Sec.27, 89, 140 spirits known by NOTION, not by idea
Sec.6, 30-33, 48 God causes and sustains the order of ideas
CAUTION: "esse est percipi aut percipere" is a LATER COMMENTATORS'
EXPANSION made to accommodate spirits. Never quote it as Berkeley's.
|
1711-1776 DAVID HUME born and died in Edinburgh
1739-40 A Treatise of Human Nature
I.i.1 impressions and ideas; the missing shade of blue
I.iii.14 the search for the impression of necessary connexion
I.iv.2 constancy, coherence and the belief in body
I.iv.6 "a bundle or collection of different perceptions"
Appendix the RETRACTION: he cannot state the uniting principle
1748 An Enquiry concerning Human Understanding
CAUTION: published 1748 as Philosophical Essays concerning Human
Understanding; RENAMED 1758. Hume disowned the Treatise as a
juvenile work, and the Enquiry DROPS personal identity. Say which
text you are using.
II copy principle | IV induction | V custom, "the great guide of
human life" | VII necessary connexion + the TWO definitions |
X miracles | XII mitigated scepticism; "commit it then to the
flames" (aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics")
1779 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion (POSTHUMOUS) - the
critique of the design argument
|
18th c. JOSEPH BUTLER and THOMAS REID (Reid 1710-1796): the circularity
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/48: Chronology II - Berkeley and Hume, with the section map and cautions (continued)

```
=====
charge and the Brave Officer against Locke on personal identity
REPORTED Samuel Johnson kicks a stone - "I refute it thus!"
CAUTION: RECEPTION, not an argument. Berkeley never denied the
stone is felt; felt resistance is exactly what he calls a stone.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/48: Locke: the three grounds against innate ideas and the surviving innatism

```
=====
INNATIST CLAIM UNDER ATTACK (Essay, Book I): certain ideas and principles
- God, identity, non-contradiction, moral rules - are stamped on the mind
at birth.
|
+--> GROUND 1 UNIVERSAL ASSENT FAILS
| if innate, ALL humans - including children and "idiots" -
| would possess them; manifestly they do not
| TARGET: the innatist appeal to universal agreement
| STATUS: empirical; a dispositional innatist can absorb it
|
+--> GROUND 2 NO UNCONSCIOUS IDEAS <== DECISIVE
| a thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory,
| because for Locke "to be IN the mind" = "to be PERCEIVED by
| the mind"
| TARGET: the retreat to ideas present but unnoticed
| STATUS: a STIPULATION about the meaning of "idea", not an
| observation - and this is what closes the escape route
|
+--> GROUND 3 A GENETIC ACCOUNT IS AVAILABLE (redundancy)
| every idea CLAIMED innate can be traced to sensation or
| reflection; if experience suffices, innateness is idle
| STATUS: empirical; inconclusive against a capacity claim
|
|
v
DESCARTES' DISPOSITIONAL REPLY: innate ideas were never claimed to be
consciously present from birth; they are CAPACITIES of the intellect,
elicited on an appropriate occasion, as a family disease is innate
before it appears.
|
v
ADJUDICATION
 AGAINST NAIVE INNATISM (consciously possessed inborn propositions):
 Locke wins outright.
 AGAINST DISPOSITIONAL INNATISM: ground 1 misses, ground 3 is
 inconclusive, and everything turns on ground 2 - a stipulation.
 THE SURVIVOR, NAMED: Leibniz - "nothing is in the intellect that was
 not first in the senses, EXCEPT THE INTELLECT ITSELF". Innatism
 survives as a thesis about STRUCTURE, the form Kant vindicates.
 PYQ ANCHOR: 2022 Q4(c) demands why and how; 2023 Q2(c) is decided on the
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/48: Locke: the three grounds against innate ideas and the surviving innatism (continued)

```
=====
dispositional reply.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/48: Locke: the two fountains and the construction of complex ideas

=====

EXPERIENCE HAS TWO CHANNELS - AND OMITTING THE SECOND WRECKS THE ANSWER

|                              |                                |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| SENSATION (outer sense)      | REFLECTION (inner sense)       |
| colour, sound, taste, smell, | thinking, doubting, believing, |
| warmth, solidity, extension, | willing, reasoning, knowing -  |
| figure, motion, number       | the mind observing ITSELF      |

\                      /  
v                      v

SIMPLE IDEAS - PASSIVELY RECEIVED

the mind can neither make nor destroy one; a person born blind has no idea of scarlet

|

ACTIVE OPERATIONS: COMBINE | COMPARE | ABSTRACT

|

v

COMPLEX IDEAS - THREE KINDS

|                                                     |                                                                                                        |                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MODES                                               | SUBSTANCES                                                                                             | RELATIONS                                                                     |
| dependent combinations: triangle, gratitude, number | supposed INDEPENDENT bearers, represented through clusters of co-occurring qualities (gold, man, lead) | produced by COMPARING one thing with another: cause, identity, moral relation |

|

v

PAYLOAD THAT MOST SCRIPTS MISS: "substance" appears HERE as a COMPLEX IDEA. That is already the admission Session 5 exploits - we have a CLUSTER plus a SUPPOSITION, never an inspected substratum.

WHY REFLECTION MATTERS: it lets Locke be an empiricist about logic, mathematics and the self without innate content - and it is the channel Hume later exploits when he locates the impression of necessary connexion INTERNALLY.

TRAP: "blank slate = a passive mind" is false. Only SIMPLE ideas are passive; complex ideas are the WORKMANSHIP OF THE UNDERSTANDING.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/48: Locke: knowledge, the three degrees and the domain of probability

=====

KNOWLEDGE = THE PERCEPTION OF THE AGREEMENT OR DISAGREEMENT OF IDEAS

CONSEQUENCE: everything Locke can say about the world must be expressed as a relation AMONG IDEAS - which is why the existence of things outside the mind is the hardest thing for his system to certify.

|  
v

| DEGREE                                            | MECHANISM                                                                         | EXAMPLE                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| INTUITIVE<br>most certain                         | agreement seen<br>IMMEDIATELY, no<br>intervening idea                             | "white is not<br>black"; my own<br>existence   |
| DEMONSTRATIVE<br>high, but long<br>chains can err | agreement seen through<br>a CHAIN of intervening<br>ideas, each link<br>intuitive | mathematical proof;<br>the existence of<br>God |
| SENSITIVE<br>LOWEST of the<br>three               | the existence of<br>PARTICULAR things now<br>affecting the senses                 | "there is a sheet<br>of paper before me"       |

|  
----- BELOW THIS LINE IS NOT KNOWLEDGE AT ALL -----

|  
PROBABILITY AND JUDGEMENT: conformity with our own experience, plus  
testimony weighed by number, integrity, skill and consistency.  
Here live natural philosophy, all history and everyday reasoning.

|  
v

THE EXAMINABLE POINT: the EXTERNAL WORLD sits on the WEAKEST rung. Rich  
sources, NARROW certification. That asymmetry - not any sceptical  
intention - is what destabilises representative realism.  
UNRESOLVED TENSION: sensitive knowledge and high probability shade into  
one another, and Locke never draws the boundary sharply.  
PYQ ANCHOR: 2022 Q4(c), second limb - "the nature and source of  
knowledge in Locke's epistemology".

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/48: Locke: representative realism, the veil objection and what survives

```
=====
THE CHAIN LOCKE ACCEPTS
 EXTERNAL BODY --acts on--> SENSE ORGAN --produces--> IDEA IN MIND
 (has primary qualities; (mechanically (the ONLY thing
 real essence unknown) affected) ever inspected)
 |
 KNOWLEDGE OPERATES ONLY AT THE THIRD TERM: agreement AMONG IDEAS
 |
 THE REPRESENTATION CLAIM
 ideas of PRIMARY qualities RESEMBLE their causes
 ideas of SECONDARY qualities resemble NOTHING in the object
 |
 v
 THE VEIL OBJECTION - STATE IT YOURSELF BEFORE THE EXAMINER DOES
 To check that an idea resembles its cause I must COMPARE the two.
 But I can only ever inspect the IDEA. So the resemblance is a claim
 I am, IN PRINCIPLE, unable to test.
 ("Veil of perception" is the CRITICS' image, not Locke's phrase.)
 |
 +--> LOCKE'S FOUR DEFENCES
 | 1 sense ideas are INVOLUNTARY
 | 2 DIFFERENT SENSES AGREE about the same body
 | 3 pleasure and pain accompany real bodies in ways
 | imagination cannot reproduce
 | 4 God would not construct us to be SYSTEMATICALLY DECEIVED
 | in what matters for the conduct of life
 |
 v
 WHAT SURVIVES / WHAT IS EXPOSED
 SURVIVES: a CAUSAL and STRUCTURAL representation claim - this idea
 was produced by that body, and measurable structure corresponds
 EXPOSED: the further QUALITATIVE RESEMBLANCE claim - and that is the
 exact target of Principles Sec.8
 |
 v
 LOCKE IS NOT A SCEPTIC: he denies knowledge of real essences and of the
 intrinsic nature of substance, not knowledge sufficient for "the
 conveniences of life and the information of virtue".
 NEVER WRITE: "Locke leads to scepticism" as if he endorsed it. Write:
 his structure MAKES A SCEPTICAL CHALLENGE AVAILABLE, and Berkeley claims
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/48: Locke: representative realism, the veil objection and what survives (continued)

```
=====
to remove the challenge by removing the veil.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/48: Locke: abstraction - the eight numbered steps and the general representative

```
=====
THE PROBLEM: everything that EXISTS is particular; almost every WORD is
general. How can a mind furnished only with particular ideas use general
words?
 |
 v
THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED Essay III.iii and IV.vii.9
1 Everything that exists is PARTICULAR III.iii.1
2 A separate name for every particular is impossible -
 memory could not hold them and communication would fail III.iii.2-4
3 THEREFORE language requires GENERAL TERMS
4 Words are general ONLY by being signs of GENERAL IDEAS III.iii.6
 (meaning is always mediated by an idea in the mind)
5 Ideas become general when the mind SEPARATES them from
 circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea III.iii.6-9
6 What remains serves as a "GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE" of all
 particulars of the same sort
7 The abstract idea annexed to a sortal name IS the
 NOMINAL ESSENCE by which we classify III.iii.15
 -> classification is the WORKMANSHIP OF THE UNDERSTANDING,
 not a reading-off of real essences
8 "General and universal belong not to the real existence of
 things; they are the inventions and creatures of the
 understanding, made by it for its own use, and concern
 only signs" III.iii.11
 |
 v
POSITION NAMED: LOCKE IS A CONCEPTUALIST - neither a Platonic realist
about universals nor a bare nominalist. Naming the position is a
one-word gain in precision most scripts never make.
 |
 v
WHY THE DOCTRINE IS NOT OPTIONAL: without it Locke has no account of
classification, of definition, or of the nominal essences on which the
whole of Book III depends. Berkeley understood this exactly, which is
why he attacks ABSTRACTION FIRST, in the INTRODUCTION, before saying a
word about matter.
```



## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/48: Locke: the general triangle, the two essences and four presuppositions

```
=====
THE CANONICAL EXAMPLE - AND THE ADMISSION Essay IV.vii.9
+-----+
| The general idea of a triangle "must be neither oblique nor |
| rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but ALL |
| AND NONE of these at once." |
| Locke concedes it is "SOMETHING IMPERFECT, THAT CANNOT EXIST", and |
| that framing it "requires some pains and skill." |
| -> Berkeley quotes this passage VERBATIM at Principles Intro Sec.13 |
+-----+
|
| v
TWO ESSENCES - KEEP THEM APART
+-----+
NOMINAL ESSENCE	REAL ESSENCE
the abstract idea annexed to	the internal constitution -
the general name: "gold" =	Locke's arrangement of
yellow, heavy, malleable,	"insensible corpuscles" - from
soluble in aqua regia	which observable properties
	flow
KNOWN - we made it	UNKNOWN - we posit it
fixes CLASSIFICATION	fixes nothing we can use
+-----+	
CONSEQUENCE: species boundaries are CONVENTIONAL IN THEIR SHARPNESS	
though not arbitrary in their materials. Locke is AGNOSTIC about	
real essences without DENYING that things have them.	
v	
FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS THE ARGUMENT NEEDS	
P1 MEANING IS IDEATIONAL - a word signifies by standing for an idea	
P2 IDEAS ARE IMAGISTIC and particular in origin	
P3 MENTAL SUBTRACTION is possible and leaves something contentful	
P4 ONE IDEA PER GENERAL WORD - generality lives in the IDEA, not in	
the USE of the word	
BERKELEY destroys P2 and P3. WITTGENSTEIN later destroys P1 and P4.	
v	
LOCKE'S BEST REPLY - AND THE PRICE
REPLY: the abstract idea is PARTIAL, not CONTRADICTORY - three-
sidedness with the angles LEFT UNDETERMINED, not with contradictory
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/48: Locke: the general triangle, the two essences and four presuppositions (continued)

```
=====
angles ASSIGNED. Determinables need not be determinate.
PRICE: this requires giving up the IMAGISTIC model of ideas that
Locke elsewhere retains; the abstract idea becomes a non-imagistic
act of the understanding, and so is no longer an "idea" in his own
official sense.
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: Berkeley wins against the IMAGISTIC Locke and loses
against the DETERMINABLE Locke. The lasting casualty is the IDEATIONAL
THEORY OF MEANING, whose true heir is Wittgenstein, not Hume.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/48: Locke: primary and secondary qualities - the table and the two theses

```
=====
+-----+-----+
| PRIMARY QUALITIES | SECONDARY QUALITIES |
+-----+-----+
solidity, extension, figure,	colour, sound, taste, smell,
motion/rest, number	warmth/cold
really IN the object	POWERS in the object to
	produce sensations in us
our ideas of them RESEMBLE the	our ideas do NOT resemble
qualities themselves	anything in the object
INSEPARABLE from body - every	DEPEND on the perceiver's
fragment retains them	sense-organs
+-----+-----+	
BASIS OF THE DIVISION: primary qualities are those ANY body must have	
however small; they enter the explanation of what bodies do. Secondary	
qualities are RELATIONAL - primary-quality configurations ACTING ON our	
sense-organs.	
TEST TO REMEMBER: cut the sugar cube to invisibility. Shape survives the	
slicing; sweetness does not, because sweetness was always a relation to	
a taster.	
v
TWO SEPARABLE THESES - SEPARATING THEM IS THE 2024 ANSWER
 THESIS A the EXPLANATORY division: which properties a physics must
 attribute to bodies
 THESIS B the RESEMBLANCE picture: ideas of the first group PICTURE
 their causes
 |
 +--> BERKELEY'S PARITY ARGUMENT (Sec.9-15; Dialogues I) hits A
 | extension cannot be conceived without colour; motion/rest
 | are relative to the observer; figure is inseparable from
 | extension. Apparent size varies with distance, motion with
 | frame, shape with angle.
 | ANSWER: perceptual relativity does NOT entail mind-
 | dependence. Looking different from different positions is
 | exactly what a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with a real shape
 | should produce.
 |
 +--> BERKELEY'S LIKENESS PRINCIPLE (Sec.8) hits B - AND LANDS
 | "an idea can be like nothing but an idea"; and if the
```

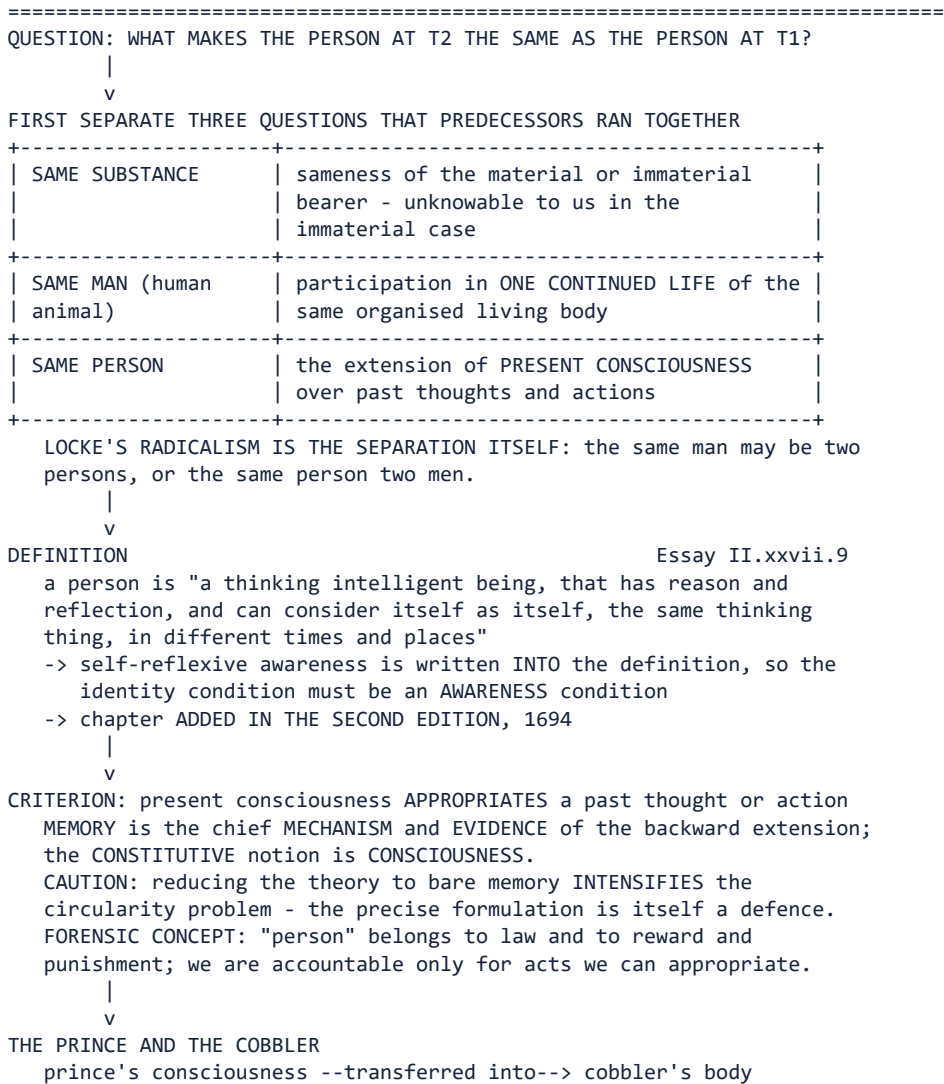
## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/48: Locke: primary and secondary qualities - the table and the two theses (continued)

```
=====
|
| originals are unperceivable, no comparison is possible, so
| a resemblance we could never check is EMPTY.
| RESCUE FOR LOCKE: ISOMORPHISM - structural or mathematical
| correspondence needs no qualitative likeness; a map
| corresponds to terrain without being terrain-coloured.
|
v
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the distinction survives as MEASURABLE-STRUCTURAL vs
RESPONSE-DEPENDENT properties, but NOT as Locke's resemblance thesis.
His mistake was to make the division depend on a PICTURE rather than on
EXPLANATORY ROLE - which is why physics keeps the distinction and
Locke's version of it does not.
TRAP: "secondary qualities are illusions" - they are POWERS.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/48: Locke: the substratum, stated exactly, defended fairly, and attacked

```
=====
WE MEET CLUSTERS THAT REGULARLY GO TOGETHER
 yellow + heavy + malleable + soluble in aqua regia = "gold"
 |
 WE CANNOT CONCEIVE QUALITIES AS SUBSISTING BY THEMSELVES
 |
 v
SO WE SUPPOSE A SUBSTRATUM THAT SUPPORTS THEM
 Essay II.xxiii.2 - the exact words:
 "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities"
 |
 +--> WHAT IS DENIED: any POSITIVE IDEA of the substratum; any
 | knowledge of the REAL ESSENCE it embodies
 +--> WHAT IS AFFIRMED: that something is qualified - qualities
 | do not float
 |
 v
THE FAIREST DEFENCE: the substratum is an EXPLANATORY POSIT tied to the
stability of qualities and kinds, NOT a claimed object of intuition.
 |
 v
BERKELEY'S REPLY - AND WHY IT IS DECISIVE FOR HIS SYSTEM
 "Support" here is a DEAD METAPHOR borrowed from pillars and floors.
 Strip the metaphor and what remains is the ABSTRACT IDEA OF BEING
 plus the RELATIVE NOTION OF SUPPORTING - which is precisely an
 ABSTRACT GENERAL IDEA.
 THEREFORE, if abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious
 UNKNOWN but a MEANINGLESS EXPRESSION.
 THEREFORE Berkeley's IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON HIS NOMINALISM, not the
 reverse.
 |
 v
FIX THE THREE POSITIONS BY THEIR VERBS - THEY ARE EASY TO SWAP
 LOCKE SUPPOSES a support whose nature is unknown
 BERKELEY DENIES THE SENSE of the expression "material substance"
 HUME DISSOLVES substance into a stable BUNDLE of qualities, and
 | does so for SPIRITUAL substance as well
 TRAP: "Locke denies substance" is false. He denies KNOWLEDGE OF ITS
 NATURE and affirms its existence.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/48: Locke: personal identity - three identities, the criterion, the case



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/48: Locke: personal identity - three identities, the criterion, the case (continued)

```
=====
THE PERSON who wakes is the PRINCE | THE MAN who wakes is the COBBLER
THEREFORE personal identity is NEITHER BODILY NOR SUBSTANTIAL
identity - established without any commitment about souls.
PYQ ANCHOR: 2021 Q1(d) "Examine" - doctrine AND test are both required.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/48: Locke: the objections to personal identity, the repairs and the verdict

```
=====
OBJECTION 1 - CIRCULARITY SOURCE: Butler, Reid
+-----+
| I can remember only MY OWN experiences. So "genuine memory" already|
| presupposes identity. If identity is DEFINED by memory, the |
| definition is circular. |
+-----+
 REPLY: distinguish the CONSTITUTIVE criterion (consciousness) from
 the EVIDENTIAL criterion (memory).
 RESIDUAL: "consciousness of X AS MINE" may smuggle the same
 ownership back in. The charge remains genuinely open.
 |
OBJECTION 2 - TRANSITIVITY FAILS: REID'S BRAVE OFFICER
+-----+
| BOY (flogged at school) <--remembers-- YOUNG OFFICER |
| YOUNG OFFICER <--remembers-- OLD GENERAL |
| BOY <--NOT remembered by-- OLD GENERAL |
| So: boy = officer, officer = general, but boy != general. |
| Identity is TRANSITIVE. Locke's criterion, read as bare episodic |
| memory, is not. |
+-----+
 REPAIR: OVERLAPPING CHAINS - identity is the ANCESTRAL of direct
 appropriation.
 RESIDUAL: transitivity is restored, but the theory is no longer the
 simple memory criterion the textbooks attribute to Locke.
 |
OBJECTION 3 - GAPS: dreamless sleep, anaesthesia, amnesia
 REPLY: continuous CAPACITY for appropriation, not constant
 recollection.
 RESIDUAL: capacity-talk strains the account, and Locke concedes that
 whether the same substance persists through a gap is unknowable.
 |
 v
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: best defended as a REPAIRED PSYCHOLOGICAL-CONTINUITY
account. On that reading it survives Reid; the circularity charge stays
open. FORENSICALLY INDISPENSABLE, METAPHYSICALLY INCOMPLETE.
 Saying exactly this is what the directive "examine" requires.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/48: Locke on God, and the premise Hume will later refuse to certify

```
=====
HOW IS GOD KNOWN? - PLACE IT ON LOCKE'S OWN LADDER
 NOT by INTUITION (that would be the ontological strategy)
 NOT by SENSITIVE knowledge (reserved for particular present things)
 BY DEMONSTRATION - the SECOND degree
 |
 v
THE CHAIN
 1 I exist, and I know it with INTUITIVE certainty
 2 Something cannot come from nothing
 3 Therefore there has existed FROM ETERNITY a most powerful and most
 knowing being
 |
 v
CLASSIFICATION: a COSMOLOGICAL-STYLE argument conducted INSIDE an
empiricist framework. God is reached ABOVE the external world and BELOW
self-knowledge on the ladder of degrees.
 |
 v
THE EXPOSED PREMISE - THE CLEANEST LINK IN THE WHOLE ITEM
 Step 2 is the CAUSAL PRINCIPLE. Hume will refuse to certify it,
 because there is NO IMPRESSION of causal necessity. Locke's proof of
 God therefore fails at exactly the point where Hume's analysis of
 causation bites.
 -> Use this link in ANY comparative answer on God in this item.
 |
 v
WHAT LOCKE DOES NOT SAY
 There is NO INNATE IDEA OF GOD. That was one of the candidates Book I
 explicitly dismissed - so an answer that gives Locke an innate idea
 of God contradicts the foundation of his system.
COMPARISON PREVIEW: Locke uses God as a SUPPORT (guarantor of our
faculties); Berkeley REQUIRES him as a MECHANISM (cause and continuity);
Hume treats him as a CASUALTY (no proof survives).
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/48: Berkeley: the demolition of abstraction, the replacement and the payload

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=====
BERKELEY'S DEMOLITION, NUMBERED Principles, Introduction Sec.6-25
1 I CONCEDE I can imagine particular things I have perceived, and
 compound and divide such ideas - a hand without a body, a headless
 torso. This is SEPARATION OF PARTS THAT COULD EXIST APART.
2 But ABSTRACTION PROPER requires separating what CANNOT exist apart:
 extension without any colour; motion without a determinate speed;
 "man" without any determinate stature or complexion.
3 Locke's own triangle - neither equilateral nor scalene, yet ALL AND
 NONE at once - is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY; no such idea can be framed.
 (Berkeley quotes the passage VERBATIM at Intro Sec.13.)
4 THEREFORE there are no abstract general ideas.
5 POSITIVE REPLACEMENT: an idea is general not by being abstract but
 "BY BEING MADE TO REPRESENT OR STAND FOR ALL OTHER PARTICULAR IDEAS
 OF THE SAME SORT" (Intro Sec.12). A determinate particular idea,
 SELECTIVELY ATTENDED TO, does duty for a class: the geometer draws
 THIS black inch-long line and proves a theorem about ALL lines.
6 COROLLARY AGAINST THE WHOLE TRADITION: words do not always stand for
 ideas at all; language also RAISES PASSION, PROMPTS ACTION and
 DISPOSES THE MIND (Intro Sec.19-20). This is a genuine anticipation
 of the later claim that meaning is USE.
7 METAPHYSICAL PAYLOAD: Locke's MATERIAL SUBSTANCE IN GENERAL and
 SUBSTRATUM are precisely abstract general ideas - the abstract idea
 of BEING plus the relative notion of SUPPORTING. If abstraction is
 impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a MEANINGLESS
 EXPRESSION. IMMATERIALISM RESTS ON THE NOMINALISM, NOT THE REVERSE.
 |
 v
WHAT IS DENIED AND WHAT IS NOT
DENIED: ABSTRACT general ideas.
NOT DENIED: general ideas, general words, general knowledge. Geometry
proceeds perfectly well on Berkeley's account.
 |
 v
TWO LIMITS TO STATE YOURSELF
LIMIT 1 The argument works only against an IMAGISTIC reading of
 ideas. Locke's DETERMINABLE reply - undetermined, not contradictory
 - escapes step 3.
LIMIT 2 THE UNPAID BILL: what fixes the RESPECT under which the
 particular idea represents its class? If the answer is a further
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 23/48: Berkeley: the demolition of abstraction, the replacement and the payload (continued)

```
=====
 idea of the respect, the abstract idea has RETURNED under another
 name; if it is a practice of use, Berkeley has moved beyond the
 theory of ideas altogether - the direction step 6 points.
PYQ ANCHOR: 2025 Q4(c) is this panel plus the Locke doctrine it refutes.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/48: Berkeley: arguments 1 and 2 - the semantic argument and the likeness principle

=====

ARGUMENT 1 - SEMANTIC / ANALYTIC Principles Sec.1-4

- 1 The objects of human knowledge are IDEAS: (a) imprinted on the senses, (b) perceived by attending to the passions and operations of the mind, (c) formed by memory and imagination.
- 2 "SENSIBLE THINGS" MEANS things IMMEDIATELY perceived by sense.  
(This is the sense of the phrase quoted in PYQ 2021 Q1(c).)
- 3 An apple, a stone, a tree, a book are NOTHING BUT COLLECTIONS of such immediately perceived ideas.
- 4 It is impossible that ideas should exist unperceived - their ESSE is PERCIPI; existence for them CONSISTS IN being perceived.
- 5 THEREFORE for sensible things ESSE EST PERCIPI (Sec.3), and to speak of their "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is UNINTELLIGIBLE.  
PRESUPPOSITION: step 3 is a DEFINITION, not a discovery. Grant it and immaterialism follows in four lines; deny it and nothing follows.  
THE WORD DOING THE WORK: "IMMEDIATELY". Locke held we perceive ideas that REPRESENT objects, so the object is reached MEDIATELY, by inference. Berkeley's definition removes the inference, and with it the veil and the sceptical problem the veil generated.  
BERKELEY'S OWN ILLUSTRATION (Sec.3): "The table I write on, I say, exists; that is, I see and feel it."

ARGUMENT 2 - THE LIKENESS PRINCIPLE Principles Sec.8

- 1 Locke says our ideas of primary qualities RESEMBLE qualities in bodies.
- 2 But "AN IDEA CAN BE LIKE NOTHING BUT AN IDEA" - a colour or figure can be like nothing but another colour or figure.
- 3 If the supposed originals are UNPERCEIVABLE, no comparison with them is even possible; a resemblance-claim we could NEVER IN PRINCIPLE CHECK is empty.
- 4 THEREFORE the representative-realist relation of resemblance between idea and material quality is UNINTELLIGIBLE.  
PRESUPPOSITION: resemblance requires COMPARABILITY BY A PERCEIVER.  
STRONGEST OBJECTION: STRUCTURAL or MATHEMATICAL resemblance (ISOMORPHISM) does not require qualitative likeness - a map resembles terrain without being terrain-coloured. This is the standard modern RESCUE OF LOCKE, and it concedes the qualitative point while saving the representational relation.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 25/48: Berkeley: arguments 3 and 4 - parity and the Master Argument

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ARGUMENT 3 - PARITY Principles Sec.9-15; Dialogues I

LOGICAL FORM: a PARITY argument. Every relativity consideration Locke accepts for SECONDARY qualities - variation with observer, with organ, with medium - applies equally to PRIMARY ones:

- apparent SIZE varies with distance
- MOTION and rest are relative to the frame of reference
- SHAPE varies with the angle of view
- EXTENSION cannot be conceived without colour or some visual quality; FIGURE is inseparable from extension

- 1 Locke ADMITS secondary qualities are mind-dependent.
- 2 Primary qualities are EQUALLY mind-dependent by the same tests.
- 3 THEREFORE all qualities are ideas.
- 4 THEREFORE there is NOTHING LEFT for "material substance" to be.

PRESUPPOSITION: perceptual relativity ENTAILS mind-dependence.

OBJECTION: it does NOT. That a thing looks different from different positions is what one should EXPECT of a mind-INDEPENDENT thing with a real shape. So parity is suggestive, not decisive - which is why the 2024 answer must identify the LIKENESS principle as the weapon that actually does the work.

|

ARGUMENT 4 - THE MASTER ARGUMENT Principles Sec.22-23

- 1 Berkeley stakes everything on one challenge: CONCEIVE ONE EXTENDED MOVABLE BODY EXISTING UNCONCEIVED, and he will concede materialism.
- 2 You reply that you can easily conceive a tree standing alone in a park with nobody by.
- 3 But IN DOING SO YOU ARE CONCEIVING IT - so you have framed ideas in your own mind and have NOT conceived the tree UNCONCEIVED at all.
- 4 THEREFORE the supposition is SELF-REFUTING; unperceived existence cannot even be entertained.

PRESUPPOSITION (AND THE FATAL ONE): that conceiving "X EXISTING UNCONCEIVED" requires the ACT of conceiving to be part of the CONTENT conceived.

STRONGEST OBJECTION (Russell; refined by Prior and Gallois): a SCOPE or USE-MENTION confusion. What is inconceivable is "I conceive OF X THAT IT IS NOT CONCEIVED BY ME"; what is required is only "I conceive THAT X exists and is not conceived" - perfectly coherent, exactly as I can THINK ABOUT an unthought-of number.

BERKELEY'S BEST REPLY: for him there is no OBJECT over and above the IDEA, so the distinction the objector needs is precisely what is at

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/48: Berkeley: arguments 3 and 4 - parity and the Master Argument (continued)

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issue - the argument begs the question only if immaterialism is already false.

ANSWER-CRAFT: use the Master Argument FOURTH, never first. It is the weakest of the five and has a well-known reply.

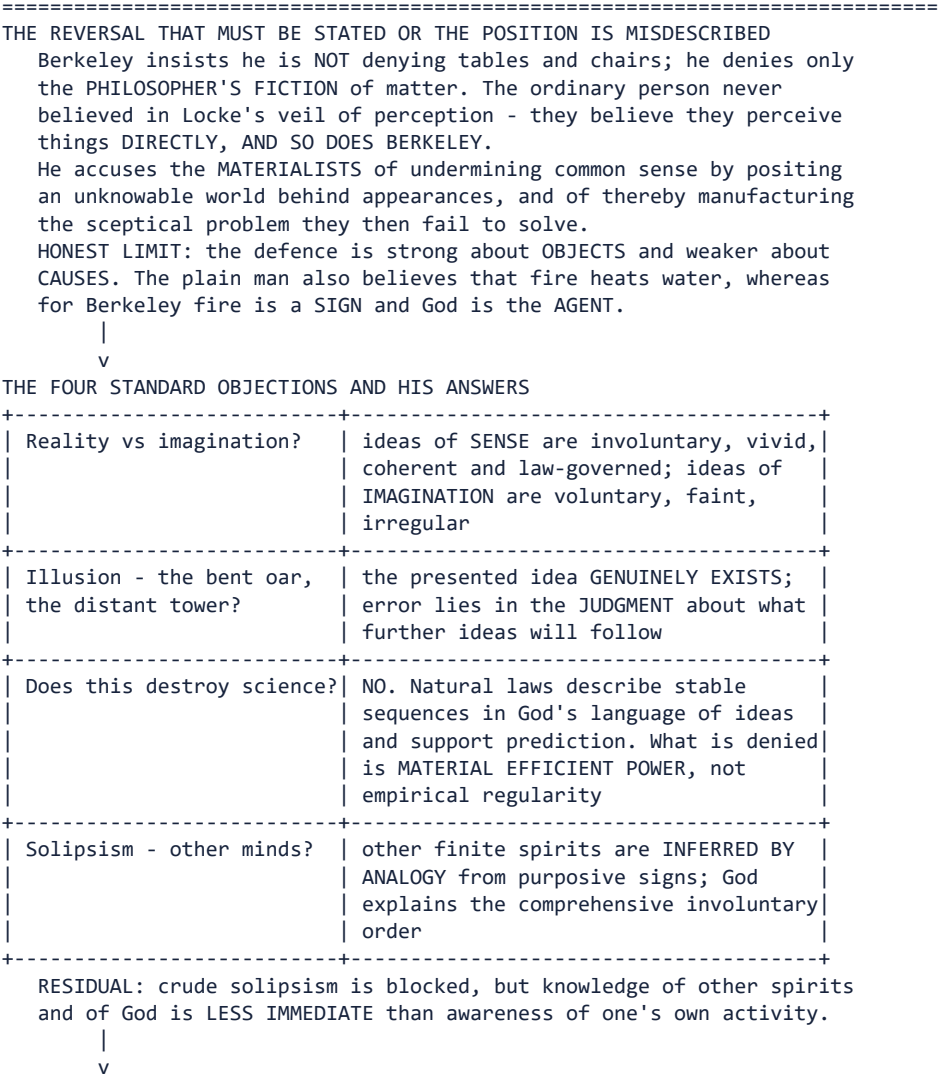
## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 27/48: Berkeley: argument 5 - continuity, spirits, notions and the divine language

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=====
ARGUMENT 5 - GOD AS GUARANTOR Principles Sec.6, 30-33, 48; Dialogues II
1 IDEAS ARE PASSIVE and inert; they cannot cause anything.
2 Yet the ideas of sense come to me INVOLUNTARILY and in a steady,
 regular order.
3 Whatever produces them must be an ACTIVE SPIRIT, and one whose power
 and wisdom EXCEED MINE.
4 THEREFORE GOD. The "laws of nature" are the SETTLED GRAMMAR of God's
 LANGUAGE of ideas - regularities are SIGNS, not causes.
5 THEREFORE objects PERSIST unperceived by finite minds because they
 are always perceived by the INFINITE MIND.
 "Does the tree exist when no one perceives it?" YES - God perceives.
 PRESUPPOSITION: only spirits are active causes (Berkeley's
 VOLUNTARISM).
 OBJECTION: this makes "existence unperceived" back into a HYPOTHESIS
 ABOUT AN UNOBSERVED BEING - the very move Berkeley forbade Locke.
 |
 v
THE FINAL ONTOLOGY - TWO CATEGORIES, NOTHING ELSE
 SPIRITS (ACTIVE substances that perceive and will)
 GOD - infinite; produces the ideas of sense; sustains continuity
 FINITE SPIRITS - my own known by inner awareness; OTHERS by ANALOGY
 from purposive signs and behaviour
 IDEAS (PASSIVE)
 OF SENSE - involuntary, vivid, coherent, LAW-GOVERNED
 OF IMAGINATION - comparatively voluntary, faint, irregular
 |
 v
HOW SPIRIT IS KNOWN: BY NOTION, NOT BY IDEA Sec.27, 89, 140
 REASON: an idea, being PASSIVE, could never PICTURE an ACTIVITY.
 Notions also cover RELATIONS, which are likewise not pictured.
 CRITICS: the asymmetry is AD HOC - an exemption introduced to protect
 the favoured posit.
 BERKELEY: the asymmetry is FORCED, not chosen; the objection assumes
 that all knowledge is idea-shaped, which is what he denies once
 ACTIVITY enters the ontology.
 HUME'S TEST: he refuses the exemption and dissolves SPIRITUAL
 substance too - which is exactly how much weight it was carrying.
 |
 v
=====
```

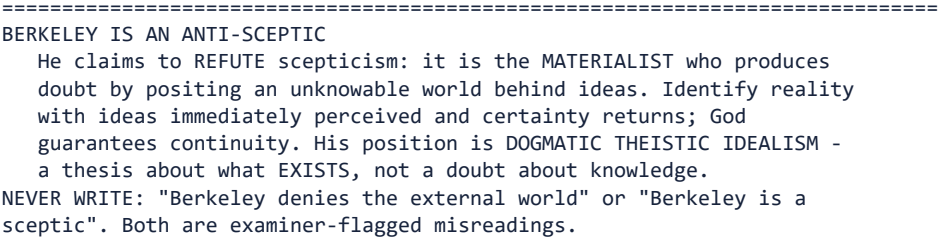
## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 28/48: Berkeley: argument 5 - continuity, spirits, notions and the divine language (continued)

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=====
BERKELEY KEEPS THE SELF. HUME DOES NOT. That single contrast organises
every comparison of the two on the syllabus limb "Self and God".
=====
```

**ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 29/48: Berkeley: common sense, illusion, science, other minds and anti-scepticism**



**ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 30/48: Berkeley: common sense, illusion, science, other minds and anti-scepticism (continued)**



## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 31/48: The two routed comparisons - Berkeley against Moore, Russell and Hegel

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### COMPARISON A - 2018 Q3(a): MOORE AND RUSSELL AGAINST BERKELEY

| AXIS                    | MOORE                                                                                                                                        | RUSSELL                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core attack             | the idealist CONFLATES the ACT of awareness with its OBJECT: awareness of blue is NOT identical with blue                                    | idealism mistakes the data of sense for the whole of the object                                  |
| Positive result         | DIRECT REALISM - the object is presented THROUGH but not CONSTITUTED BY consciousness (the transparency argument)                            | LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION - objects are inferred or built from sense-data, perspectives and relations |
| Method                  | analysis of common-sense certainties                                                                                                         | analysis into STRUCTURE                                                                          |
| Shared ground           | both REFUSE to reduce object to act or idea                                                                                                  |                                                                                                  |
| THE DIFFERENCE          | MOORE DEFENDS the ordinary object and calls it directly known; RUSSELL REPLACES it with a construction and keeps only STRUCTURAL objectivity |                                                                                                  |
| the examiner is testing | -> Moore restores COMMON SENSE, Russell restores SCIENCE                                                                                     |                                                                                                  |

ANSWER-CRAFT: the 2018 question has THREE limbs - establish, react, and DIFFER. Scripts that report both reactions and never contrast them forfeit a third of the marks.

### COMPARISON B - 2024 Q2(a): BERKELEY AGAINST HEGEL

| AXIS                           | BERKELEY - SUBJECTIVE                            | HEGEL - ABSOLUTE                                            |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Basic reality                  | finite spirits, God, ideas                       | self-developing Absolute Spirit                             |
| Why objects are mind-dependent | sensible existence CONSISTS in being perceived   | objectivity is a MOMENT within dialectical self-development |
| Role of the divine/system      | an infinite PERCEIVER who causes and coordinates | the Absolute is NOT an external perceiver                   |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 32/48: The two routed comparisons - Berkeley against Moore, Russell and Hegel (continued)

=====

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                    |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Method  | ideas                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | preserving private idea-collections                |
|         | anti-abstraction plus immaterialist argument                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | dialectical development through DETERMINE NEGATION |
| VERDICT | both reject independently self-subsisting matter as final reality, but theistic SUBJECTIVE idealism is NOT an early version of OBJECTIVE / ABSOLUTE idealism. They differ in KIND, not in degree. "Berkeley the early Hegel" is a CATEGORY ERROR the 2024 paper is designed to detect. |                                                    |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 33/48: Hume: impressions and ideas, the copy principle, the missing shade, association

```
=====
ALL CONTENTS OF THE MIND = PERCEPTIONS
 IMPRESSIONS (FORCE AND VIVACITY) IDEAS (FAINT COPIES)
 of SENSATION: colours, sounds, MEMORY: retains order and
 tastes, pains vivacity
 of REFLECTION: passions, emotions, IMAGINATION: free to separate
 the felt determination of the mind and recombine
 CRITERION: force and vivacity - a difference of DEGREE. Hume accepts
 that in fever or madness the difference can blur; this is a working
 psychology, not a definition by essence.
 |
 v
THE COPY PRINCIPLE
 every SIMPLE idea derives from a corresponding SIMPLE impression.
 COMPLEX ideas may be new combinations (a golden mountain).
 If no source impression can be located, the alleged idea is SUSPECT,
 OBSCURE OR FICTITIOUS - not automatically "meaningless" in the later
 logical-positivist sense. That stronger reading belongs to Topic 07.
 |
 v
THE CONCEDED EXCEPTION - THE MISSING SHADE OF BLUE
 Treatise I.i.1; Enquiry II
 A man acquainted with every shade of blue but one, shown the spectrum
 with a gap, CAN form the idea of the missing shade from imagination
 alone - a simple idea with no antecedent impression. Hume calls the
 instance "SO SINGULAR" that it is not worth altering his maxim for it.
 WHY IT MATTERS FOR MARKS: it shows the copy principle is an EMPIRICAL
 GENERALISATION, not an analytic truth - so the demolitions of
 substance, self and necessary connexion rest on a premise its own
 author admits admits an exception. Deploying it converts a
 DESCRIPTIVE answer into a CRITICAL one.
 HUME'S AVAILABLE REPLY: the shade is generated by INTERPOLATION
 BETWEEN impressions actually had, so the principle's SPIRIT
 survives even if its LETTER does not.
 |
 v
THE THREE PRINCIPLES OF ASSOCIATION - the mind's gentle force
 RESEMBLANCE | CONTIGUITY in time or place | CAUSE AND EFFECT
 These are PSYCHOLOGICAL mechanisms, NOT logical relations - and they
 are decisive later: resemblance and causation together produce the
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 34/48: Hume: impressions and ideas, the copy principle, the missing shade, association (continued)

```
=====
 FICTION OF A UNIFIED SELF, and repeated conjunction produces the felt
 determination Hume identifies as the source of the idea of NECESSARY
 CONNEXION. Naming association early makes the later results look
 inevitable rather than surprising.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 35/48: Hume: the fork, the dissolution of substance and the belief in body

=====

HUME'S FORK

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                               |
| RELATIONS OF IDEAS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MATTERS OF FACT               |
| known A PRIORI, by thought                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | known A POSTERIORI, require   |
| alone                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | experience                    |
| NECESSARY and certain; denial                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | CONTINGENT; the contrary is   |
| is SELF-CONTRADICTIONARY                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ALWAYS CONCEIVABLE            |
| "2+2=4"; "a bachelor is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | "the sun will rise tomorrow"; |
| unmarried"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | "fire causes heat"            |
| do NOT depend on what exists                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | DEPEND on how the world       |
| in the world                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | actually is                   |
| +-----+-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                               |
| CONSEQUENCE: anything that is NEITHER is meaningless - "COMMIT IT THEN TO THE FLAMES" (Enquiry XII), aimed at "divinity or school metaphysics".                                                                                                        |                               |
| ANCESTRY: the direct ancestor of the logical positivists' verification principle - worth ONE CLAUSE, not a paragraph.                                                                                                                                  |                               |
| 2018 Q1(a) IN ONE LINE: "2+2=4" is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory; "the Sun will rise tomorrow" is a matter of fact whose denial remains perfectly CONCEIVABLE. NOT the same necessity, and NOT merely a difference of probability. |                               |
| REFLEXIVE OBJECTION: is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact? If neither, it burns itself. HUME'S AVAILABLE ANSWER: it is a clarification of the MEANINGS OF TERMS - a meta-level classification, not a first-order claim.          |                               |

|  
v

FIRST CASUALTY - SUBSTANCE

Do we have an IMPRESSION of substance? NO. We have impressions of particular qualities - redness, hardness, sweetness - never of an underlying substrate. THEREFORE "substance" is a FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION: the mind's habit of grouping constantly conjoined qualities and INVENTING a support for them.

SCOPE: MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance alike. THIS IS WHERE HUME PASSES BERKELEY, who retained spirit.

RESULT: an OBJECT is a stable BUNDLE; the SELF is a flowing bundle.

|  
v

THE BELIEF IN BODY

Treatise I.iv.2

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 36/48: Hume: the fork, the dissolution of substance and the belief in body (continued)

=====

Sense presents only INTERRUPTED perceptions; it does not present an object existing CONTINUOUSLY while unperceived or DISTINCTLY beyond perception.

CONSTANCY of similar perceptions + COHERENCE in their reappearance -> the IMAGINATION FEIGNS continued objects and smooths the gaps.

The philosophers' DOUBLE-EXISTENCE theory - private perceptions representing independent objects - CANNOT BE VERIFIED, because all comparison remains WITHIN perceptions.

CRUCIAL QUALIFICATION: Hume does NOT demonstrate that no external world exists. Sceptical reflection undermines the RATIONAL JUSTIFICATION; NATURE restores the unavoidable belief in bodies.

THE PATTERN OF HUMEAN NATURALISM: explain why a belief is psychologically inevitable AFTER showing that reason cannot establish its metaphysical object.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 37/48: Hume: the bundle self, the Appendix retraction and Kant's reply

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=====
THE ARGUMENT Treatise I.iv.6
1 Apply the COPY PRINCIPLE to the self: from which impression is the
 idea of a self copied? It would have to be CONSTANT AND INVARIABLE
 through the whole course of a life.
2 INTROSPECTION delivers only particular perceptions - heat, cold,
 light, shade, love, hatred, pain, pleasure - in PERPETUAL FLUX.
3 NO constant impression is found.
4 THEREFORE the self is "NOTHING BUT A BUNDLE OR COLLECTION OF
 DIFFERENT PERCEPTIONS, WHICH SUCCEED EACH OTHER WITH AN INCONCEIVABLE
 RAPIDITY, AND ARE IN A PERPETUAL FLUX AND MOVEMENT."
 WHAT IS DENIED: a SIMPLE, IDENTICAL SELF-SUBSTANCE.
 WHAT IS NOT DENIED: the perceptions, which are REAL.
 |
 v
WHY THE ILLUSION OF UNITY?
 RESEMBLANCE - present ideas resemble past memories, creating a felt
 continuity
 CAUSATION - one perception seems to produce the next; memory links
 them into a chain
 -> the IMAGINATION passes SMOOTHLY along the series and MISTAKES AN
 EASY TRANSITION FOR AN IDENTICAL OBJECT: the FICTION of identity
 |
 v
THE APPENDIX RETRACTION - THE PAGE THAT EARNS MARKS
 Hume cannot explain what BINDS the bundle: "ALL MY HOPES VANISH WHEN
 I COME TO EXPLAIN THE PRINCIPLES THAT UNITE OUR SUCCESSIVE
 PERCEPTIONS."
 DIAGNOSIS: he has denied BOTH a substance AND any real connexion
 between distinct existences, so he has removed in advance every
 resource a principle of unity could have used.
 THEREFORE the honest verdict: THE FAILURE INDICTS THE ATOMISM OF
 IMPRESSIONS, NOT THE SELF.
 TEXTUAL NOTE: the Enquiry SILENTLY DROPS personal identity.
 |
 v
KANT'S REPLY - THE 2020 SECOND LIMB, STATED EXACTLY
1 Kant ACCEPTS that no impression or inner intuition reveals a simple
 soul-substance. He is NOT restoring a Cartesian ego.
2 He argues that the "I THINK" MUST BE ABLE TO ACCOMPANY ALL MY
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 38/48: Hume: the bundle self, the Appendix retraction and Kant's reply (continued)

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=====
 REPRESENTATIONS if they are to belong to ONE experience at all.
3 The TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION is therefore a FORMAL
 CONDITION of synthesising a manifold under rules - NOT another
 perceived item inside the bundle.
4 LIMIT: this answers the missing unity at the level of POSSIBLE
 EXPERIENCE; it does not prove an immortal soul or settle every
 practical question of identity through time.
5 HUMEAN REJOINDER: Kant has stated a condition of DESCRIPTION rather
 than discovered an ENTITY. Kant ACCEPTS the non-entity point and
 insists that rule-governed unity is PRESUPPOSED by judgment.
CROSS-TRADITION BRIDGE - ONE CLAUSE ONLY: the bundle strikingly
resembles the Buddhist doctrine of no-self (nairatmyavada). It is a
PARALLEL, not an influence, and the syllabus owner is Indian Philosophy.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 39/48: Hume on God, and the three fronts on which the proofs fail

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=====
FRONT 1 - THE CAUSAL / COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT
 We have NO IMPRESSION of a "first cause" or of causation as NECESSARY
 CONNEXION. We therefore cannot legitimately infer from experienced
 effects to an UNEXPERIENCED TRANSCENDENT CAUSE.
 CONSEQUENCE: the argument LOCKE used is cut off AT ITS PREMISE - the
 cleanest single link between Locke's God and Hume's scepticism.
 |
FRONT 2 - THE DESIGN / TELEOLOGICAL ARGUMENT
 Dialogues concerning Natural Religion
 FOUR SEPARATE OBJECTIONS - give all four, not "weak analogy" alone:
 1 THE ANALOGY IS WEAK: universe : designer :: watch : watchmaker.
 The universe is not sufficiently similar to a MANUFACTURED ARTIFACT.
 2 EVEN IF GRANTED it proves at most a FINITE ARCHITECT working on
 GIVEN MATTER - not an omnipotent, omniscient, morally perfect
 creator.
 3 ORDER MIGHT ARISE from natural principles - matter's inherent
 organising tendencies - WITHOUT invoking intelligence.
 4 THE PROBLEM OF EVIL undermines any inference from the world to a
 PERFECTLY GOOD designer.
 |
FRONT 3 - MIRACLES
 Enquiry X
 A miracle violates the laws of nature. Testimony in favour of a
 miracle is ALWAYS LESS PROBABLE than the testimony being false.
 THEREFORE it is never rational to believe miracle-reports on
 TESTIMONY ALONE.
 OWNERSHIP NOTE: the miracle argument is SECONDARY ENRICHMENT here;
 Hume's critique of the PROOFS is CORE, because "God" is printed in
 the syllabus clause.
 |
 v
CROSS-PAPER LINK: the design-argument critique is also the required
content for Paper II questions on proofs for God's existence. Same
argument, different paper - do not duplicate ownership.
 |
 v
THE GOD AXIS ACROSS THE THREE EMPIRICISTS - THE WITHDRAWAL TEST
 LOCKE God is a SUPPORT: a demonstrated conclusion plus a
 guarantee of our faculties. WITHDRAW HIM and the
 epistemology survives; the demonstration and the defence
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 40/48: Hume on God, and the three fronts on which the proofs fail (continued)

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=====
 of representative realism are lost.
BERKELEY God is a MECHANISM: the cause of involuntary ideas and the
 guarantor of continuity. WITHDRAW HIM and the system
 COLLAPSES - no cause of order, no continuity, no
 distinction between real and imaginary beyond felt
 vivacity.
HUME God is a CASUALTY: no proof survives. WITHDRAW HIM and
 NOTHING IS LOST, because nothing rested on him.
DEEPEST CRITICISM OF IMMATERIALISM: God performs EXACTLY the two
functions Locke assigned to MATTER - causing our ideas and sustaining
the unperceived. Berkeley's economy is a SUBSTITUTION of posits
rather than an ELIMINATION of them.
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## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 41/48: Hume on causation - the negative argument and the two definitions

=====

### (A) THE NEGATIVE ARGUMENT ON NECESSARY CONNEXION

Treatise I.iii.14; Enquiry VII

- 1 COPY PRINCIPLE: every simple idea derives from a simple impression.
- 2 So if we have a genuine idea of NECESSARY CONNEXION, locate its SOURCE IMPRESSION.
- 3 EXTERNAL SEARCH: in any SINGLE instance of causation - one billiard ball striking another - sense delivers only PRIORITY, CONTIGUITY and the SUCCESSION of qualities. No impression of a POWER or TIE.
- 4 REPETITION ADDS NO NEW QUALITY TO THE OBJECTS: the hundredth collision is qualitatively no different from the first.
- 5 INTERNAL SEARCH: volition does no better. I have NO IMPRESSION of HOW the will moves the limb; the actual mechanism - nerve, muscle - is unknown to consciousness. This rules out the CARTESIAN and the OCCASIONALIST appeal alike. (SCRIPTS OMIT THIS STEP; IT IS WHAT MAKES THE CONCLUSION GENERAL RATHER THAN ANECDOTAL.)
- 6 But repetition DOES produce a change in THE MIND: after constant conjunction the mind is DETERMINED to pass from the idea of A to the idea of B. That felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION.
- 7 THEREFORE the idea of necessary connexion is COPIED FROM THAT INTERNAL IMPRESSION. Necessity "IS SOMETHING THAT EXISTS IN THE MIND, NOT IN OBJECTS."
- 8 THEREFORE TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE FOLLOW:

|                                |                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                  |                                |
| (i) OBJECTIVE / PHILOSOPHICAL  | (ii) SUBJECTIVE / NATURAL      |
| an object followed by another, | an object followed by another, |
| where ALL OBJECTS SIMILAR to   | whose appearance CONVEYS THE   |
| the first are followed by      | THOUGHT to the other           |
| objects similar to the second  |                                |
| regularity-based, EXTERNAL     | psychological, INTERNAL        |
| +-----+-----+                  |                                |

NAMING BOTH IS THE SINGLE HIGHEST-VALUE MOVE IN ANY HUME-ON-CAUSATION ANSWER. TENSION TO FLAG: the two pull apart and Hume NEVER RECONCILES them - the origin of the modern REGULARITY vs PROJECTIVIST debate. MECHANISM: CUSTOM OR HABIT, "the great guide of human life" (Enq. V).

#### PRESUPPOSITIONS

- P1 the copy principle is exceptionless
- P2 single and repeated instances can be compared for ADDED content - i.e. causation must be visible in ONE instance if objective at all
- P3 impressions are ATOMIC and SEPARABLE, so no relation is given WITH

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 42/48: Hume on causation - the negative argument and the two definitions (continued)

=====

its terms

- P4 "necessity" must be either OBSERVED or PROJECTED - no third option such as an inferred theoretical posit

CANONICAL EXAMPLES: the two billiard balls (Enquiry IV, VII); bread nourishing the body (Enquiry IV) - the sensible qualities of bread give no clue to its NUTRITIVE POWER.

2019 Q4(b) IN TWO LINES: in the OBJECTS - NO necessity. In the MIND - YES, the impression of reflection. A flat "no" fails the directive.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 43/48: Hume: the induction dilemma, Kant's Second Analogy and mitigated scepticism

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=====
(B) THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION AS A FORMAL DILEMMA Enquiry IV
1 All reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory
 rests on the relation of CAUSE AND EFFECT.
2 Causal inference rests on the UNIFORMITY PRINCIPLE (UP): the future
 will resemble the past; unobserved cases resemble observed ones.
3 UP can be established ONLY DEMONSTRATIVELY OR PROBABLY.
 <== THE VULNERABLE STEP: this is the FORK APPLIED REFLEXIVELY
4 NOT DEMONSTRATIVELY: "the course of nature may change" implies no
 contradiction - it is perfectly CONCEIVABLE.
5 NOT PROBABLY: every probable or experiential argument ALREADY
 PRESUPPOSES UP, so the argument would be CIRCULAR.
6 THEREFORE UP has NO RATIONAL FOUNDATION.
7 THEREFORE inductive inference is produced not by REASON but by
 CUSTOM OR HABIT.
 EVERY SERIOUS REPLY ATTACKS STEP 3:
 KANT supplies a THIRD category - the SYNTHETIC A PRIORI
 POPPER denies that science needs induction at all
 STRAWSON argues that demanding a justification of induction AS A
 WHOLE misapplies the very standards induction constitutes
EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the sceptical conclusion depends on the
EXHAUSTIVENESS of a dichotomy that IS the fork - so Hume's scepticism
about induction is the SHADOW CAST BY HIS CLASSIFICATION OF
PROPOSITIONS, and survives only as long as the fork does.
 |
 v
(C) KANT'S RESPONSE - THE ROUTED REPLY IN 2025 Q2(c)
- Kant AGREES that necessary connection is not copied from a sensory
 impression. HE ACCEPTS THE NEGATIVE RESULT.
- SECOND ANALOGY: the category of CAUSE is an A PRIORI RULE required
 to distinguish OBJECTIVE event-succession from the merely
 SUBJECTIVE succession of my perceptions. Without a rule, the
 difference between a SHIP DRIFTING DOWNSTREAM and MY EYE WANDERING
 OVER A HOUSE cannot be drawn.
- "Every event has a cause" is therefore SYNTHETIC A PRIORI FOR
 POSSIBLE EXPERIENCE: the understanding supplies necessary temporal
 ordering to phenomena.
- LIMIT: this rescues objective empirical causation WITHOUT claiming
 knowledge of causality among THINGS IN THEMSELVES.
- HUMEAN CHALLENGE: has Kant PROVED the category, or BUILT IT INTO
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 44/48: Hume: the induction dilemma, Kant's Second Analogy and mitigated scepticism (continued)

```
=====
 the definition of objective experience? KANT'S REPLY is
 TRANSCENDENTAL - without such rule-governed synthesis, experience
 of an EVENT would not be possible at all.
- ADJUDICATION: Kant is CORRECTLY AIMED, because Hume's result
 follows from the ATOMISM OF IMPRESSIONS, and it is the atomism, not
 the inference, that Kant attacks.
 |
 v
(D) MITIGATED SCEPTICISM - THE POSITIVE DOCTRINE Enquiry XII
EXCESSIVE / PYRRHONIAN: total suspension of judgment - UNLIVEABLE
MITIGATED: limit enquiry to what experience can answer; avoid
 speculation beyond possible experience (substance, God, the soul);
 PROPORTION BELIEF TO EVIDENCE; rely on the natural beliefs custom
 compels
STANDING OBJECTION: Hume USES induction while denying its rational
 basis. REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its
 groundlessness; both can be true without practical contradiction.
RESIDUAL: stable ONLY IF natural beliefs are exempt from the demand
 for justification - which concedes that not all belief needs reason.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 45/48: The eight-axis comparison grid and the criticism-reply-residual ledger

| AXIS       | LOCKE                                         | BERKELEY                                      | HUME                                                            |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| MATTER     | real but unknowable substrate                 | does not exist - an empty word                | no impression -> fiction                                        |
| QUALITIES  | primary (objective) vs secondary (subjective) | ALL mind-dependent; the distinction COLLAPSES | all are impressions; no basis for an objective/subjective split |
| SUBSTANCE  | "something I know not what"                   | spirit only - no material substance           | none at all - material OR spiritual                             |
| SELF       | continuity of consciousness                   | ACTIVE SPIRIT, known by NOTION                | BUNDLE of perceptions                                           |
| CAUSATION  | real power, knowledge of mechanism limited    | God's will producing ideas in us              | constant conjunction + habit; no real power                     |
| GOD        | DEMONSTRATED by a cosmological-style argument | REQUIRED to sustain unperceived ideas         | all proofs fail; scepticism                                     |
| SCEPTICISM | REJECTED (moderate realism)                   | claims to REFUTE scepticism                   | EMBRACED, but MITIGATED                                         |
| OVERALL    | representative realism                        | subjective (theistic) idealism                | phenomenalism + scepticism                                      |

===== CRITICISM | SOURCE | REPLY | RESIDUAL =====

### AGAINST LOCKE

- 1 The primary/secondary distinction is unstable. [Berkeley]  
 REPLY: extension can be THOUGHT abstractly through mathematical reasoning even if always IMAGINED with colour.  
 RESIDUAL: the reply needs a NON-IMAGISTIC idea, straining Locke's own theory of ideas.
- 2 Representative realism generates scepticism. [Berkeley; sceptics]  
 REPLY: God would not make us systematically deceived; inference to external causes is reliable enough for the conduct of life.  
 RESIDUAL: an epistemological problem is converted into a THEOLOGICAL GUARANTEE.
- 3 Personal identity via memory is circular. [Butler, Reid]

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 46/48: The eight-axis comparison grid and the criticism-reply-residual ledger (continued)

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REPLY: constitutive (consciousness) vs evidential (memory) criteria;
overlapping chains repair transitivity.
RESIDUAL: "consciousness of it AS MINE" may re-import ownership.
AGAINST BERKELEY
4 Surely tables exist unperceived. [reported: Johnson's stone-kicking]
REPLY: the table DOES exist unperceived BY YOU - God perceives it.
RESIDUAL: continuity is bought with a THEOLOGICAL PREMISE.
5 Solipsism threat: what of other minds?
REPLY: other spirits are known by ANALOGY; God guarantees the system.
RESIDUAL: knowledge of other spirits is LESS IMMEDIATE than awareness
of one's own activity.
6 Why invoke God? This is dogmatic, not empiricist. [Hume]
REPLY: Berkeley accepts he is a THEIST USING EMPIRICIST METHODS.
RESIDUAL: God does exactly the work LOCKE'S MATTER did.
7 How does subjective idealism differ from Hegel's absolute idealism?
[the 2024 examiner]
REPLY: Berkeley - ideas in finite and divine minds; Hegel - the
self-development of Absolute Spirit.
RESIDUAL: they differ in KIND, not in degree.
AGAINST HUME
8 Without real causal power, science becomes inexplicable.
[Kant; scientists]
REPLY: science works by INDUCTIVE HABIT; its success is a
PSYCHOLOGICAL FACT, not a philosophical justification.
RESIDUAL: an account of SUCCESS is not an account of WARRANT.
9 What holds the bundle together? [critics; HUME HIMSELF]
REPLY: none is offered - "all my hopes vanish" (Appendix).
RESIDUAL: the failure indicts the ATOMISM, not the self.
10 Is the FORK itself a relation of ideas or a matter of fact?
REPLY: a clarification of the MEANINGS OF TERMS - meta-level.
RESIDUAL: the status of the meta-level remains CONTESTED.
11 Mitigated scepticism is inconsistent - Hume USES induction.
REPLY: nature forces belief; philosophy reveals its groundlessness.
RESIDUAL: stable only if natural beliefs are EXEMPT from the demand
for justification.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 47/48: PYQ routes, directive decoder, answer spines, provenance, traps and conclusion

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THE TWELVE ROUTED PYQs AND THEIR ANSWER ROUTES (2018-2025)
2018 Q1(a) 10 the fork; conceivability test; NOT the same necessity
2018 Q3(a) 20 five arguments for immaterialism, then Moore's act-
 object realism vs Russell's logical construction, THEN
 the explicit contrast (the third limb)
2019 Q4(b) 15 not in objects, YES in the mind - the impression of
 reflection; both definitions of cause
2020 Q2(a) 20 bundle self, fiction of unity, the Appendix; THEN Kant's
 transcendental unity of apperception
2021 Q1(c) 10 "IMMEDIATELY perceived": the semantic argument; removal
 of the veil; esse est percipi at Sec.3
2021 Q1(d) 10 person/man/substance; consciousness and appropriation;
 Butler-Reid; the Brave Officer; graded verdict
2021 Q1(e) 10 constant conjunction is NECESSARY but NOT SUFFICIENT;
 the felt determination completes the analysis
2022 Q4(c) 15 three grounds; white paper; sensation and reflection;
 the three degrees of knowledge
2023 Q2(a) 20 full causal analysis; association and custom; three
 objections; a delivered ruling
2024 Q2(a) 20 parity AND likeness, abstraction as the deeper ground;
 Berkeley vs Hegel on matched axes
2025 Q2(c) 15 Hume complete FIRST, then the Second Analogy, then
 adjudication
2025 Q4(c) 15 Locke's abstraction; Berkeley's refutation; the Sec.12
 replacement; the metaphysical payload
CORPUS SIGNAL: 12 primary-owned parts of 112; at least one in EVERY
year 2018-2025.
DIRECTIVE DECODER - ONE LINE EACH
EXPLAIN / ELUCIDATE = give the DERIVATION, not a synonym for the
conclusion
EXAMINE = state AND test; rule on the objection's force
CRITICALLY ANALYSE = exposition PLUS a delivered verdict
DISCUSS = roughly 60:40 exposition to assessment
"IS THERE ANY ELEMENT ...?" = a YES-AND-NO WITH A DISTINCTION
"IS A INSTRUMENTAL IN B?" = a CAUSAL-EXPLANATORY ruling
COMMENT ON THE STATEMENT = locate the sentence in its own text first
ANSWER SPINES
10-mark: thesis line -> doctrine in three moves -> one objection ->
graded verdict
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 48/48: PYQ routes, directive decoder, answer spines, provenance, traps and conclusion (continued)

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15-mark: frame -> Body A (the empiricist argument, complete) ->
 Body B (the routed reply) -> assessment -> close
20-mark: frame -> full analysis -> positive account -> three
 objections -> ruling that names the load-bearing premise
PROVENANCE RULES THAT PROTECT MARKS
"tabula rasa" is a LATER LABEL; Locke writes "white paper, void of
 all characters" (II.i.2)
"esse est percipi" is Berkeley's own Latin (Sec.3); "aut percipere"
 is a COMMENTATORS' EXPANSION
Essay II.xxvii was ADDED IN 1694; the Essay appeared in 1689 with
 1690 on the title page
Treatise != Enquiry: the Enquiry DROPS personal identity; published
 1748 as Philosophical Essays, RENAMED 1758
"Reason is the slave of the passions" is Treatise II.iii.3 - ETHICS,
 not epistemology
Samuel Johnson's stone is RECEPTION, not argument
TRAP SHEET - TEN LINES
1 "Berkeley denies the external world" -> he denies MATTER AS AN
 UNPERCEIVING SUBSTRATUM
2 "Hume denies causation" -> he denies OBJECTIVE NECESSARY CONNEXION
3 "Secondary qualities are illusions" -> they are POWERS
4 "Locke denies substance" -> he denies KNOWLEDGE OF ITS NATURE
5 "tabula rasa" quoted as Locke's words -> it is the tradition's
6 "Hume says the self does not exist" -> no SIMPLE IDENTICAL
 SUBSTANCE; the perceptions are real
7 "Kant proves the soul" -> he supplies a FORMAL CONDITION
8 Berkeley called a sceptic -> he is an ANTI-SCEPTIC
9 Berkeley called an early Hegel -> different in KIND
10 Quine's "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" imported here -> Topic 11
QUALIFIED CONCLUSION
Empiricism consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live.
That outcome DIAGNOSES the founding rule as INCOMPLETE rather than
refuting philosophy - which is exactly the conclusion Kant draws when
he keeps Hume's negative results and attacks the ATOMISM OF
IMPRESSIONS that produced them. The slide from Locke to Hume is
therefore RIGOUR, not decadence, and the next syllabus item begins
where this one ends.
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